

A person is shown from the waist down, wearing black lace underwear and black garters. The person is also wearing sheer black stockings. The background is a solid light pink color.

DELORES SWALLOWS

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by
THE BOARD

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Her First Time Teamed
A Loaned Wife's Journey (Book 3)

by Delores Swallows

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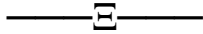
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After Ciaran decided to share her with his business partner, Nicole knows it's time to move on. Only her husband gets to share her. Ciaran was just her bull, and the bullpen's full of alternatives for a beautiful hotwife—alternatives like the gregarious couple next door.

Unable to accept that their kinky times are over, Ciaran persuades Nicole to accompany him to Ireland on a business trip to charm a bank manager and join his firm's get-together in Galway. Angered by his deviousness on the first day, Nicole makes him pay on the second, getting along too well with his colleagues for his liking.

Set against the backdrop of a global pandemic, Nicole finds just how good life as loaned wife can be. And her husband's suggestion means that once the travel restrictions are lifted, her adventures will get even better...

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Chapter One

Nicole and Julian spent the weekend after her threesome in what seemed like a sexual vacuum, neither of them mentioning what she'd done on Friday evening. Julian spent his Saturday unpacking tools and finding places for them in his new garage, and Nicole cut back all the dead foliage from the shrubs in the garden. On Sunday, they walked hand-in-hand around the estate to get their bearings along the numerous paths running through the surrounding fields and woods.

It was Monday morning by the time Nicole finally broached the subject of having told Julian's boss that she wouldn't be seeing him again. She stroked her husband's hand across the breakfast table. "You'll be civil today, right? And professional."

He flashed her a grin. "I'm always civil and professional. But if you're referring to how I'll behave with Ciaran, there'll be no need. I won't see him until Thursday at the earliest."

"Oh?" She tried to remember if either of them had mentioned not going to the office this week. "Why's that?"

"Ciaran's going to be spending today and tomorrow at the Leeds branch, and I'll be visiting clients on Wednesday with a new member of my team. But as I've said before, what happens between you and Ciaran will have no bearing on my relationship with him. We've only ever discussed work-related issues in the entire time you two have been seeing each other, and I see no reason why that will change."

"Good." Having her husband's boss as a bull was fraught with potential complications; she was still worried that dropping him as a bull may prove troublesome.

Ciaran had been the perfect bull—handsome, fit and hung. His self-confidence bordered on arrogance, but with his designer suits and penchant for women in stockings and high-heels, he'd treated Nicole to several enjoyable encounters in his office. To counteract his cockiness, she'd been

inspired to act out of character. Strutting into his large office wearing a crisp blouse, figure-hugging skirt and heels she could barely walk in, she'd become the empowered slut. She'd stripped down to her lingerie, bent over his desk and ordered him to pleasure her. They'd both loved every minute of it, but Friday night had changed all that.

"How about you?" Julian asked, breaking her from her reverie.
"Anything exciting in your calendar?"

"No, just more of the usual drudgery."

He laughed and went off to get his jacket and briefcase.

After he'd left, Nicole tidied the kitchen and made another cup of tea, then headed off to start work on her laptop.

She received a text from Ciaran just before lunch.

*I'm in the Yorkshire office for a couple of days.
Fancy meeting up later in the week?*

She'd intended ignoring his texts completely, but decided she'd have to answer.

*No.
The bookkeeping's finished, and I don't like being
manipulated.*

She got an instant reply.

*The way you reacted to having two men
manipulating your body at the same time suggests
otherwise. :-)*

Seething, Nicole typed out a succinct *Fuck off* and put her phone to one side. A couple of minutes later, it pinged again. Though sorely tempted to delete without reading then block his number, she opened the message.

Sorry, I was joking. If you send me your bank details, I'll pay you for all the bookkeeping you've done.

She did so, then put him out of her mind and went back to concentrating on her day job.

She had the satisfaction of finishing everything she needed to do by the time the office furniture they'd ordered was delivered later in the afternoon. She spent a rewarding couple of hours after dinner putting her new desk together and getting her own workspace just as she wanted it.

When they went to bed that night, Nicole didn't bother with her usual attire of vest top and panties. Julian's expression at her nakedness made her smile.

"I want to make up for the disappointment of my return home on Friday night."

"There's nothing to make up."

She leaned close and traced kisses along his jawline, the hair of his beard softer now it'd grown a bit longer. "I'm not offering kinky fun. That'll come later. Tonight, I want to make love to you."

"That sounds nice."

"Nice?" She eased his boxers down his thighs and wrapped her fingers around his growing erection. "Your sexy young wife offers to make love to you, and it's just nice?"

He grinned. "Should I have said arousing?"

She pinched his nipple and laughed. "I think it's probably best if you don't say anything." Nicole climbed on top and guided him inside. They both sighed, and she moved slowly on him. He ran his hands over her back and bum, and they kissed often as she rode him. After she'd reached her orgasm, her legs lost strength and Julian guided her hips to help her move her on him.

Nicole bit into his shoulder when she knew he was on the brink, and he cried out and shuddered beneath her. She held him close and clenched herself around his cock as it jerked and spasmed.

Nicole fell asleep lying on top with his arms around her waist.

* * * *

Tuesday was one of her days off so, after Julian had headed off to work, Nicole decided to go for another walk around the footpaths they'd discovered a few days earlier. She enjoyed the bright December morning walking through fields and woods, encountering only a few joggers. The trees were bare, many birds and squirrels hopping through the branches.

As she made her way back up their road, neighbour Liz passed in her car and waved. Liz was still unloading shopping bags from her car when Nicole passed their drive.

She waved. "Morning."

"Hi Nicole. Fancy a coffee?"

"Yeah, that'd be lovely." She paused on the driveway. "Am I allowed to come inside? The law seems to change every five minutes."

Liz laughed and shrugged. "Yeah, I know. I'm sure it'll be fine."

Nicole left her walking boots outside the front door and followed her hostess through to the kitchen.

"How are you guys settling in?" Liz asked, putting milk and yogurts into the fridge.

"Great, thanks. We discovered the paths through the woods at the weekend, and I've just been down there again."

"Next time you go, could I come with you?"

"Sure." Nicole nodded. "That'd be nice."

Liz sighed. "This whole year's been so weird. I'm going stir-crazy, and now they're saying there's going to be another lockdown."

"Yeah, I wish they'd hurry up and get the vaccine sorted."

Liz slipped off her coat. "Tea or coffee?"

"Ooh, tea, please."

Taking two mugs from a cupboard, Liz asked, "How was your night out with the girls?"

She remembered meeting Liz and her husband on her way out to see Ciaran. She saw no need to confess that she'd spent the evening in a hotel room getting pleased by two men. "It was nice, thanks."

"Well, you certainly made an impression on Ed." She gave a grin. "I think he rather approved of your decision to dress up, not down."

Nicole grimaced. "Oh God! We'd all agreed to dress a bit slutty."

"Well, I'm not complaining. He kept me awake for most of the night."

Nicole stared, open-mouthed.

"Sorry, TMI?" Liz cackled, pouring the boiling water into the teapot. "I guess I need to rein back my dirty side."

"No, don't rein back at all. I was just a little..."

Liz poured the tea and took a seat on the opposite side of the kitchen island. "So, where were you guys living before you moved here?"

"Just a few miles down the road. On the Meadows estate."

"Oh, okay. We used to live on the other side of town and only moved in a couple of months before you did."

"Do you work?" Nicole asked.

"Officially I work for Ed, but that's mainly for tax purposes. He has his own business and I do some 'admin' so he can pay himself some of his salary at the lower tax band." She shrugged, either not understanding it or not caring. "How about you?"

"I've been part-time at home for the last nine months. I work for the Tax Office."

Liz's face blanched.

Nicole burst out laughing. "I'm joking. I work for a local company that makes heating system controls."

"You bitch! Nearly gave me a heart attack."

Nicole was still giggling. "Sorry. Maybe I should rein back my evil sense of humour."

"Tell you what, you can show me more of your humour if I can show you more of my dirty side."

“I’d like that.” Nicole wondered if she’d ever show her own dirty side to their new neighbour. They chatted and laughed while they finished their tea, then Nicole headed back home.

While pottering around in the garden that afternoon, her mind started to wander. Although last night’s love-making had been sensual and rewarding, she suspected Julian would need more than that to scratch his kinky itch. The days when her husband was satisfied after missionary with the lights off had long since passed. The wife-sharing voyeur he’d evolved into needed to hear about, and visualise, everything she’d done with another man.

Tonight, Nicole would tell him everything she’d done with *two* other men. She smiled at the thought of how he’d react to her having done anal and reminded herself to slip the tube of K-Y into her bedside drawer for later. No doubt Julian would want to experience it for himself.

As the light faded, she went inside to prepare dinner. Once the casserole was in the oven and she’d set the table in the dining room, she then went upstairs to shower. By the time Julian’s car pulled into the drive, she’d showered and dressed in a knee-length skirt and sparkly top.

He smiled as he came into the kitchen. “Hi.” After putting his briefcase down, he let his gaze wander down her body. “Have you been out?”

She shook her head, stepped close and offered a cheek, which he duly kissed.

He inhaled. “You smell nice.”

“I got dirty and sweaty in the garden, so I needed a shower.”

“It’s not soap or shampoo I can smell. It’s perfume.”

Nicole slipped a hand inside his jacket lapel and stroked his chest. Sometimes she loved the fact she was almost a foot shorter than him when barefoot. She smiled up into his eyes. “I thought maybe you could help me get dirty and sweaty again later... in the bedroom.”

He grinned, then turned serious. “There’s no need. If you don’t feel ready—”

“I’m ready.” She tilted her head towards the hall. “Go get changed, then pour yourself a drink. Dinner’s ready.”

As he headed upstairs, she plated up their food and carried it to the dining room. Returning to the kitchen, she poured herself a glass of white wine from the fridge and grabbed an empty glass for Julian. He came downstairs dressed in jeans and a black t-shirt, chose a bottle of red from the rack, and sat opposite.

“So, how was your day?” she asked.

“Fine. I had another call from Keith, and he—”

“Keith?”

“The sales director. He’s suggested I go down to Head Office next week.”

“Oh?”

“He wants to chat about the company-wide implementation of the algorithm. He’s worried that if we don’t sort it soon, there’ll be another lockdown which would postpone it for a few months.”

“Will it be an overnight stay?”

He nodded, then smiled. “Why, are you thinking of arranging another night out with your bull?”

“No. It’s a nice offer, but I’m between bulls at the moment.”

“You’re not going to go back to Ciaran?”

“I got a text yesterday asking if we could meet later this week, and I said no.”

“How did he take it?”

“I’m hoping he got the message. He asked for my bank details so he could pay me for the work I did on his accounts.”

“And has he paid?”

“I haven’t checked yet.”

They ate for a while, then he asked about her day.

“I’ve had a really nice one, making the most of the sunshine. This morning I repeated the walk we took the other day, and then spent a few hours in the garden this afternoon.” She took a sip of wine. “Actually, I bumped into Liz from next door on my way back from my walk and popped in for a cuppa. Apparently they only moved in a couple of months before us.”

“Ah, okay. It’s nice that you’ve got someone close by that you can chat with.”

“I think we’re going to get on, she seems like a lot of fun. Did I mention I’d also met her husband?”

He shook his head.

“They arrived home just as I was heading out to meet Ciaran on Friday—the first impression he got was that I dressed like a high-class escort.”

Julian chuckled.

She shook her head, still cringing. “I made some lame excuse about me and the girls from work doing a DUND thing, and—”

“A what?”

“DUND – dress up, not down. Anyway, from what Liz said today, I think he liked my outfit. She said it inspired him to keep her awake for most of the night.”

He laughed out loud. “So, what are they like? I don’t think I’ve seen either of them.”

“Liz is friendly and attractive. Maybe your age, slim with a curly blonde bob. Ed’s probably ten years older than her. He has his own business, but I don’t know what he does. Liz gets a salary, but I don’t think she actually does anything to earn it.”

“If he kept her up all night, I think that tells you what she does to earn it.”

Nicole giggled. “I think that’s part of the marriage contract and nothing to do with her salary.”

“Speaking of jobs,” he said, picking up his wine glass, “do you remember I’m visiting clients to introduce Mitchell tomorrow?”

“Yes, I remember. What’s your new team member like?”

“Very young, and very shy.” He grinned. “Probably not your type.”

“I wasn’t asking for that, and I certainly don’t intend getting involved with another of your colleagues.”

“Sorry, I was being facetious. Although he’s bright, I worry that he’s too introverted to impress most people.”

“Sounds familiar.”

He gave his trademark embarrassed smile. “I think that might be why they’ve put him in my team. But I brought it up now because I need to prepare a few things beforehand.”

Nicole tried to keep the disappointment from her face “You’re going to work tonight?”

“It won’t take me long, I promise. I just need to gather some info and print a couple of things out. An hour at most.”

“Okay. Do you want to do it now, or wait until you’ve satiated your slutty wife?”

He guffawed and put his glass down. “I worry that if I don’t do it now, I’ll be too tired to do it later. My slutty wife can be quite demanding, now that she’s used to taking two men at once.”

“Hmm. Go and do whatever you need. I’ll clear up. And drink more wine.”

He helped her carry the plates through to the kitchen, where he picked up his briefcase and headed up to his office. Nicole loaded the dishwasher, tidied the kitchen and topped up her glass.

Back in the lounge, she curled her legs beneath her on the couch and sipped her wine, planning how to tell Julian about the better part of her Friday night adventures. Or should she go back a bit further and tell him about her overnight stay in the hotel with Ciaran? That had been her first anal experience; opening her sex-talk with that particular night would pave the way for describing how she came to take both Ciaran and Will inside her at the same time on Friday. She regretted not telling him about her first anal experience sooner, because then she could go straight into her description of the threesome, which she was looking forward to. She’d only just worked out how to get her stories in order when Julian returned to the living room, smiling.

“All done.”

“That was quick. Want to talk here, or in bed?”

“During your entire adult life, how many men have chosen to sit with you on a couch over taking you to bed?”

She put a finger to her chin and looked up at the ceiling as if thinking about it. “Erm... None.”

“So there’s your answer.” Without waiting, he turned and headed upstairs. Nicole followed him up, taking her glass of wine with her.

Once in the bedroom, Julian quickly stripped and climbed into bed. He sat up and watched as she pulled off her top, slid down her skirt and knelt on the bed in her bra and panties.

She leaned close and kissed him gently. “So, I know you’ll have questions about Friday, but first—”

“Tell me what they said when you returned to the bar after our phone call.”

“I don’t think they said anything, but before we get onto—”

“What did you say?”

She sighed. “I can’t remember exactly. I didn’t sit down. I just walked back to the table and suggested we go to the room.”

Julian closed his eyes, and she knew he was visualising the scene in his head. Best to change tack and let him have his moment, then. She’d have to double back to her big revelation later.

“What did they say to that?” he prompted.

“I don’t think either of them replied. They just got up and we all walked to the lift. I can’t remember anyone speaking until we were in the hotel room. And before you ask, I think I did most of the talking from that point. I told Will that you were happy for me to enjoy myself with other men, and that Ciaran was just one of the men I had sex with.”

“Ha! I hope that hurt him.”

“It was why I’d said it, but he didn’t seem to be hurt. He was grinning like a Cheshire cat. So, as I was telling Will this, I removed my blouse and then my skirt.”

“What were they wearing?”

“Ciaran was in a suit and tie, Will had on jeans and a jumper.”

He opened his eyes, grinning apologetically. “I’m sorry, I just—”

“I get it. You like to see it in your head.” She stroked his chest. “Anyway, as you’d suggested when I rang you, I stepped in front of them

and dropped to my knees. I'd decided to start with Will, so I unzipped his jeans and took out his cock."

"Was he big?"

She shrugged. "I didn't measure or compare, but he was big enough. And he was hard. I leaned in and took him into my mouth and sucked him, watching his face as I did it. Then I pulled back and told Ciaran to get his dick out."

"You didn't undo his trousers like you did for Will?"

"No. He made some sarky comment about his dick being all I cared about. I should have bit it, but instead I sucked him for a while before moving back to do Will again."

"How long did you spend there?"

"Not long. I alternated between them, sucking each one for about half a minute at a time. Probably for about five minutes or so."

"And one of them came in your mouth."

She was puzzled, then remembered she'd told him that much when she'd returned home. "Yes, one of them did, but neither of them came at that point. I stood up and told them it was my turn for pleasure, and they manoeuvred me onto the bed."

"Still wearing your underwear and stockings?"

She nodded. "And my shoes. They stripped and got on the bed, one on either side. Then they started to stroke me, which was a surprise."

"Why?"

"I thought they'd be eager to..." She smiled and shrugged. "I'd just sucked their cocks and sort of teased them. I expected them to fuck me."

"Were they returning the pleasure and teasing?"

"Yeah, I guess. So I lay still, enjoying being stroked and fondled."

"How did they fondle you, and where?"

"Just touching me through my underwear. Boobs, tummy, legs."

"They didn't take anything off?"

She shook her head. "My bra fastened at the front, and I undid it for them. They played with my boobs and then each sucked a nipple. I closed

my eyes and enjoyed it. While this was happening, one of them fingered me.”

“Which one?”

She reached down and wrapped her fingers around his cock. It was semi-hard, the tip already slick with clear precum. “I don’t know. I didn’t open my eyes.”

“Did you come?”

“No, it didn’t go on for long. But then they both undid the suspender clips from my stockings to get my panties off.”

He looked puzzled. “Don’t you usually put your panties on over your suspenders to save you unclipping stockings every time you need to pee?”

She laughed. “Look at you, Mr. Practical. Yes, I sometimes do, but it depends on the design of the panties. I wanted to look good. When I left on Friday night, I’d only expected to sit on Ciaran’s desk and have him pull the gusset aside, so I’d put my panties on first. The detour to the hotel and the threesome hadn’t been in the game plan.”

“Ah, right. Sorry…”

She squeezed another pearl of precum from him, then leaned closer to look into his eyes. “Want me to get this inside me before I continue?”

“Be warned, I may not last until the end of the story.”

“That’s fine. I’m sure I’ll be able to coax you into going again, later.” She slipped off her panties and straddled him, watching his face as she lowered herself onto his cock.

Reaching up, he ran his fingers over her lace-covered nipples. “Take your bra off.”

She obliged and jiggled her boobs. “Happy now?”

“Very. So, they unclipped your stockings…”

“Then pulled off my panties, and—”

“Who did? Which man took them off?”

She sighed in frustration. “My eyes were closed. When fingers hooked into my waist-band, I raised my bum and they were dragged off.”

“And then?”

“Then one of them got between my legs and got into position to enter me.”

“They didn’t reciprocate the oral sex?”

“What?”

“Didn’t they go down on you?”

“No.” That hadn’t occurred to her at the time, or since. “Neither of them licked me.” She rocked her hips, trying to move things along. “I still didn’t open my eyes but, from their positions on the bed, I knew it was Will kneeling between my legs. I felt Ciaran press his cock against my face, so I turned my head and opened my mouth. Then they both pushed in.” She leaned over Julian and looked into his eyes, letting her hair drape down on either side of his face. “And for the first time ever, your slutty little wife had two dicks in her at the same time.”

Julian placed his hands on her hips to slow her movements, presumably to make him last a little longer. He took a breath. “How did it feel?”

“Slutty. Wait, does that count as a spit-roast?”

“What?”

“I had a dick in my cunt and another in my mouth, but I was on my back. Don’t I have to be on all fours with a man kneeling at each end to qualify as a spit-roast?”

“I don’t know.” He cupped her breasts. “Did you come like that?”

“Yes, but I’m not sure when. After a while, the men swapped places. I can’t remember whose dick I came on.”

Julian’s breathing grew ragged. “Did they come with you?”

He was obviously close, so she reached down and placed a finger on either side of her clit. “No, I came first. They carried on for a while, and both came pretty much at the same time. Ciaran inside, and Will in my mouth.”

Julian’s mouth dropped open and she felt his cock shudder as it unloaded. She rubbed faster with her fingers, getting herself over the line. Her contraction made him cry out, and she jerked her hips forward and back until he’d finished coming.

She lay down on his chest and kissed his neck. "I'm sorry you had to wait to hear about it."

He slipped his arms around her and stroked her back. "It was worth the wait."

She suddenly remembered the photo she'd taken of their legs. "Ooh, wait here." Within moments, she was back in bed, the picture gallery in her phone opened for him to see. He peered over at the image of three pairs of legs, men lying either side of a woman, her stockings rolled down her thighs.

"Oh, I like that." Julian sat up next to her and took her phone for a closer look. "I really like that."

"I took a couple. Click through."

He slid his thumb across the screen and brought up another almost identical image. Then a third. He looked closer and nodded. "I think this one's even better. You've moved your leg slightly, and we can now see the heel of your shoe. It's very sexy."

Nicole took the phone back and, keeping the screen out of Julian's view, slid through to the next three photos. They were all close-ups of her sex with cum seeping out. She chose the one that showed the biggest glob and then passed it back.

His eyes went wide. "Oh my word!"

"Is that sexy?"

"It's... pornographic."

She worried she'd gone too far. "Sorry, I thought—"

"No, no! It's fine." He glanced at her and smiled. "It's very sexy. And slutty. I'm just surprised you allowed anyone to take it."

"I took it myself. After I'd captured the legs, I felt stuff dripping out and on impulse, I held the phone down there and took some photos to show you."

"Thank you." He smiled and pulled her close. "How do you feel about it now?"

"The photo?"

"No, the threesome. Do you still regret doing it?"

She'd had time to get the messy ending in perspective since Friday. "No. I still resent Ciaran for how he'd arranged a surprise third party in our arrangement, but it was a unique experience."

He held her gaze. "And will it remain unique? Will it be your one and only threesome?"

A shiver ran up her spine. She could still feel the delicious stretch of both cocks inside her. "I hope not."

He smiled. "Good."

"You'd like me to repeat it?"

He gave an uncomfortable shrug. "You were upset when you got home. I like the idea of it, but I'm not going to try and force you—"

"I know, and I wouldn't allow myself to be put in that situation again. But, what I'm asking is..." She pushed her hair behind her ear and stared into his eyes. "Do you want me to take two men again?"

He held her gaze for a couple of seconds, then nodded.

"Okay." She lowered her voice to a whisper. "Maybe the next time I do it, you can be one of the men."

He stared wide-eyed, his breathing shallow. "Could you do that?"

"Of course. Up until the plumber, I'd have been more worried if *you* could. Hearing stories about me being with other men is one thing, seeing it happen is another. But since watching me from the closet didn't seem to upset you..."

He grinned. "No, it had the opposite effect. So, are you going to carry on with telling me about your night?"

"If you like." She placed her hand firmly on his chest. "But before I do, I should probably—"

"How long did you lie like you were in the photograph?"

"I don't know. Not long. Five minutes, maybe ten."

"Then what happened?"

She sighed, feeling the opportunity to give him the rehearsed spiel sliding away from her again. "I knelt on the bed and sucked them in turn to get them hard again."

"Ah. That's a rather sexy image to visualise."

“Sexy or slutty?”

He grinned. “Both.”

Nicole remembered Ciaran had videoed her sucking them both. “Actually, you don’t have to visualise it. Hang on...” She found the clip of her kneeling up and sucking Will, pressed play and handed the phone to Julian.

He held the phone and watched, breathing a little faster.

“That’s Will,” she explained. “Ciaran picked up my phone after I’d taken the photos I’ve just shown you.”

On-screen, Nicole turned to look directly into the camera as she spoke. “I hope the dirty pictures are making you hard.”

Ciaran’s voice boomed loud. “See for yourself.” The image jolted and then settled on Nicole’s face. With her eyes fixed on the lens, she lowered her head and took Ciaran’s cock into her mouth.

Deciding to treat her husband to the same, she scooted down the bed and took him into her mouth as he watched the film of her sucking Ciaran. His cock soon began to swell.

She heard herself say, “And now you can film this,” and remembered riding Ciaran’s cock while he filmed her. She bobbed her head faster on Julian, getting him fully hard. As soon as the film ended, she’d tell him what had happened next, then take out the lube and offer him to do the same.

Ciaran’s voice asked how it felt, and she’d replied that she was going to try the other cock. Julian was watching a film of his slutty wife sucking and riding two men, and his dick was as hard as she’d ever known it. The only noises coming from the phone now were her moans, and she remembered she’d moved back to ride Ciaran for a while before returning to Will.

Knowing the film was almost over, she released Julian’s cock from her mouth. Wrapping her fingers around the base of his shaft while cupping his balls with her other hand, she waited for him to put down the phone and look at her.

Ciaran’s voice said something about it being as hot and tight as he remembered.

Nicole frowned. She hadn't known he'd filmed this part. She moved up the bed and reached for her phone, but Julian held it at arm's length, never taking his eyes from the screen.

"Julian, wait—" She reached for her phone again, but he held it out on the other side of the bed. They could both see the screen, where she lay impaled on Will's cock as Ciaran fingered her backside. "Please, turn it off. I need to tell you—"

The image shook, flashing across the bedspread, the wall and the ceiling as Ciaran adjusted his position without putting down the camera. Then the shot settled on Nicole's middle section. Her legs were open on either side of Will's, his cock completely buried inside her. Ciaran's cock came into view, and Nicole watched with dread as the huge fat tip pushed against her asshole.

Julian seemed to have stopped breathing.

On screen, with frightening ease, she seemed to open around Ciaran and his cock slipped inside, though most of the shaft was still visible. The screen shuddered and changed to another view, shot from between Nicole's legs, showing her being reamed by one cock from above and another from below. Her groans and whimpers filled the room.

"I didn't know he'd filmed..."

She cringed as the screen view moved to the side, showing her upper body crushed between the two men, her eyes closed and her mouth open. She groaned, she screamed, shouted expletives and obviously experienced two powerful orgasms, then the phone was dropped on the bed. The shaky footage showed just the ceiling and both men were heard grunting over her screams as they finished.

The image stopped shaking but sounds of heavy breathing kept coming through the phone's speaker. Then the phone was picked up and aimed to show just her and Will on the bed. Ciaran had withdrawn and was kneeling by their feet. The image zoomed in. Will's cock was still buried in her, but it was withered, traces of white oozing out around it. More cum ran from her still-gaping backside. The film ended.

Her cheeks raging, Nicole remembered hearing clicks as she'd come down to earth, lying next to Will. There must be some still photographs of

them together. But that didn't matter now.

Julian passed her the phone, a coldness in his eyes.

She dropped it onto the mattress. "Jul—"

"What happened to the openness and honesty you said was so important?"

"I wanted to tell—"

"Really? So why didn't you?"

"I was waiting for the right—"

"And since it was *as hot and tight* as he remembered, I'm guessing that wasn't the first time."

Nicole opened her mouth, but no words came.

"It wasn't the first time, was it?"

She shook her head.

"When?"

"On the first night in the hotel." Her voice cracked. "Wh-when it was just him and me."

"And how long ago was that? How many nights have you decided it wasn't the right time yet?"

"I just wanted us to enjoy—"

"*You've* already enjoyed it. Isn't that all that matters?"

"No!" The accusation stung, but she tried to stay calm. "I wanted us to enjoy it together. I tried to tell you earlier, but you kept interrupting."

"You've had *weeks* to tell me!"

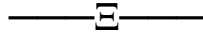
"I wanted to..." She could hardly admit she wanted to wait until he could do the same to her. She reached for him, but he got out of bed. The erection she'd lovingly brought to life had disappeared completely.

"I still have some things to prepare for tomorrow," he said as he opened a drawer in his dresser.

She didn't know if that was true, but she sat silently on the bed as he tugged on pyjama bottoms and the t-shirt he'd worn earlier. After he'd stomped out of the bedroom and gone to his office, Nicole lay back on the

pillows and cursed herself for not telling him about the anal straight away. She also regretted not watching the film before tonight.

She could see Julian's point. She'd made such a big deal out of him secretly filming her, and now she'd done something that was probably worse. He had every right to feel aggrieved.



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Chapter Two

Nicole woke alone in bed. It was still dark outside, and on checking her phone she saw it was just before six-thirty. She reached over to Julian's side. The sheets were still warm, so he must have come to bed after she'd dropped off. Just then, he walked out of the en-suite with a towel wrapped around his waist, his hair damp from the shower.

She sat up and turned on the bedside lamp. "Morning."

He gave her a weak smile and pulled on a pair of boxers before dropping the towel. Then he went to his wardrobe and took out a shirt.

"Julian, can we please talk about—?"

"We can, but not now. I need to meet Mitchell at the office at seven-fifteen."

"I was going to tell you about it. I was just waiting until—"

"I know." He sighed and pulled on his suit trousers. "Let's wait until we have time to discuss this properly. I can't set a bad example by being late." He put on his tie and didn't look at her until he'd tied his shoes.

"We're going to the north-east today, so it'll be late by the time I get back."

"Okay."

"See you tonight."

A few seconds later she heard the front door close, then his car start and pull off the drive. Closing her eyes, she lay her head back on the pillow. Although she'd handled things badly, she was still surprised by his reaction. Giving her the cold shoulder wasn't something Julian had ever done, not even after she'd cheated on him. He always approached everything with an open, thoughtful attitude, and that had been especially true regarding their new sex life.

Maybe there were other issues she wasn't aware of. Was his new role at work putting extra pressure on him? Was his reaction to her not telling

him about the anal a symptom of him being stressed in other aspects of his life?

Eventually she pulled herself out of bed, showered and dressed. Once downstairs, she made herself a cup of tea and booted up her laptop, then spent the next couple of hours working through the tasks for the day, paying for one-off purchases and making sure all the regular payments had been made.

There was an email from Ciaran in her personal inbox. A feeling of dread crept through her stomach. *Why can't he just take the hint?* Taking a breath, she opened it up.

Hi Nicole,

I trust the payment for the great work you did for us has now reached your account. I hope you buy yourself something nice with the money.

I have another request regarding what you'd told me and Will about the possibility of us needing to raise finance in the short term. Would it be possible for you to come into the office to discuss?

Thanks.

Ciaran.

Nicole sighed. At least his tone was a lot more reserved than in some of his previous emails. A quick check of her banking app showed a payment for £750. That was a lot more than she'd been expecting. She tried to work out how much time she'd spent doing the work and doubted it could have been more than ten hours. If she could earn £75 an hour in her regular job, she'd be very happy.

Deciding she had no option but to reply, she tapped out a quick email.

Hi Ciaran,

Yes, the money is there. Thank you.

I'm not sure exactly what you need regarding the extra finance, but I could come into your office one lunchtime to discuss.

Regards.

Nicole

Hopefully her stipulation of a lunchtime meeting, along with her formal tone, would leave him in no doubt that any future liaisons between them would be strictly business.

She'd barely had time to sit back down with a cuppa before he replied.

How about tomorrow?

She sent a quick reply explaining she wouldn't have time this week, and suggested Friday of the following week. That sent, she closed down her private inbox and got back to work on her real job.

During her lunchbreak, she resisted checking to see if he'd replied. Instead, she spent an hour doing some online shopping in readiness for Christmas before returning her attention to the spreadsheets that made up her working day.

By the time it got dark outside, she'd still not looked for his response. The ease with which she could ignore Ciaran confirmed he wasn't important to her anymore. She may not have yet found a new bull, but she'd certainly moved on from her previous one.

She texted Julian to ask if he wanted her to save him any dinner. He replied within a few minutes.

No thanks. I'll treat Mitchell to the delights of a Motorway Services banquet of grease, carbohydrates and additives to prepare him for life as a travelling salesman.

*Today's meetings went smoother than I expected,
and we should be leaving here soon. I may even
be home before 10.*

That sounded a lot more like the old Julian. She smiled in relief.

*Okay, I'll eat now. Enjoy your banquet!
Drive safe. See you later.
xxNxx*

When Julian trudged into the living room just after half ten, he had dark circles under his eyes. Nicole stood up and gave a smile, and he stepped close and wrapped his arms around her.

She slipped her arms around his waist and squeezed, laying her head on his chest. "I'm sorry." Tears blurred her vision.

He shushed her, running his hands up and down her back. "No, *I'm* sorry." Pulling his head back, he looked down at her. "I overreacted. I don't know what got into me."

"I should have told you. I was just waiting until—"

He kissed her forehead. "Let's put it behind us. It was a misunderstanding and nothing more. I'm sorry for behaving the way I did. I've spent the whole day regretting it."

She wiped her cheeks. "You look shattered."

"It's been a long day."

She knew he probably hadn't slept very well the night before, either. "Can I get you anything?"

"I just need to sleep."

"You go up, I'll turn things off down here."

He gave a grateful smile before heading upstairs. Nicole checked the back door was locked, then turned off all the lights and followed him up. He was taking a shower. After putting on a white vest top and clean panties, she brushed her teeth and waited for him in bed.

Julian slid in beside her and she snuggled up to him, inhaling the shower gel and his own familiar smell. He slipped his arm around her shoulder and kissed the top of her head. She lay in his embrace and listened as his breathing settled into the steady rhythm of peaceful sleep.

* * * *

Nicole woke early and slipped out of bed without disturbing her husband. She made him a coffee and took it up, kissing his cheek to wake him. Julian blinked and sat up.

She passed him the cup. "Good morning."

"Hi." He frowned and checked his watch. "Sorry, I was dead to the world."

Sitting on the edge of the bed, she stroked his leg through the quilt. "I've never seen you look as tired as you did last night."

He nodded. "It was a long day, with much of it driving through roadworks and traffic jams."

"And you didn't get much sleep the night before, either."

He gave an embarrassed smile. "Well, that serves me right."

"We'll talk about that later, but if you need to be in the office for nine, you'd better make a move as soon as you've finished your coffee."

"I don't have any meetings this morning, so I'll work from home. I'll write up the outcome of yesterday's meetings, then go into work this afternoon to catch up with Mitchell."

"Okay." She considered mentioning that today would be his first meeting with Ciaran since her threesome but decided against it.

He read her expression and smiled. "I'm not avoiding anyone at the office, if that's what you're thinking."

Nicole laughed. "Good. Speaking of Ciaran, he's paid me for my bookkeeping."

"Really? So he's been in touch?"

"He emailed to say the money should be in my account. I got seven hundred and fifty quid."

“That seems pretty good money.” He grinned. “Just under a hundred pounds per orgasm.”

She slapped his arm, laughing. “He’s also asked about another task, so I’ll go and see him next week.”

“Okay.” He didn’t say anything else, but she could tell from his expression that he was wondering if Ciaran would be able to charm his way back into her affections.

“I’ll see what work he wants me to do,” she said. “Nothing more.”

He nodded.

Nicole couldn’t tell if he was pleased or disappointed. “Since you don’t need to rush out, would you like me to make us a cooked breakfast?”

“No, I think it’ll take my body until Spring to metabolise the fat from last night’s dinner.”

“That good, eh?”

“A slice of toast and another coffee would be perfect.”

Nicole headed back downstairs and made them breakfast. Julian joined her wearing pyjama bottoms and a t-shirt. They sat at the kitchen table.

“Are you working today?” he asked. Her part-time schedule was much more fluid now she was working from home.

She shook her head. “No, they’ve asked if I can work tomorrow instead. There’s some management meeting today, and the outcome of that will have financial implications that I’ll need to be aware of.” She brushed toast crumbs from her fingers and picked up her cup. “If another lockdown happens, which seems likely, then they’re going to have to decide if they furlough staff or actually make some redundant.”

He nodded his understanding. “Yes, worrying times.”

“Maybe I could come and work for you.” She smiled. “I have some nice skirts and blouses, and a wide selection of lingerie that’s perfect for the office.”

He guffawed. “If you were to join our workforce dressed how you did for your meetings with Ciaran, I’m pretty sure production would grind to a halt.”

“Your team’s all men, right?”

He nodded.

“How many?”

“Six, though we’re never all in the office on the same day.”

She narrowed her eyes and took her lower lip between her teeth for effect. “Mmm, six men.”

Julian held her gaze, then sighed. “As I’ve said many times, you’re quite a distraction.”

“Really?” Nicole looked down at herself. She’d pulled on a pair of dark blue leggings and still wore the white vest top she’d slept in. She wasn’t wearing a bra.

“Oh, I think you know you are.”

“How am I a distraction?” She slipped the straps of her vest off her shoulders and pulled the front down to expose her breasts.

He took a breath, then looked up into her eyes. “I don’t know. Perhaps I’m being too critical, but something about your demeanour makes me think your presence in the office wouldn’t be conducive to a high-functioning environment.”

She ran her fingertips around her nipples, making them stand out. “I’m not sure what you mean...”

“I doubt that.”

She widened her eyes in mock-innocence. “You’re using management-speak and HR-babble—*so* many long words that I find hard to follow. What exactly are you saying?”

“I’m saying that the presence of a beautiful woman in an off—”

“And sexy.” She pulled at her nipples, enjoying the fact he couldn’t resist dropping his gaze to look at them.

“Yes, a beautiful *and* sexy woman in an office full of men wouldn’t —”

“*Six* men, you say?”

“Yes, six—” He paused as she closed her eyes. “What is it?”

She opened her eyes and looked at him. “I was just imagining giving myself to six men.”

His jaw dropped.

She stood up and walked around to his side of the table, rubbing her bare breasts against his shoulder. “I’m going to go upstairs. I’m going to take all my clothes off and lie on the bed. I’ll wait for five minutes, and if you don’t come up and join me, then I suppose I’ll have to take Denzel out of my drawer and use it to satisfy myself.”

Without another word, she left the kitchen and headed upstairs. She stripped, took the KY from her drawer and put a large blob on her finger. Lying on the bed, she reached down and smeared it around her bum-hole. She added another glob to her finger and repeated the action, this time pushing in a little to lube inside. Then she put the tube away and took out the black vibrator she’d christened Denzel, dropping it onto the mattress beside her. She still hadn’t used it, so if Julian didn’t join her in the next few minutes, she might be forced to christen it in another way.

Her husband appeared in the doorway. He walked to the foot of the bed and stared down at her, his eyes flicking to the vibrator. “If you’re still fantasising about six men, I’m happy to wait in line while you take one of the others first.”

She was surprised by his initiated roleplay but happy to go along with it. “And what will you do while I take the first one?”

He blinked and licked his lips. “I’ll just watch. We both know how much I like to do that.”

Spreading her legs, Nicole ran her hand down her body and stroked her fingers either side of her outer lips. She could feel the wetness there already. “And what exactly will you be looking at?”

“Him, stroking your body. Groping your tits, then running his hand down between your legs. I’ll watch him stroke his finger through the wet, slick valley of your cunt.”

Nicole clenched involuntarily. *Where has this come from?*

“And then, when he pushes two fingers into you, my eyes will go up to your face. I’ll watch your mouth drop open and your eyes squeeze shut, and I’ll hear your breathy sigh when his thumb finds your clit.”

“Julian, get on the bed.” She reached for him. “Put your dick inside me. Now.”

When he pushed his pyjama bottoms down, his cock sprung out, straight and hard. Nicole gripped his shoulders as he guided himself into her. She cried out as he sank all the way in, then bit his neck when he began thrusting. He raised his upper body and pinned her arms down on the mattress above her head.

Looking into her eyes, he fucked her. “I wait patiently while the first man fingers you, but I can tell you want more than that. You want his cock.”

Nicole stared at him, struggling to believe this was her sweet, shy husband.

“I tell him it’s not enough.” Julian maintained the slow thrusts of his hips and the calm voice of his roleplay. “Fingers might be all a puppet needs inside it to make it come to life, but you’re not a puppet. I explain that you’re a slut, and sluts need cock.”

She desperately wanted to join in with this game, but she could hardly breathe. Rocking her hips beneath him, moving with his thrusts, she nodded. “I need cock. Tell him I need his cock.”

“I watch him unzip and take it out...”

“Is he big?” Her voice was a hoarse whisper. Her legs were starting to tremble as she moved towards orgasm. “I hope he’s big.”

Julian swallowed. “Yes, he’s big. Long and thick. I worry for you a little because it’ll probably hurt.”

“I want it to hurt. I want him to split me open.”

Julian ploughed into her with slow, deliberate thrusts. He was showing a level of self-control she’d never seen before, and it thrilled her. “He places the huge tip of his cock between your lips. I’m torn because I want to see it stretch and fill you, but I also want to watch the expression on your face when he enters you.”

“Oh God! Julian...”

“He pushes in and makes you shriek. My eyes are drawn to your face. Your expression is a wonderful mix of emotions. Shock and gratitude. Agony and ecstasy...”

“I’m coming...”

“That’s exactly what you tell him. His big cock plunges in and out and I watch as you scream and thrash beneath him.”

Nicole wanted to see him but struggled to keep her eyes open. She wanted him to know how much he’d stimulated her. She sobbed several times, then forced herself to ask one more question. “Does he come with me?”

“Yes.” Julian released her wrists and brought his hands to her breasts. “He comes in your cunt while you writhe beneath him.” He pinched her nipples and Nicole screamed with her release, gripping the sheets, pushing her head back into the pillow and arching her back.

The orgasm shook her like an earthquake, every nerve-ending tingling with the aftershocks. It seemed to last a long time, and as the sensations ebbed away, she became aware of his cock still buried inside, and still rigid. He hadn’t come yet.

She opened her eyes and looked at him. He smiled down, his expression one of embarrassed smugness.

“Thank you.”

“Any time.”

She placed her hands on his hips and pushed him gently. He frowned but withdrew.

“So,” she said, her voice still raspy after the exertion, “I’ve had the first guy. He fucked me good, and you saw how much he pleased me.” She glanced down at his dick, slick with her juices. “But he’s no longer here. He’s come and gone, as it were.”

Julian smiled at the way she’d said it.

“Now I’m ready for the next man, and that’s going to be you.”

“I know.”

“How many more are waiting?”

He shrugged. “I’m not sure. Three or four, maybe.”

“Are they watching, too?”

He nodded. “Some have their cocks out and are playing with themselves. They may not last long enough to go inside you.”

She licked her lips. “That’s fine. They can shoot it over me. But you...” She pushed him away enough so she could bend at the waist and raise her legs. She placed them over his shoulders. “You’ve waited patiently because you want to go inside me.”

He nodded.

“You can come over me later with the others if you like, but I want your first shot inside.”

“I’d like that, too.”

Nicole lifted her bum off the bed, inching her feet further down his back. “But the first guy’s just filled my cunt. You’re going to have to use somewhere else.”

His eyes widened as she reached around her raised right leg and gripped his slippery cock. “I want you to fuck me in a different hole.” She pulled him closer. When his cock touched the entrance of her backside, she wondered if he could feel the coldness of the KY.

“Are you—?”

“Don’t break the spell. Please.” She flashed an encouraging smile. “I’ve had one guy come already, and now I want you to come in me as well.”

Julian stared into her eyes and pushed forward, opening her up, filling her. She sighed, relishing the feeling.

Once he’d got about halfway in, he held still. “Is that okay?”

She rocked her hips, moving herself on him. “It’s much better than okay.”

He moved his hips slightly forward and back. “Oh gosh.”

She watched his face, feeling herself opening more, taking him deeper. “Does it feel good?”

He nodded, breathless. “What about for you?”

“Feels wonderful. Fuck me.”

Taking a breath, he began to thrust his hips. His eyes were half-closed, and he was breathing through clenched teeth.

Nicole slipped her hand down her sex. “To show what a slut I am, I’m going to play with myself while you fuck my arse. And after I’ve come

on my fingers and you've come up there, I'm going to move on to the next guy."

Julian's breathing became ragged.

Nicole wet her fingers with her juices, then ran the slick fingertips around her clit. "And since he's the third guy, he gets to use my third hole. I'll take him into my mouth. You can watch me suck him..."

Julian's legs began to shake.

He was already past the point of no return. She rocked her hips faster, making him gasp. "You'll hear him moan and see my cheeks bulge out when he fills my m—"

"Ahh!" He pushed deep and her insides bloomed with heat as he came. Nicole rubbed her clit and came with him, both of them groaning, panting and shaking.

When they finally stilled, Julian looked shellshocked. He slowly pulled out and eased her legs from his shoulders.

"Let's go for a shower," she said.

He helped her up and they walked hand in hand to the en suite.

Under the water, she shuffled up against him. "You surprised me in there."

"I surprised myself, but not as much as you surprised me."

"That's how I wanted to tell you about it. I wasn't hiding things. I was waiting until we could share it like that. I wanted to show that when we do it, it's more than a sex act."

Julian kissed the top of her head.

"I'm sorry you found out by watching me do it with someone else."

He wrapped his arms around her and held her close. "I understand that, and I'm sorry for behaving the way—"

She placed her finger to his lips. "It was a misunderstanding, nothing more."

He nodded.

She squeezed shower gel into her hand and washed his cock. He let out a sigh as she cleaned him. Gripping his shaft, she slowly rubbed her

soapy palm over the tip. “Why did you pretend you were part of a gangbang?”

He shrugged. “The discussion over breakfast sparked something.”

She laughed. “Well, it certainly worked for me. I guess if I’m not going to be getting fresh cock for a while, this is a good way to keep it exciting.”

“How long do you think it’ll take you to find a new bull?”

“I have no idea. There are websites I can use, but for now, I’m happy to just take things slow.” She held his cock against her tummy. “Especially now I know you can talk me through fantasies.”

“That’s good, because I have an idea for another one.”

“Oh?” Nicole stood on tiptoe and kissed his cheek. “And what’s that?”

“I thought we could recreate the threesome you had, using Denzel.”

A shiver ran through her as she remembered the exquisite sensation of her DP with Ciaran and Will. “I think that’s a great idea.”

Smiling, he hosed himself off. “Now, I really need to do some work. I need to show Mitchell how to write up meetings and use the algorithm.”

“Okay. You’re clean, so if you get out now, I’ll wash my hair.”

Once dressed, Nicole made Julian a coffee and wandered next door to invite Liz for a walk.

She rang their doorbell, waited for about thirty seconds, then rang again. She was just about to return home when the door opened.

Liz wore a long bathrobe. “Hi Nicole. Sorry, I was in the shower. D’you want to come in?”

“No, I just came to tell you I’m going for a wander down the paths. You asked me to let you know when I’d be going again.”

“Yeah, I’d love to. Can you give me half an hour?”

Nicole nodded. “See you in in a bit.”

Thirty minutes later, Liz showed up on her doorstep dressed in jeans and a big fluffy jumper. “Here’s my card with my mobile number.”

“Cheers—next time I can text rather than interrupt your shower.” Nicole left Liz’s number in the kitchen and went to grab her coat. They

walked down the road and followed the route through the fields and woods, chatting like old friends about their plans for Christmas.

“I’m hoping my mum can come and stay,” Nicole said. “What are you two doing?”

“My parents are going to my sister’s house because she has three kids. We’re going to see Ed’s parents for the day.”

The walk took them almost an hour, and as they trudged up their road, Nicole saw Julian’s car still on the drive. “Fancy coming in for a coffee? You can meet Julian. He’s working from home this morning but going into the office later.”

Once in their kitchen, Nicole proudly used their posh gadget to make two cappuccinos. She called to Julian, who came downstairs and smiled at their visitor.

“Hi, Liz. Nice to meet you,” he said.

“You too.”

“Want another coffee, hon?” Nicole asked.

“No thanks. I need to be on my way.”

He headed back upstairs, and the women wandered through to the small sitting room, settling together on the leather Chesterfield couch.

“I love this room,” Liz said, looking around and through the window to the side garden.

“Me too. I’ve commandeered it as my office. I can’t wait for summer so I can get out in the garden.”

Just then, Julian popped his head in to say goodbye.

They drank their coffee and chatted a little longer, and then Nicole mentioned that Julian was going to London the following week for a meeting.

“Why don’t you come around one evening and have dinner with us?” Liz suggested. “It’ll be better than sitting in on your own.”

“Thanks, I’d like that.”

“When’s he away?”

“The latter half of the week, I think.”

“Shall we say Thursday, then?”

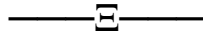
“That’ll be great.”

After Liz had headed home, Nicole spent the afternoon pottering around in their house, trying not to think about Julian and Ciaran meeting at work.

She needn’t have worried. When he arrived home, Julian said he’d only seen Ciaran briefly, and that they’d discussed a couple of work projects but nothing more.

“Like I told you,” he said, “we’ve never discussed what goes on between the two of you. I don’t see why you not seeing each other would be discussed, either.”

She smiled, then headed off to serve dinner.



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Chapter Three

On Saturday morning Julian picked up the huge Christmas tree they'd ordered, and Nicole spent the afternoon dressing it. She had to go out and buy more fairy lights and decorations because their previous tree had been tiny by comparison. When finished, it made their living room look cosy. They spent the evening cuddled together on the couch watching TV and drinking hot mulled wine.

Nicole was tipsy when they went to bed and keen to maintain the closeness they'd shared all week. She didn't want roleplay or kinky sex, just to make love with her life partner. Julian caressed and kissed her, then eased himself on top. She whimpered when she came and sobbed when he did. They fell asleep in each other's arms and slept in late on Sunday.

On returning from work on Monday evening, Julian said the details of his trip had been finalised. He'd drive down to Head Office on Wednesday afternoon, spend Thursday and Friday overseeing the roll-out of his algorithm for all sales staff, then drive home Friday evening.

"Okay. I've been invited next door for dinner on Thursday night."

"I'm glad you're finding friends here—Liz seems nice."

"Yeah, she is. Have you remembered that I'm also seeing Ciaran on Friday?"

He gave a smile. "Of course I've remembered. How do you feel about it?"

"I'm not sure. I don't want to make a scene, but he needs to understand there'll be no repeat of what's happened in the past."

"Yes, quite." He stood up from the table. "Right, I just need to sort a few things out in the office—"

"Before you do that, can we discuss Christmas?"

He nodded and sat back down.

"Are you sure it's okay for my mum to come and stay with us?"

“Of course. The rules seem clear about the size of the bubble—”

“Yeah, I know, but that’s not what I mean. I don’t want to steamroll you into staying here so my mum can visit without checking if you wanted us to go and visit your parents.”

“No, let’s stay here. We can catch up with my folks in the Spring. It looks like another lockdown’s inevitable.”

“Thank you. Next, is there anything in particular that you’d like for a present? I have a few ideas for little things, but I wondered if there was anything in particular you wanted?”

He pursed his lips in thought, then nodded. “Walking shoes. If we’re going to spend time at weekends exploring, it’d be good to have the appropriate footwear.”

“Great, I’ll start searching online.”

“How about you? Anything you’d like?”

She scrunched up her nose. “Maybe a well-hung stud to help you spit-roast me.”

He nodded sagely. “I’ll see what I can find on Amazon.”

She laughed and stood to clear the dinner table. While he worked in his office, Nicole sat in the lounge with her phone and opened the gallery. She clicked onto the photos she’d taken during her night with Ciaran and Will. Julian had liked the pictures that showed the three sets of legs on the bed. She found the one that showed the heel of her shoe and uploaded it into the photo-editing app. She trimmed it to a square, then chose a monochrome filter that made it look really sexy. Her phone took better photos than any of the cameras she’d ever owned, and the definition of the picture was certainly good enough to get a large print for Julian’s office wall. She sent the jpg to an online printer and ordered a 500x500 frame to go with it.

Having found a good pair of walking boots for Julian and other bits and bobs for him and her mum, she went upstairs to find him still working at his desk. “Hi. How’s it going?”

“Slowly.” He flashed her a smile. “I need to set a few things in motion because I’ll be away from the office for a couple of days.”

“That’s fine. I might have a bath.”

He nodded. "Okay."

She remembered them being in this situation before. "If you're going to have a wank, make sure the door's closed this time."

He guffawed. "If I find myself getting too aroused by the sales figures, I'll walk along to the bathroom and relieve myself over your wet, slippery body."

A shiver ran up her spine. "Well, I can see you're busy—but in the not too distant future, I'm going to hold you to that."

"I'll look forward to it."

* * * *

After her shower on Thursday evening, Nicole pinned up her hair and put on minimal makeup. She pulled on black jeans, a grey angora jumper and flat shoes, picked up the lilies and bottle of sauvignon blanc she'd bought, and walked to her neighbours' house.

Liz opened the door, thanked Nicole for the flowers and wine while admonishing her for buying them, then ushered her into their living room.

Ed stood up from his armchair to greet her. "Nicole, good to see you again."

"Hi."

"White wine?" Liz asked.

"That'd be lovely, thanks."

Once all were seated in the living room, they made small talk until dinner was ready then headed through to the dining room. Nicole enjoyed the food and the company, spending a very pleasant hour laughing and chatting while eating.

"So," she said, "how long have you guys been married?"

Liz replied. "It'll be seven years next month."

"Similar to us."

Ed took a sip of wine and smiled. "I actually got married thirty years ago this month."

“Really?” Nicole looked at Liz, then back at Ed. “I hadn’t realised you’d been married before.”

He nodded. “Serial offender. What can I say?”

Liz giggled. “Ed has a son from his first marriage.”

“Oh. Does he live close by? Will you meet up over Christmas?”

“No, he’s in the army. He’ll be spending Christmas in Afghanistan.”

“Oh wow. That must be hard for you.”

He gave what looked like a forced smile. “I think it’s harder for him, but he’s nearly at the end of his time there. His regiment is returning in March.”

“Was Julian married before?” Liz asked. Then she smiled. “I noticed he’s a bit older than you.”

“He’s fourteen years older but no, I’m his only wife to date.”

Liz smiled and nodded toward her husband. “He’s thirteen years older than I am, the dirty cradle-snatcher.”

Ed snorted. “I don’t think I can be accused of cradle snatching—you were thirty-three when we got married.”

Nicole did the calculation. “So you’re forty-one?” she asked.

Liz nodded.

“The same age as Julian.”

Ed obviously did his own calculation. “Which puts you at twenty-seven.” He grimaced. “Which makes me exactly twice your age.”

“Aww...” Liz patted his hand. “Don’t worry, baby. Men get better with age, like a good whiskey.”

Nicole nodded. “It’s true.”

“I hope you’re right,” Ed said with a smile.

Back in the lounge, Liz revealed that Ed’s company was actively involved with a children’s charity, and that he’d dressed up as Father Christmas a couple of years back to distribute presents to kids in hospital.

“Ah, that’s nice.” Nicole noted his flat belly appreciatively. He must have needed a lot of padding.

Liz smiled. “I thought he looked very sexy in his red suit and big black boots.”

Ed snorted again. “The trouble with being Santa is, he only gets to come once a year, and then it’s down a chimney.”

“Yeah,” Nicole said with a laugh. “But at least he gets to completely empty his sack.”

The other two looked at her with startled expressions.

Nicole put her hand over her mouth. “Sorry, was that a little too—?”

Liz burst out laughing and put her hand on her leg. “You don’t need to hold anything back while you’re here. I can see we’re going to get on fine.”

Relieved, Nicole smiled. “I blame the wine.”

They chatted for another twenty minutes or so, then Nicole announced she should be getting back home. “I do bookkeeping for someone who has a business in Ireland, and I’m meeting him tomorrow to talk about another task he wants me to help with.”

After Nicole had bid Ed goodnight, her hostess walked her to the door. “We’ll do this again,” Liz said.

“Definitely,” Nicole agreed. “I’ll cook next time, though if there’s going to be another lockdown after Christmas we might have to eat in the garden.”

Liz gave her a hug. “I suspect I’m in for another sleepless night.”

Nicole laughed, a little uncomfortable. “Is that a good thing or a bad thing?”

“It’s good. I’ll enjoy every minute of it.” She ran a finger down Nicole’s cheek. “You’re beautiful, and I don’t blame Ed for getting excited by you.”

“But...” Nicole shrugged. “Doesn’t it bother you?”

“Not at all.” Liz leaned close and whispered, “Our marriage is a little different from most.”

Holding her friend’s gaze, Nicole bit her lip. “So’s ours.”

“That’s good to hear. I look forward to sharing more secrets with you.” Liz hugged her again. “Maybe we can go for another walk before

Christmas?”

Nicole nodded, then walked back home. Once in her kitchen, she grabbed a bottle of sparkling water from the fridge and sat down at the island. She checked her phone for texts and found a short, formal one Ciaran, asking if tomorrow’s meeting was still convenient. She replied with a simple ‘Yes’, then composed a text for Julian.

Hi

Just got back from next door and had a lovely evening – great food, great company and too much wine. Hope your day has been good, and you’re not still working.

Let me know what time you’ll be getting home tomorrow. I’ll cook you something nice.

xxNxx

She turned off the downstairs lights and checked the deadlock on the front door, then retired to bed. Lying in the dark, Nicole thought about what Liz had said when she’d left—how different was her neighbours’ marriage? Was it open? Were they swingers? Was Liz also a hotwife?

One thing *was* certain: Liz would be having a lot more fun than her tonight.

Closing her eyes, she let her mind drift to what might be happening in the bedroom next door. She imagined Ed laying his wife down on the bed and removing her bra and panties, kissing each part of flesh as it was revealed. Then climbing on top and...

Nicole sat up and opened the bottom drawer of her bedside cabinet. Taking out Denzel, she lay back down and quickly slipped off her panties. Closing her eyes, she brought back the image of Liz and Ed in bed, him looming over her and swiping the tip of his cock through her folds. Nicole flicked the switch on Denzel and held the buzzing shaft against her clit. She let out a groan.

She pictured Liz looking up at her husband with a teasing smile, asking him who was responsible for the erection he was rubbing against her.

Ed asked if it mattered and she shook her head, pulling him into her.

Nicole swallowed, then eased the vibrator inside. She sighed, took a deep breath and rocked her hips as she slid it all the way in. *This isn't going to take long.*

Rolling over onto her front, she gripped the end of the vibrator and thrust her hips. She clenched her teeth and groaned through her orgasm, then rolled onto her back and pumped the toy in and out until she came again.

Sated but a little shocked by her reaction to Liz's whispered confession, she flicked the switch, eased Denzel out and wrapped it in her panties. She couldn't be bothered to get another pair from her dresser and lay in the dark naked from the waist down as her heart slowed. Then she picked up her phone and sent Julian another text.

*I wish you were here, but Denzel's just taken
care of me :-)
xxNxx*

Fifteen minutes later, she heard her phone beep. Though almost asleep, she picked it up. Julian had replied.

*Just got back to the hotel. I read your text while
sharing a taxi with two colleagues, and
struggled to hide my reaction. What a wonderful
image to keep in my head. Thanks.
Good luck with your meeting tomorrow.
xx*

Nicole smiled and put her phone down, wondering if her text would motivate Julian to pleasure himself as well. All this from a simple comment made by Liz. It showed how inspirational sex talk could be.

* * * *

When Nicole walked into reception at the GLP office, Ciaran was waiting for her on one of the leather and chrome chairs. He stood as she approached, offering her a smile and his hand. “Nicole, good to see you.”

“You too.” She was pleased that he frowned at her outfit: a deliberately modest combination of cream fluffy jumper, jeans and Cuban-heeled ankle boots.

He already had her visitor’s badge and led the way upstairs to the office where they’d shared so many exciting liaisons. Bernice wasn’t at her desk. Ciaran let Nicole walk into his office first, then closed the door behind them.

She sat on the chair opposite his desk, and he perched on the closest edge of the desktop, wearing a friendly smile. “Thanks for coming in. So, I’ve been thinking about what you’d said regarding the potential shortfall in company cashflow with the change in focus from selling to leasing.”

She nodded. “And?”

“And I was thinking it might be prudent to have a word with our bank about setting up an overdraft facility to cover that shortfall.”

“I assumed you’d already have that sort of arrangement. Wouldn’t you need it to cover salaries for the months when you don’t make any sales, or if customers are late making payments?”

“At the end of each year, we pay a Christmas bonus and then have a celebratory dinner for all staff in January.”

“That’s nice.”

“And since you’ve been a part of the team this year, I thought it’d be nice for you to join us.”

She wasn’t sure she liked where this was going. “For the celebratory dinner?”

He nodded.

“And where does this take place?”

“Galway, where all the other employees live.”

“You want me to go with you to Galway?”

“Well, not just Galway. The company accounts are with a bank in Dublin, so I thought we could kill two birds with one stone. Rather than fly to Shannon, we could take my car on the ferry to Dublin, go see the bank manager to make the financial arrangements, then drive over to Galway.”

Nicole didn't answer immediately. Though the idea of a trip to Ireland was nice, she didn't trust Ciaran. A few weeks ago, an offer like this would have been wonderful. “I'm not sure if that's a good idea.”

“Why not?”

“How long would the trip take?”

“Just a couple of days. We could drive to either Liverpool or Holyhead to catch a ferry. I'll book an appointment at the bank, because having you there would show the manager we have a financial genius working with us.”

“I don't think any bank manager would be impressed by someone who simply does bookkeeping.”

“Don't sell yourself short. You'll impress him, especially if you dress in one of your power suits and high heels.” Reading her expression correctly for once, he held up his hands. “Believe me, having you there for the meeting would be a great help. We'd spend the night in Dublin... Have you ever been?”

She shook her head.

“It's a fantastic city, then—”

“And where would we stay?”

“I'll book a hotel.”

“We'd need two rooms.”

He paused, holding eye contact, then nodded. “Of course. And then we could drive over to Galway the next day.”

“How far is it?”

“About a hundred and twenty miles. It'll take a couple of hours or so, and you'll get to see the country. We have the celebratory dinner in a great restaurant near the harbour, and you can meet the rest of the staff.” He grinned. “And you'll get to see Will again.”

She sighed. “If you're expecting—”

“No, nothing like that. This is purely business. You’ll get your own hotel room.”

“What about travel restrictions? Another lockdown looks likely, and there’s no way I’m going into a fourteen-day quarantine with you.”

He laughed and shook his head. “That’s something I’ll have to check up on, but hopefully our scheduled bank meeting qualifies our trip as business-critical.” He gave another grin. “Maybe I won’t mention the dinner, but say I’ll need to go to Galway to discuss the outcome of the bank meeting.”

The alarm bells were ringing loud enough to make her head swim. This entire trip was clearly an excuse for the two of them to end up in a hotel together. “I’ll have to think about it,” she said.

“Great. Talk it over with Julian. I’m sure he’ll agree that having someone with financial experience will be seen in a positive light by the bankers.”

“Hmm.”

He laughed at her response, then nodded at her clothes. “I see you’ve dressed down for today’s meeting.”

“I thought it’d be more appropriate.”

“More appropriate for...?” He gave her a smile that might once have made her tingle.

“More appropriate for a work-related meeting on casual-dress day.”

“Ah, yes. Though I’d hoped you’d spend some of your earnings on something nice.”

“I did. I’ve ordered a new mirror for the bathroom.”

“A mirror?”

She nodded. “With LED lights.”

“LED—”

“And Bluetooth speakers.” She smiled sweetly.

“I was thinking more along the lines of a dress and new shoes, maybe.” He flashed another grin. “Some nice lingerie.”

“Ciaran, if I were to buy those, you wouldn’t be the one who’d benefit from them.”

He scoffed. “Nicole, I don’t understand why you’re still behaving like such a ball-breaker.”

“I think you know exactly why.”

“I was there, don’t forget.” He leaned forward and looked into her eyes. “I saw how much you enjoyed it.”

“Yes, but I didn’t enjoy how you’d set it up. You made me feel uncomfortable, and you made me feel cheap.”

He shook his head. “I didn’t *make* you do anything. Taking cock is what you do best, and taking two at once was your decision.”

Her heart thumped in her chest, but she was determined not to let him see he’d upset her. “Yes, it was.”

“And it was my cock that you came on, remember?”

“Yes. And if you’d had the decency to mention what you were planning beforehand, we might have had more fun together.” She shook her head. “That won’t happen again, Ciaran. But thanks for the glowing endorsement—‘taking cock is what you do best.’” She shook her head. “Jesus, and they say that romance is dead. But you’re right. I *did* enjoy taking two at once, so it’s something I may well repeat in the future.” She made her voice as icy as she could manage. “But it certainly won’t be with you. From now on, all you’ll be getting from me is bookkeeping. If you’re not happy to accept that, find someone else to do the accounts.”

“Okay, okay. Calm down.” He walked around his desk and dropped into his office chair. “Jeez, Nicole. I didn’t mean it as an insult.”

She stood up. “Well, I guess this meeting’s run its course. While a trip to Ireland sounds fine, I can’t honestly see that it would be considered a necessary trip during a global pandemic.”

“Leave that to me.” He stood up and walked to the door but didn’t open it. “Well, I suppose I should wish you a Happy Christmas.”

“Thanks. You too.” She nodded at the door. “If you wouldn’t mind, there are things I need to do before Julian comes back from his trip to Head Office.”

Ciaran sighed, opening it. “Nicole, what we had was special, and I don’t want to—”

“I know.” She looked deep into his eyes and kept her expression serious in the hope the message would penetrate his skull. “It *was* special, but you ruined it. And I’m afraid there’ll be no going back to what we had.” She walked past him and headed down the corridor, calling over her shoulder, “I can find my own way out.”

Ciaran followed her as far as the top of the stairs. She didn’t look back before going through the door to reception. After handing back her visitor’s badge, Nicole walked out to her car and drove off the carpark. She knew she wouldn’t come back to see Ciaran here again.

Once home, she made herself cheese and biscuits and poured a glass of white wine. She ate her lunch on the leather couch in the small sitting room while reading the news on her phone. Then she tapped out a quick message to her neighbour:

Hi Liz

Just wanted to thank you again for last night. I had a really nice time.

I hope you managed to get some sleep :-).

Nicole x

Smiling to herself, she hit send. A couple of minutes later, she received a reply.

Hiya

You’re welcome, but I should be thanking you.

Your comment about Santa emptying his sack meant I was awake for quite a while!!

I look forward to discussing our secrets when we go for a walk.

Liz

Nicole grinned, wondering if she’d have the courage to admit to her neighbour what she got up to with Julian’s blessing.

Her phone beeped again. It was a text from Julian saying his final meeting was scheduled to end by four, and that he'd be home around seven-thirty.

Deciding to enjoy a lazy afternoon, she topped up her wine and wandered through to the lounge. She found a Christmas film on Netflix and settled down on the couch to watch it.

* * * *

Not having heard Julian's car pull onto the drive, Nicole was surprised when he walked into their kitchen shortly after seven. "Hiya," she said, walking over to kiss his cheek. "You're early. I've only just put dinner in the oven."

He smiled as he placed his briefcase on the floor, then wrapped his arms around her waist. "Traffic was lighter than usual—the only positive effect of the pandemic."

"Can I get you a beer, or would you prefer wine?"

He gave her his familiar grin then walked to the hall, coming back a few moments later with a bunch of orange roses and a bottle of champagne. The last time he'd done this was after he'd been put forward for a promotion.

"Are we celebrating?" she asked.

"I celebrate every time I see you."

She took the flowers. "That's sweet. But what are we really celebrating?"

"Maybe I was just so happy that the traffic was light that I decided to stop and buy these." He grinned. "Or maybe I wanted to celebrate you finally using the special gift I bought you."

She frowned, regretting telling him she'd pleased herself with her vibrator.

"Or... maybe it's because after Christmas I'll be starting a new role."

"What?"

“I’ve been promoted again.” His eyes lit up. “They seem to think my algorithm is making a significant impact and want me to look into some other processes to see if I can come up with ways to streamline the way we do things.”

Nicole couldn’t believe it. “Ciaran never mentioned anything about it.”

“He probably doesn’t know. It’s a role they’ve just introduced, and what’s more…” He gave her another smile. “Ciaran will no longer be my boss.”

“Really?”

He nodded. “He’ll now be my peer.”

“Wow.” She shook her head and stepped close, tilting her head up to kiss his cheek. “Congratulations.”

“Thank you.” His expression of boyish happiness faded a little. He looked apprehensive.

“What’s up?”

“Once this pandemic is out of the way, the new job will involve considerably more travel.”

“Oh, that’s fine.”

“Sure?”

She gave a teasing smile. “I have a lovely big house to sit in while you’re suffering all the Motorway Services banquets.”

“I think it’s more likely I’ll be eating on airplanes. The new role will involve helping overseas branches as well as UK ones.”

“Oh dear. Don’t they know you’re afraid of flying?”

“It’s not flying I’m afraid of. It’s crashing.”

She laughed. “Will you be going anywhere nice?”

He slipped his arms around her waist. “Europe and the US, possibly China. And I see no reason why you can’t accompany me on some of the trips. We’ll be able to afford an extra plane ticket with my new salary.”

“There’ll be more money?”

He grinned. “Oh yes.”

Nicole was speechless. This was all like a dream.

Julian stroked her back. "I know you like some aspects of your job, and that you've got friends within the company, but there's actually no need for you to carry on working if you don't want to."

She blinked. "I'm not sure I like the idea of being a free-loader."

"Oh, I'll make sure you contribute." He dropped his hands to her bum and squeezed her buttocks. "I'll demand my pound of flesh."

"I like the sound of that. But what about me?" She batted her eyelids. "Will I still be allowed to get my pound of flesh from wherever I want?"

"Certainly." He pushed his groin into her tummy. "The more the merrier."

"Hmm. Hold that thought until after we've eaten."

He laughed, releasing her from his grip. "I'll go and get changed. The champagne was in a chiller but doesn't feel very cold. Pop it into the freezer for ten minutes, and then you can tell me about your meeting with Ciaran as we wait for it to cool."

"Do you want a beer while you're waiting for the bubbles?"

"Good idea."

While Julian was upstairs, Nicole put the bottle in the bottom drawer of the freezer and checked the dinner. It needed longer in the oven.

She topped up her white wine and opened a beer as Julian walked in wearing his pyjama bottoms and a t-shirt. "I see you've dressed for dinner," she said, smiling.

"It's casual-dress day."

"Heh. That's exactly what I told Ciaran." At Julian's quizzical expression, she described how she'd dressed for the meeting.

"Was he disappointed you weren't in your usual attire and killer heels?"

"I think he was more disappointed when I told him he'd never get to see my sexy lingerie again."

"Come and give me the details." He led her into the lounge, and they sat together on the couch.

Nicole told him about Ciaran's proposed trip to Ireland. "He assures me there's a need to see the bank manager in Dublin, and says he'd also like me to go to an annual dinner with the other employees."

"It might be nice to meet everyone."

"Yeah, but you know Ciaran. I suspect there's an ulterior motive that involves non-business activities."

"Ah, right."

"How do you feel about it?"

"As I've said before, I'm happy for you to do whatever you're comfortable with."

"You'd be happy for me to go to Ireland with him?"

"I'd be happy if you chose to sleep with him. Or Will. Or anyone else, for that matter." He took her hand in his and squeezed it, his face serious. "But only if it's something *you're* comfortable with. Don't let anyone pressure you into something you don't want."

"I definitely won't be having sex with Ciaran." She nodded, more to herself than her husband. "Will, maybe." She smiled. "I'll see how I feel at the time."

"When would the trip happen?"

"That's the thing. I don't know if it will because of the travel restrictions. Ciaran seemed to think a trip to see the bank manager makes it business-critical, but this sort of thing is usually carried out online. It's simply a matter of applying for a larger overdraft facility, which is why I think he's inventing excuses to take me to Galway with him."

Julian nodded. "I can understand your misgivings."

"Come on," she said, standing up. "Let's eat, and you can tell me all about your new role. If you take cutlery through to the dining room, I'll plate up dinner."

While they ate, Julian explained that GLP had several offices in the US, the largest ones being in Delaware and Boston, and several in Europe, with Strasbourg and Budapest being the ones he'd probably need to visit first.

“Who told you about your promotion?” she asked between mouthfuls.

“Keith. Apparently, during a videoconference between higher managers last week, the use of the algorithm was discussed. It was decided to implement trials in other countries to see if it works for them as well as it does for us.”

“I’m so proud of you.”

He gave another embarrassed smile, then dabbed his mouth with a napkin. “Changing subject slightly, when’s your mum coming over for Christmas?”

“With the ever-changing policy from Downing Street, I’m not sure. I’ve suggested she drive down early on Christmas Eve and stay until after lunch on Boxing Day. But there are rumours that they’ll limit visits to just Christmas Day.”

“She can’t be expected to drive all the way from Durham and back again in a day!”

“I know—she’s expected to stay home alone if she can’t make the return journey. That’s why everyone’s up in arms about the way it’s being handled.”

He tutted. “Let’s see what happens.”

Once they’d carried their plates through to the kitchen, Julian took the champagne from the freezer and two glasses from the cupboard. “And now,” he said, tearing off the foil from the cork, “we can toast your first date with Denzel, and you can tell me all about it.”

Nicole laughed. “What goes on between me and Denzel is private, unless I choose to let you watch.”

He removed the cork and poured their drinks. “That hardly seems fair.”

“Well, Denzel will be staying in my drawer tonight, because you’ll be giving me what I need.”

“Will I?” He smiled down at her as she stepped close.

“Mm-hmm.” She ran her hand over the crotch of his pyjama bottoms. “Unless you’re too tired from your late night and long drive...”

“I think I’ll manage to rise to the occasion.”

“Good. Come on,” she said, picking up her glass. “Let’s go and sit in the lounge and enjoy the bubbles.”

Once they were snuggled up on the couch with the only light coming from the fire and the Christmas tree lights, Julian asked about her visit to their neighbours’ house.

“It was lovely, and I’ll invite them round as soon as we can.” She told him about the food she’d been served, that she drank more wine than usual, and that Ed had an adult son from his first marriage.

“I think he and Liz might have some sort of open marriage arrangement,” she said.

“Really? What makes you say that?”

“Just stuff Liz has said.” She sipped her wine. “You remember me saying that after he’d seen me dressed up—?”

“He kept her up all night, yes.”

Suddenly, she felt a little embarrassed. “Well... she said the same would happen after my visit last night.”

“What did you wear?”

“Nothing.” She shook her head. “And by that, I mean nothing that would have excited him, not no clothes.”

He laughed. “You look sexy no matter what you wear.”

“Thanks, but according to Liz, it was something I said. Ed’s company’s involved with a charity, and one year he’d dressed as Father Christmas to visit kids in hospital. He made some joke about Santa only ever coming down a chimney, and I pointed out that he gets to empty a full sack.”

He laughed and shook his head. “Well, what do you expect if you talk dirty?”

“If it helps gets my friend laid, I’m not going to complain.”

“Was it the thought of Ed being all revved up by you that made you feel the need to pleasure yourself with your vibrator when you got home last night?”

She stared at him, surprised he'd worked that out so quickly. "Is that bad?"

He smiled. "Not at all." He ran a finger down her cheek. "Did you pretend it was Ed's cock inside you?"

"No." She shook her head, then shrugged. "Not really, but I imagined him fucking Liz while I fucked Denzel."

"They sound like very open-minded people. Have you told Liz about our arrangement?"

"No."

"And will you?" He gave a friendly smile.

"Would you want me to?"

Julian shrugged. "While I wouldn't want to advertise it in the local Gazette, I don't think it's anything to be ashamed of. And if they're like-minded people, there could be an opportunity to have some fun."

"Hmm." A tingle ran through her. "Do you find Liz attractive?"

"I find a lot of women attractive, but my only focus is on you. I don't want to sleep with other women."

Nicole frowned. "That doesn't seem fair to you."

"It's what I want. *You're* all I want."

"And do you want me now?"

"Here?"

She nodded.

"What do you want me to do?"

"Nothing." She took his glass and put it next to hers on the coffee table, then slipped off the couch and knelt on the floor between his feet. "You've had a hectic week at work, getting promoted and working late into the night."

"That's true." He raised his bum off the seat as she pulled down his PJs.

"And then there was the long drive home this evening..."

He nodded, then shivered when she ran her tongue up the length of his thickening cock.

She watched his face. “So I think you should just sit still while I do all the work.”

“I think I can manage that.”

Nicole took him into her mouth, making him sigh. He was fully hard in less than a minute. She quickly removed her jeans and panties, then straddled his thighs and fed him inside.

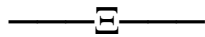
Julian groaned and held her hips as she rode him. She leaned forward and kissed him, then gripped his head and rocked her hips. She came quickly, and he lasted long enough for her to build towards a second orgasm. When he finally came, she came with him. They clung to each other as their bodies shuddered.

Eventually, Nicole sat up and stroked his face. “Maybe I could give you that sort of welcome home after every trip.”

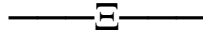
“It’d certainly help take my mind off flying.”

She laughed, pulled her panties back on and sat next to him. Picking up both glasses, she offered a toast. “To your wonderful algorithm.”

Julian laughed out loud, then sipped his champagne.



Ψ



Chapter Four

“Are you all ready for Christmas?” Nicole asked, holding open the gate into the woods.

“Yeah, just waiting for a couple more things to be delivered. Ed’s mum’s ordered all the food online, so I won’t need to face crowded supermarkets and fight over the last bag of sprouts or parsnips.”

“I still have that to look forward to.”

“You said your mum’s coming, is that right?”

Nicole nodded.

“No dad?” Liz looked concerned.

“He’s still alive, but I don’t have anything to do with him.” She shrugged. “Don’t ask.”

“Okay.” Liz linked her arm into Nicole’s and pulled her close. “So, these secrets we have...”

Nicole looked at her friend, who was smiling broadly. “Secrets?”

Liz laughed. “It’s okay if you don’t want to share.”

“I didn’t say that. It’s just... I’m not sure how to—”

Liz squeezed her arm. “That’s fine. How about I tell you how it works with me and Ed?”

Nicole nodded.

“We both sleep with other people, so I suppose it’s an open marriage. Ed’s had several sexual partners since we’ve known each other, but I have some intimacy issues and only sleep with one man.”

“Oh?”

“I’ve been sleeping with him for over twenty years.” When she saw Nicole’s expression, she gave a sad smile. “He was married when I started sleeping with him.” They walked in silence for a few steps. “I know how

that makes me sound, but it wasn't some seedy thing. He was everything the boys I'd been out with before weren't, and he swept me off my feet. I fell for him. I loved him, and I still do."

"Wow."

"When I started seeing Ed, I told him about John—the other man. Ed accepted it and said it wasn't a problem. When he asked me to marry him, he said I could continue to see John."

"And Ed sees other people to even things up?"

"I'm not sure it's a revenge thing, but yes, he sees other women. Some he's seen over a period of time, others are just one-night stands."

"And do you two tell each other about what you do?"

"No. At least not in any detail. Sometimes he'll tell me certain things, like he once met a woman while attending a meeting in Germany, and they ended up having sex in a toilet at the airport just before they boarded different planes. She was French."

"Is John still married?"

Liz shook her head. "His wife knew about us, and she didn't mind. It was a complicated situation. She had medical issues, and they couldn't have a physical relationship. She died five years ago. They couldn't have kids, and now John's all alone."

"He still has you."

Liz smiled. "Yes, he does. So...?"

Nicole wasn't quite sure where to start, so she kept things simple. "Our arrangement is a little different, and it's something that's only started happening recently."

"Okay."

"I'm the only one who has other partners. While Julian's happy for me to sleep with other men, he claims to have no interest in sleeping with other women."

Liz bounced her eyebrows playfully. "Would I be right in thinking he wants to hear about what goes on between you and the other men?"

Nicole nodded. "He also likes to watch."

“Oh my.” She pulled Nicole close. “I guess that means you’re a hotwife.”

“Apparently so.”

“God, Ed will blow a gasket when he hears about this.”

Nicole laughed out loud and slapped her friend’s hand. “I thought we were sharing secrets.”

“Do you keep secrets from Julian?”

“No.” She remembered their argument about her having anal with Ciaran. “I tell him everything, now. It’d be wrong not to.”

“Exactly. And I tell Ed everything about John—if he asks. But he stopped asking for details a long time ago.”

Nicole nodded. “Are you surprised? About me, I mean.”

“Not really. There’s something about you that’s sexual. The way you move and hold yourself. The way you dress when you’re going out.”

“Oh *God!* Remember the first time I met Ed, when I was dressed like an escort?”

Liz nodded.

“I wasn’t meeting girls from work. I was meeting the guy I was having sex with.”

“Well you looked fabulous, and he’s a very lucky man.”

Nicole briefly considered telling her what Ciaran had arranged for that night but decided against it. For now, at least. She’d already shared more than she’d expected.

They walked on in comfortable silence, and when they started chatting again, the subject moved back to Christmas and more mundane things. After their walk, they drank coffee sitting at the patio table in Nicole’s garden.

Liz stood up to leave. “Right, I should be getting back. If I don’t see you before we leave for Ed’s parents’, I hope you have a lovely Christmas.”

“Thanks. You too.”

As the women hugged, Liz whispered, “Thanks for sharing your secret.”

Nicole bit her lip, then smiled. “It felt weird actually telling someone.”

“I’m glad you did.”

Then, to Nicole’s complete shock, Liz leaned in and kissed her gently on the lips. The women held eye contact for a few moments afterwards, then Liz smiled again and walked up the garden path and around the house.

Nicole stood motionless, a little stunned, and licked her lips. She could taste the other woman’s lipstick. There was a low-level buzz in the pit of her stomach. Not sure how she felt about what had just happened, she walked back into her house and put the mugs in the dishwasher.

To save the need for going out while Julian was off work, she decided to do the Christmas food shop. When she arrived home she found a card pushed through the door: a parcel had been left behind the garage. As soon as she saw it, she knew it was the photo she’d ordered for Julian. She took it into the house, opened it and smiled. It was fantastic. She was shocked how sexy her legs and shoes looked, but proud of how sharp the image was. Taking photos wasn’t usually something she did particularly well.

By the time Julian returned from work, she’d put all the food away, wrapped all the presents and put their dinner in the oven. He was in a good mood, and his team had bought him a thirty-year-old bottle of malt whiskey as a going away gift.

“Of course,” she said. “It never occurred to me that you’d be saying goodbye to your team. Who’s taking them over?”

“They’ll become part of Ciaran’s team in the short term. I guess they’ll see what happens when things get back to normal.” He frowned. “All areas have been asked to make cuts, and a niggling little voice at the back of my head keeps telling me that my new position is helping this. By using algorithms and similar programs, the company can reduce the number of data-entry employees.”

“It’s progress, I guess.”

“I know, but can’t help feeling a little guilty.”

* * * *

Nicole's mum arrived as planned in the early afternoon of Christmas Eve. She loved their house, displaying a fresh expression of awe in every room.

The two women eventually sat on the high chairs at the island in the kitchen while they drank tea. Julian had nipped into town for something, and Nicole suspected he'd left it until the last minute to buy her a present.

They had an early dinner in the dining room, then Julian watched TV while Nicole and her mum chatted away on the couch. He retired to bed around eleven to let them catch up properly.

"Julian's changed," her mum said.

"Hmm. I much prefer the short hair and beard to the comb-over and moustache."

"Not just that. He does look different, but he acts differently, too. He's less... Well, he's more in control, somehow."

"Yeah, I know what you mean." Nicole had no intention of suggesting their new sex-life might have contributed to the change in her husband. "I think he's finally being appreciated for what he does at work, and that's had an effect."

"Good." Her mum smiled. "He's always been nice, but something about him now makes him seem more..." She shrugged.

"I always saw this side of him," Nicole said. "But I know his shyness made it hard for other people to see it."

"It's nice to see you both so happy. Right, I'd better let you get to bed, otherwise Santa won't be coming down your chimney."

Nicole laughed, thinking about Ed's comment. She hugged her mum, then tidied the glasses away before going to the bedroom. Julian looked up from his novel and smiled.

She brushed her teeth in the en suite and slid into bed in her vest-top and panties. She leaned close and kissed his cheek. "Mum thinks you've changed."

"I suppose I have."

“She also loves our new home.”

“Not enough to come and live with us, I hope?”

“No, stop panicking.” She laughed, then turned serious. “Can I ask you something?”

“Anything.”

“It’s about the other day, when we were in bed having sex.”

He laid his book face-down on the duvet. “You might have to be more specific.”

She smiled. “I’m talking about when you described being one of several men waiting in line to take your turn with me.”

“Ah.”

“Where did that come from?”

“Like I told you at the time, it was based on your comment about joining all the men in our office. Comments like that tend to make my mind wander.”

“It turned me on.”

“Having six men at once?”

“No—well, yes—but I meant you talking to me like that while you fucked me. It was incredibly sexy.”

“Thank you.”

“Can we do it again sometime?”

“Definitely. Or maybe I could do it while you’re using Denzel.”

“Hmm.” All her muscles clenched at once, and the mention of Denzel brought to mind her reason for using it. “I meant to tell you, I went for a walk with Liz the other day.”

“Oh?”

“She told me about their arrangement. They have an open marriage, but she only sleeps with one particular guy. She’s been seeing him for most of her adult life.”

“And what about her husband? Does he just only see one other woman?”

“No, he sees several. Some long term, some one-night stands.”

“And he fancies you.”

Nicole looked into his dark eyes. He was smiling.

“And do you fancy him?”

“I hadn’t thought about it.”

He chuckled. “You can’t expect me to believe that.”

Nicole smiled and shook her head. “No, I suppose I can’t. Yes, I find him attractive. Even though he’s exactly twice my age.”

“And did you tell Liz about our arrangement?”

“Yes.”

“What did she say about what we do?”

“Nothing, really.”

Julian looked at her expectantly. “Is this where you’re going to politely ask me if I would condone you sleeping with the man who lives next door if the opportunity were to arise?”

She held his gaze. “Would you?”

“Of course. Do you think Liz would approve?”

“I’m not sure. But just before she left, she kissed me.”

“Kissed you?”

“Hmm.”

“Where?”

“In the garden.”

Julian rolled his eyes. “You know what I mean.”

“Oh, sorry. On the lips.”

“Ah.”

“It was just a peck, nothing more. But...”

“But what?”

Nicole shrugged. “I’m sure it was nothing more than a friendly gesture, but after what happened with Ciaran, I wanted to tell you it had happened.”

He pulled her down next to him and kissed the top of her head.
“Thank you.”

“If you want to abuse my body, put a pillow over my face so my mum can’t hear my moans.”

“I’ll wait until your mum’s gone home—I love hearing the noises you make.”

She kissed his neck. “Okay, I promise I’ll be vocal then.”

* * * *

Julian woke Nicole with a cup of tea. “Merry Christmas.”

Smiling, she sat up. “Thanks, same to you.” She took the cup from him. “Is Mum up yet?”

He shook his head.

“Okay. I’m going to do eggs benedict for breakfast.”

“Wonderful.”

Nicole slipped out of bed and walked to her wardrobe. She took out the wrapped photograph and passed it to Julian. “You’re going to have to open this one here. It’s not really suitable for Mum’s eyes.”

Looking intrigued, he sat on the bed and unwrapped his gift. As the picture was revealed, he smiled broadly. “That’s wonderful.”

“I thought you could put in on the wall in your office.”

“Am I allowed to masturbate while I look at it?”

She was shocked into laughter. “Only if I can kneel in front of you while you do it.”

He took a deep breath. “I’d love that.”

She held his gaze. “Me too.”

Julian studied the photograph closely. “Did you get the printers to make it black and white?”

“I did it all on my phone. Trimmed it to size and chose the filter. I tried sepia and a few others, but that was my favourite.”

“It’s fabulous, and incredibly erotic.” He held it out at arm’s length. “How do you feel about it now? I mean, how do you feel about what you’d experienced just before you took that photo?”

“Physically, it’s a nice memory.”

He nodded. “Good. Just keep thinking of the physical side of it.”

* * * *

Nicole had a wonderful morning. Her mum loved her gifts and told them off for spending too much on her. Julian tried on his walking shoes and played gleefully with all the other gadgets she’d bought him. He’d bought her a long fluffy dressing gown and matching slippers, which she put on over her leggings and vest-top.

Finally, he handed her a small, gift-wrapped box. “This is your main present,” he explained.

Nicole looked at it, then glanced at her mum who shrugged to show she didn’t know anything about it. Julian had always claimed ignorance when it came to jewellery, so Nicole had wondered if he’d asked her mum’s opinion.

“Before you open it,” he said, “I think we should go outside.”

Nicole frowned, but he was already walking towards the hall. *Maybe it’s something for the garden.*

He opened the front door and strode out. Nicole and her mum followed, both still wearing dressing gowns and slippers.

Julian walked to the garage, then nodded towards the doorhandle.

Nicole smiled, now certain he’d bought her something like a birdbath or statue. She turned the handle and swung the door upwards. Her jaw dropped and she heard her mum gasp.

In the middle of the double garage, facing out, was a Mini. It was metallic pale blue with a white roof. She turned to look at Julian, who was grinning from ear to ear.

“You’ve bought me a *car*?”

He nodded. “I couldn’t help noticing that yours looked a little tired compared to all the others down this road.”

She looked back at the Mini, then opened the gift box, which held a key fob. On pressing the button, the indicators flashed and the doors

unlocked. She opened the door and sat in the driver's seat. It smelled of leather and carpets. "Is it brand new?"

He nodded again, still grinning.

"I've never had a new car before."

Nicole's mum climbed into the passenger side. "I've never known anyone to get a car for Christmas."

"Me neither." Nicole still couldn't believe it. She got out of the car in a daze and walked all around it. It was a Cooper S, which meant it was the sports version. Climbing back in, she started it up; the engine sounded throaty. She smiled at her mum. "Fasten your seatbelt, we'll go for a spin."

"But I've only got my dressing gown on."

"Me too. Let's hope we don't break down." As Julian stepped to one side, Nicole drove slowly out of the garage and down the drive. She took the car for a short drive around the estate, marvelling at the way it handled and its acceleration. Less than five minutes later, she'd parked neatly and flung her arms around her husband's waist. "Thank you."

"You're welcome."

"Can we afford it?"

"Yes."

After Julian had closed and locked the garage door, Nicole linked arms with her husband and mother as they headed back towards the house. "Come on, we've got Bucks Fizz to drink before breakfast."

Her mum laughed. "So this is how the other half lives."

A boozy breakfast was followed by a late lunch, then Nicole and her mother watched *It's a Wonderful Life* for the umpteenth time, both of them dabbing their eyes by the time the credits rolled up.

As ever, Julian went to bed while the women stayed up talking. When Nicole finally joined him in bed, he was already asleep. She spooned him from behind, still unable to believe he'd bought her a car, let alone managed to get it in their garage without her seeing anything.

* * * *

After Nicole's mum had left on Boxing Day, Julian suggested a walk to try out his new shoes. It was a clear, cold day and they spent almost two hours walking hand in hand around the now familiar trail. Back at home they ate cold turkey sandwiches while listening to music. After they'd finished, Nicole took her husband's hand and pulled.

"Where are we going?" he asked, standing up from his chair.

"Bed. You're going to talk to me while Denzel satisfies me. And then I'm going to show you how grateful I am for my new car."

He grinned. "Maybe I could wear my new walking boots."

She laughed and led him upstairs. She stripped naked and lay on the bed, resting on her elbows. "Get Denzel out."

Julian found the vibrator in the bottom drawer of her bedside cabinet, then sat on the edge of the bed and held up the toy.

She took it from him, fond memories of the only occasion she'd used it flashing through her mind. After placing the tip against her outer lips, she flicked the switch. Denzel buzzed to life and made her quiver. "Tell me a story."

Julian looked down at her. "I've been away on business, but managed to get an earlier flight home."

She stared into his eyes, marvelling at how easily he could conjure this up. Six months ago, he'd get tongue-tied trying to explain the type of dress he wanted her to wear.

"You're not expecting me home until the evening. When I pull onto the drive, there's a car I don't recognise. I surmise that you have a visitor. I try to remember if you'd told me who you were seeing." He smiled. "We've gotten into the routine of you having a date while I'm away. It's entertainment for you in my absence, and also provides things for you to describe when I get home."

She sighed. "I like that idea."

"Me too." He reached down and gripped her wrist, then pulled it up slightly, guiding the first couple of inches of Denzel inside her. "I open the front door quietly, not wanting to disturb you. I assume you're in the bedroom and intend sneaking up to my office and waiting in there."

Nicole watched his face, her insides already tingling in anticipation of her release.

“As I approach the stairs, I hear you moan. But the sound’s not from above—it’s coming from the room you use as an office. I see the door is slightly ajar, and I imagine you bent over your own desk in the way you used to bend over Ciaran’s.”

“Please tell me it’s not Ciaran.”

He smiled and shook his head. “No, he’s the past. This is someone else.”

Nicole nodded. “Go on.”

“I know I should go upstairs and wait, because once he’s gone, you’ll sit on my cock and tell me all about it.”

Nicole rocked her hips and slid Denzel deeper, letting out a long sigh.

“But the open door is too much of a temptation. I’ve watched you before, and I know how wonderful you look when you’re having sex. I put down my briefcase and tiptoe along the hall and peer through open door. It turns out that you’re both lying on the rug, but I can’t see much. Your upper bodies are hidden behind the couch, your feet obscured by the door. All I can see is two pairs of legs from knees to waist. One pair’s still in trousers, but yours are bare. So is your sex. A hand is busy between your spread thighs, and I watch you writhe and hear you moan. I can smell your juices from the hall. You arch your back and beg to have your nipples sucked.”

Nicole’s legs began to tremble, her breathing shallow and unsteady.

Julian leaned down and kissed her forehead. “It’s only then that I notice how small the hand is, and the arm is slim and has no hair.”

Nicole stared at him, puzzled.

“And I realise it’s not a man you’re entertaining.”

Her eyes fluttered and she frowned at the twist in his story.

“I’m watching you being finger-fucked by a woman and, as she brings you to orgasm, you scream—”

“Ahhh...” Nicole rammed the vibrator deep and arched off the bed, stabbing herself time after time as she came. She grunted, then slipped it out

and dropped it onto the bed. She pulled Julian on top of her, yanking his t-shirt up and off, then grappling with his zip. “Get your dick out. I want—”

She gripped his cock and guided him into her, wrapping her legs around his waist and rolling them both onto their sides. Nicole thrust her hips, scratched his arms and pulled his hair. She came again, a sharp, intense spasm that wracked her body.

Pushing him onto his back, she clambered on top and ground her clit against him as she shuddered and moaned. Julian reached round and pushed a finger up her backside. Nicole yelped and arched her back, then came for a third time. She bounced up and down with force, relishing the feeling of his cock and his finger invading her at the same time. She growled obscenities, calling him a dirty bastard and herself a slut and then, with an overwhelming feeling of fulfilment, she welcomed the gush of his orgasm as he flooded her. She wriggled her hips from side to side, then rocked in small circles until his cock stopped pulsing.

After hiding from his gaze for a few moments, she slowly lifted herself up until his cock and finger slipped out. She shuffled up the bed on her knees and held herself over his waist, then clenched her muscles. Julian looked down and watched as she squeezed out his cum. It dribbled onto his stomach, soaking into the dark hair.

“Sit on my face,” he whispered.

She shook her head. “Not this time.” She lowered her crotch onto his stomach and began to gyrate her hips, spreading the cum over his tummy. She felt more of his stuff ooze out and continued smearing the mixture of their combined juices all over his belly and her thighs. She rocked faster, grinding her clit against his sternum, the wiry hairs tickling the soft, sensitive skin around her cunt. Her legs began to shake again. She gritted her teeth and stared down into his eyes.

Before she could get over the final hurdle, he flipped her off him and onto her back, then roughly pushed three fingers into her, making her squeal. When he dropped his head and took her clit between his lips, she exploded. Flashes illuminated the insides of her eyelids and shockwaves convulsed her body, her feet kicking as if she were being electrocuted.

With her back arched and her head pushed back into the pillow, Nicole let out a final, guttural groan. Julian released her clit from his lips and withdrew his fingers, then sat back on his haunches. She opened her eyes and looked at him, his trousers tangled around his knees and his chest hair a matted mess.

He ran his hand down her leg. "You're amazing."

She let out a sigh. "That was all you. That was..." She shook her head. "I've never come like that before. Nobody's ever..." She let out a long, ragged exhale. "Your story. What made you think of that?"

He shrugged. "I know I need to find ways to keep it fresh. To push buttons."

She laughed. "You're pushing buttons I never knew I had."

"Your comment about Liz kissing you made my mind wander."

"I'm sure it was just a friendly gesture." *Liar.*

"It doesn't matter. It worked for my story, and it's a nice scenario to think about."

"You like the idea?"

"Very much." He narrowed his eyes. "Do you?"

She held his gaze for a moment, then sighed. "God, what am I turning into?"

He guffawed. "I need a shower. Someone seems to have used me as a rubbing post."

She ran her hands through the sticky mess on his stomach. "I'm not sorry."

"Neither am I."

While Julian went to clean up, Nicole lay on the bed for a couple of minutes to get her breath back before joining him. They slowly washed each other, and she avoided his eyes as she spoke. "If I were to do anything with Liz, would you mind?"

"Of course not."

"What about if I were to do something with Liz *and* Ed?" She looked up to gauge his expression.

“I wouldn’t mind that, either.” He tucked a strand of wet hair behind her ear. “Why, do you think it’s a possibility?”

She shrugged. “I’ve no idea. They’re the first couple I’ve ever met who admit to having an open marriage. I just wanted to know what you thought, before—”

“Whatever happens, it’ll be fine with me.”

“Thanks.” She kissed his chest. “But I don’t think anything will happen.”

“I’m not sure either of us believe that.”

* * * *

Over the next few days, the wet weather prevented them from going on any more walks, though they did take Nicole’s new car for a longer drive. She loved everything about it. Julian explained that someone would be collecting her old car to take to the auctions in the next few days. He’d bought his parents a tablet for Christmas, and they had a Zoom meeting with them. Neither of his parents commented on his beard.

They spent New Year’s Eve at home on their own, which was the first time they’d done that since they’d met. When someone further down their road set off fireworks at midnight, they took their glasses of champagne into the garden and watched. Nicole checked to see if Liz and Ed were outside, but there was no sign of them.

Once the fireworks had finished, they headed back into the lounge. All the talk in the papers and on the TV that day was about how everyone would be glad to see the back of 2020, Covid’s devastating death toll, and the shattered economy.

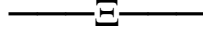
“With all the negative reviews of this year, I feel guilty for being so fortunate,” she confided as they snuggled back down onto the couch.

“I know what you mean. This year will be a black spot for many people when they look back, but for us...” He smiled. “It’s been life-changing.”

“What will 2021 bring, I wonder?”

“More of the same for us, I hope.”

She raised her eyebrows. “And maybe more variety, too.”



$$\Psi$$

Chapter Five

Nicole had been asked to go into her employers' office for a meeting on the day that Julian started his new role. It was the first time she'd been there in more than nine months. The employees gathered in the company canteen, where all the tables had been pushed to one side and all chairs, though spaced further apart than usual, had been lined up in a way that reminded her of assembly at school. She looked out for Sam, the man she'd had a brief fling with eighteen months ago, but couldn't see him.

As the managing director made his way to the makeshift stage at the front, everyone fell silent. His expression was solemn.

Nicole listened as he thanked them for coming in and then explained that the board had been left with no alternative but to make some painful decisions. They would need to cut the workforce by twenty percent. She glanced around, seeing sad eyes and creased brows over the facemasks in the audience. After thanking everyone for their service and apologising yet again, he left the stage to the noise of almost ninety chairs being pushed back. Everyone stood up and headed for the door.

Nicole went up to her old office and chatted with a couple of women in her work group. Their line-manager, Ian, joined them and said that while he hoped to retain everyone in his team, some might be asked to do fewer hours.

"I could do that," Nicole said, after seeing Tracy's face fall.

Ian gave her a wan smile. "Thanks, but you're already part-time. We might need to ask more people to do the same. At least for a while."

Nicole thought Tracy might cry. Her husband worked on the factory floor, so he might be out of a job altogether. "I'm happy to be laid off until things pick up again."

"We're not sure if the furlough scheme will—"

"I'm not asking to be furloughed. Just suspend my contract until this thing's over. Then I'll come back, though I'd like the chance to keep

working remotely.” She smiled. “It’s much easier to sit in my jammies all day and not worry about putting on makeup and doing the commute.”

“Okay, I’ll mention it,” he said. “But I don’t want to lose you from the team.”

After he’d wandered off to talk to other people, Nicole stayed and chatted for a few more minutes before leaving the office and walking along the path towards the car park. She sensed someone behind her. When she turned, she came face to face with Sam. “Hello stranger,” she said with a smile.

Fortunately, they’d managed to maintain their friendship after Nicole had called a halt to their lunchtime trysts. She’d enjoyed the excitement but had felt too guilty to continue the affair.

“Hi.” He stopped a couple of paces away. “How are you?”

“I’m good, thanks. You?”

“Yeah, great.” Frowning, he looked around at the site. “Worrying times.”

“Yeah. Will your job be safe?”

“I hope so, we have a baby on the way.”

“Ah, that’s lovely. When’s it due?”

“April.”

“Well, congratulations. And I really hope things work out with the job situation.” Nicole gave him a warm smile and walked away, wondering if she’d ever meet him again.

Once on the open road, she turned the music up loud and revelled in the pleasure of driving her new car. When she got home she headed into the kitchen and put the kettle on. Before it had boiled, her phone pinged.

Hi Nicole

HNY !

*Just seen you get back — fancy coming over for
a coffee?*

She replied with a thumbs up emoji and headed next door.

Liz was waiting on her porch. “Hiya. Happy New Year.”

“Thanks. You too.” They hugged with a closeness that made Nicole shiver slightly.

Liz nodded toward Nicole’s drive. “New car?”

Turning to look at the Mini on her drive, she nodded. “Yes. It was a Christmas surprise.”

“It’s fabulous. Come on in.” They walked through the hall and into the kitchen. “How come you’re all dressed up?”

Nicole glanced down at her white blouse, black trousers and high heels. “I wouldn’t call it dressed—”

“I love your hair pinned up. You look great.” Liz filled the kettle from the tap.

“Thank you. I had to go into the office today for an announcement. There are going to be job cuts as a result of the Covid situation.”

“Oh no. Are you at risk?”

“I actually volunteered to take a break. Julian’s just been promoted again, and some of the girls I work with need the job more than I do, so I offered to become a lady of leisure for a few months.”

“Ooh, I like the sound of that. A lady of lei—s-u-u-u-re.” Liz narrowed her eyes. “Maybe ‘lady of pleasure’ would be more appropriate for you, though.”

Butterflies fluttered in Nicole’s stomach. “Hmm.”

Liz stepped closer. “I thought about you a lot over Christmas.”

She stared into Liz’s eyes, aware that their boobs were almost touching. Nicole felt her nipples tighten, and her mouth became dry. “I’ve thought about you, too.”

“And what in particular did you think about?”

The kiss. Nicole swallowed. “I wondered if you’d told Ed about our shared secrets. And I wondered if he’d kept you awake as a result of our conversation.”

Liz smiled. “Yes, and yes.” She glanced down at Nicole’s mouth, then back into her eyes.

Nicole hoped she was going to kiss her again, and her heart thumped in her chest.

“Did you tell Julian about our secrets?”

Nicole wondered at first if Liz meant their shared kiss, but then realised she meant their open marriage. She nodded.

“Good.” Liz traced her fingertips along Nicole’s upper arm, sending tiny electric shocks down her spine. “I love the feel of this blouse.”

Nicole smiled, but what she really wanted was for Liz to keep stroking her. And not just her arm: her shoulders, back, tummy. Tits. She realised she was holding her breath.

Liz stepped back as the kettle clicked off. “Coffee or tea?”

“Coffee, please.”

Liz poured their drinks and tilted her head toward the door. “Shall we go through to the lounge?” Without waiting for an answer, she walked out of the kitchen.

Liz sat on the couch and patted the cushion next to her. Nicole placed her cup on a coaster on the small side table, then sat down next to her friend and crossed her legs.

“I have a confession,” Liz said as she turned to face her, bringing her knee up onto the seat between them. “I was as much to blame as Ed for us not getting much sleep.”

“Oh?”

“It was something you’d said, about...” Liz frowned, as if embarrassed.

“About what?”

“About what you do, and—”

Nicole was enjoying her friend’s sudden attack of shyness. She leaned closer and lowered her voice. “What I do?”

“When you’re with another partner...”

“Hmm?”

“You said Julian likes to watch.”

Nicole felt her sex clench. She wondered if Liz wanted Julian to watch the two of them. “Yes he does. It turns him on, gets him all worked

up.”

Liz took a breath, then licked her lips. “I’ve never watched anyone having sex.”

“Neither have I.” She grinned. “I’m always the one having sex.”

“I can understand that. You’re so beautiful.”

Nicole leaned closer still. She was desperate for another kiss, but afraid to initiate it. “You’re pretty hot yourself.”

Liz giggled, then looked over to the door. “Hey, you.”

Nicole turned, shocked to see Ed. He wore jeans, a chequered shirt and carpet slippers. He also had on a pair of black-framed reading specs. “Hi, Ed. Happy New Year.”

“Hi Nicole,” he said, smiling and removing his glasses. “I didn’t hear the doorbell. Did you have a good Christmas?”

“Very nice, thanks, though it was odd not being able to go anywhere other than shopping for food.”

As he nodded his agreement, Liz leaned forward. “Nicole got a new Mini for Christmas.”

“Oh?”

“Don’t get all excited,” Liz warned him. “It’s a car, not a skirt.”

Nicole grinned. “Santa came in my garage this year.”

Ed laughed out loud, and Liz elbowed her in the ribs. “Stop it, you’ll give him another hard-on.”

Nicole turned and stared at her friend, who looked embarrassed by her own comment.

“What I meant was, you’ll... He’ll...” She looked up at her husband. “Help me out here.”

He shook his head. “It’s all your own doing. I’ll get myself a coffee.”

After he’d gone to the kitchen, Nicole turned to Liz. “I didn’t realise Ed was home.”

“Is it a problem?”

“Of course not.”

“Good.” Liz sat closer and inhaled. “I love that perfume you’re wearing.”

“Thanks, it’s...” Nicole found she couldn’t remember what she’d sprayed on that morning, and neither did she care. Liz’s face was so close, her eyes half closed and mouth slightly open. Nicole leaned in and kissed her softly on the lips, then pulled back. The women stared at each other. Nicole wondered if Liz’s heart was thumping as hard as her own.

Just at that moment, Ed returned with a mug of coffee and sat in the armchair. Nicole wondered if he could sense the charged atmosphere.

Desperate to find something to talk about, she nodded toward the French doors leading to their garden. “Did you see the fireworks on New Year’s Eve?”

“No, we actually had an early night...” He glanced at his wife, then looked down into his cup.

Liz giggled. “Don’t worry, I’ve already told her how little sleep we’ve been getting.”

Ed looked uncomfortable and glanced at Nicole.

Liz reached out and stroked Nicole’s arm. “I’ve also admitted how much I like the idea of doing what Julian does... Watching.”

Nicole looked into her friends’ eyes, then glanced at Ed. He looked as surprised as she felt by his wife’s admission.

“I can imagine how sexy you must look,” Liz whispered, her eyes fixed on Nicole’s.

Though self-conscious in Ed’s presence, Nicole couldn’t deny the heat that bloomed between her legs and which diffused through her entire body. “Would you only want to watch?”

Liz opened her mouth, then closed it again and nodded. “Like I told you, I have some intimacy issues...”

Nicole reached out and took her hand. “Maybe I could help you get over them?”

Flashing a nervous smile, Liz nodded. “I’m sure you could, but for now...” She freed her hand and used it to undo the top button of Nicole’s blouse. “I just want to watch.”

Nicole held her breath and sat perfectly still, allowing her friend to unfasten all five buttons of her blouse. Purposely not looking at Ed, she kept her eyes fixed on Liz's face.

Liz pulled open the blouse and looked down at Nicole's bra-clad breasts and stomach, then turned to her husband. "Isn't she beautiful?"

He nodded his agreement.

"Come and see her up close."

Nicole swallowed the lump in her throat, unable to believe what was happening. That she was actually letting it happen.

Ed put down his cup, dropped off the chair and slowly crawled across the carpet. He stopped with his knees by Nicole's feet, his gaze resting inside her gaping blouse.

Liz ran her hand down Nicole's arm. "Would it be okay if I asked Ed to take your trousers off now?"

Her throat felt tight and her pulse raged in her ears. She nodded.

Smiling, Liz undid the trouser button, then pushed the zip down. She leaned close and whispered, "Raise your bum up."

As if in a trance, Nicole did as ordered. Ed slipped his hands into the waistband and eased it down over her hips. As Nicole lowered herself back to the cushion, he slid the trousers down her thighs, over her bent knees and over her feet, removing her shoes with the trousers.

Liz placed her hand on Nicole's thigh and let out a murmur of approval. "You're so perfect."

Nicole bit her lip. "No I'm not..."

"Yes you are. Your legs are firm and yet so soft to touch." She ran her fingertips down Nicole's thigh, then tilted her head toward her husband. "I know he's been fantasising about seeing you like this." She leaned close and blew in Nicole's ear. "And so have I." Liz slid her soft palm down Nicole's leg to her knee, then slowly up again.

Nicole turned to look into her friend's eyes, then glanced down at her mouth again. "Kiss me."

Liz leaned close and kissed her softly on the lips. Nicole brought a hand up to cradle the back of Liz's head. It was strange to kiss someone so

soft and smooth, but incredibly erotic. Liz ran her hand up Nicole's leg and over her tummy, then higher still. Delicate fingers circled over a taut nipple, then stroked it through the soft lace of her bra.

Nicole felt two other hands, the skin of the fingers and palms rougher, stroking the outsides of her calves. As Ed's hands moved over her knees and up to her thighs, the women's kissing became more passionate, their tongues sliding against one another. When Ed's fingers reached her inner thighs, Nicole spread her legs without breaking the kiss.

He stroked a finger over the wet gusset of her thong, and Nicole let out a quiet groan. He did it again, then slipped the finger beneath the edge of the silky material and touched her slippery folds.

Nicole opened her eyes and let out a louder groan. Liz broke the kiss and watched her face. Ed's hands moved to behind her knees, pulling gently and encouraging her to slide to the edge of the cushion. Nicole inched forward, which also lowered her head on the backrest of the couch. As Liz smiled down at her, Ed slipped his fingers into the waistband of her thong. Nicole allowed him to peel it off.

Liz glanced down at Nicole's uncovered lower body. "You're so sexy."

Before Nicole could respond, Ed kissed her inner thigh. His lips weren't soft like Liz's, and she could feel the graze of the stubble on his chin. The kisses trailed higher up her leg until she could feel his warm breath against the wetness of her sex. When she felt a warm wet tongue slide up through her folds, she whimpered. He did it again, and Nicole closed her eyes and raised her hips to meet his tongue.

"Does she taste as good as she looks?" Liz whispered.

Ed pushed his tongue into Nicole's channel. She tilted her hips to give him easier access. Her bra fastened at the front and, holding Liz's gaze, she unclipped it and pulled the cups aside, pushing her blouse wide open.

Liz stared at her boobs for a second before tentatively lifting a hand to caress one.

Nicole's passion took over. She pulled Liz close and kissed her hungrily while her husband lapped at her sex. Then she put her hand on Liz's head and pushed gently downwards. With wide eyes, the other woman

allowed herself to be moved until her face was positioned over Nicole's erect nipple.

"Suck it," Nicole whispered.

Liz pushed her tongue out and ran it round the areola, then took the nipple between her lips and sucked. At the same time, Ed moved his attention up to her clit. Liz grazed her teeth over one nipple while using her fingers to tease the other.

Nicole felt the tightening of muscles throughout her body. Her toes curled and she let out a sob. She looked down at Liz, whose eyes had never left her face. "Oh..."

Liz released her nipple and moved up until the women were face to face. As Ed sucked her clit between his lips and lathered it with his tongue, Nicole let out a yelp.

Liz stroked her cheek, then leaned down and kissed her lips. "Tell me when, and try to keep your eyes open for me..."

Nicole's eyelids fluttered, but she forced them open. "Now. It's now. I'm... Oh." She pushed her crotch up into Ed's face, grinding herself against his nose and chin.

"God, you're beautiful," Liz whispered.

Nicole failed in her quest to keep her eyes open. She squeezed them shut and pushed her head back against the couch as the orgasm thundered through her.

She eventually managed to open her eyes and took a deep breath. She smiled up at Liz. "God, that was..."

Liz stroked her face. "You looked fantastic. Are you ready for more?"

"Mm hmm."

"Can he make love to you?"

She smiled and shook her head. "My husband's the only man who does that. Other men have to fuck me."

"Oh." Liz grinned. "So, can he fuck you now?"

Nicole nodded, then looked down at Ed. She was about to tell him he'd need to wear a condom, but he was already rolling one on.

Liz ran her hand over Nicole's mons, then reached out and gripped her husband's cock. As he leaned forward on his knees, she guided him into position, then turned to watch Nicole's face as her husband pushed slowly inside.

Nicole let out a moan and gripped Liz's hand. Ed eased back and pushed in again. His cock was thick, stretching her. She pushed her bare feet up on tiptoes, arching her bum off the cushion.

Liz bent until her face was inches from hers. "Does that feel good?"

"Oh, yeah." Nicole winced as Ed pushed in deeper still, his girth causing pleasant discomfort. "Oh fuck, yeah." Looking down her body at Ed, she rocked her hips in time with his thrusts. "Fuck me."

Liz's expression was like a kid's at a fair; she stared wide-eyed, her gaze flicking between Nicole's face, her writhing body, and Ed's cock driving in and out of her sex. He placed his hands on Nicole's hips and held her in place as he pounded her.

Panting through clenched teeth, she urged him on by raising her hips to meet each thrust. She looked up at Liz. "Is this what you wanted to see?"

"Yes."

Nicole noticed Liz jerking her own hips in time with her husband's thrusts. Maybe she was clenching and able to get herself off that way. Reaching up, Nicole cupped Liz's breast through her t-shirt, making her sigh.

Ed increased his force—probably excited to see the woman he was fucking grope his wife—and Nicole felt the early tingle of another orgasm. She clamped a finger and thumb on one of Liz's nipples, twisting it and making her squirm. Liz bent and kissed her, probing Nicole's mouth with her tongue in time with the thick cock plunging again and again into her body.

Nicole let out a groan, but Liz didn't let up—she kissed harder, grinding their lips together. Even the occasional clash of their teeth didn't seem to bother her.

Ed was now fucking her with long, deep thrusts. Nicole felt his palm on her mons, pushing her tummy down around his thick dick. Then he

moved his thumb over her clit, making her orgasm erupt like a Jack-in-the-box. She screamed and shook, breaking the kiss.

She was vaguely aware of Liz watching her entire body jerk and twitch. Spasms rippled through her, then Ed grunted. He pushed deep and held still, pumped his hips twice and held still again. Nicole tried to clench and wriggle for him, but her body seemed to have a will of its own. Her legs shook and her buttocks repeatedly clenched and relaxed spontaneously.

Eventually, the two performers stopped moving and the room became silent except for their ragged breathing. Nicole had her eyes closed and was reluctant to open them in case Liz was having second thoughts. She knew only too well how easy it was to go from really enjoying something to regretting it almost the second the adrenaline rush had faded. A soft hand stroked her cheek, and she opened her eyes.

Liz smiled down, her face inches away. "Thank you," she whispered, before kissing her gently on the lips.

"It was my pleasure," she replied, glancing down at Ed as he withdrew.

"And mine," he said, standing and turning around. It was obvious he was removing the condom. He left the room and came back a few moments later, buckling his belt.

Liz helped Nicole sit upright. "That was so much sexier than I'd dared hope for."

Nicole pulled on her thong and trousers, and Liz took their cups of cold coffee out, leaving Nicole and Ed together in the lounge.

An awkward silence might have ensued, but Ed dropped into his armchair and smiled broadly. "You've just made an old man very happy."

She laughed and shook her head. "You're not an old man, and I think it was pretty evident you weren't the only one who was happy."

He nodded gratefully.

"Besides," Nicole said, re-fastening her bra and buttoning her blouse, "I happen to know that, like me, you're not new to this."

"Touché." He let out a long exhale. "There are a million questions I'd like to ask, but for now I'm still wrapped in a cocoon of sated euphoria."

Nicole laughed. “Yeah, I’m feeling kind of that way myself. I was only expecting coffee.”

Liz came back into the room carrying a tray with three cups and a cafetière. “Did I hear you mention coffee?”

“I was pointing out that I thought coffee was all I’d be getting today.” Nicole gave her a knowing smile.

Liz placed the tray on a side table. “I don’t know what you mean.” A smile tugged at the corners of her mouth. “But I think all three of us have had that on our minds for a while.”

Nicole remembered pleasuring herself after she’d visited them for supper. “Yes, that’s probably true.”

Liz poured the drinks and sat beside her on the couch. “Will you tell Julian?”

“Of course. I don’t do anything behind his back, and I don’t do anything I think he’d disapprove of.”

“Had you two already discussed the possibility of—”

“Yes.” She smiled at Liz’s surprised expression. “What can I say? I’m easy.”

Her friend put her hand on her arm and smiled warmly.

“So,” Nicole asked. “Was watching as much fun as you expected?”

“Better. Much better.” She nodded thoughtfully. “I’ll spend time thinking about it, let the images percolate in my dirty brain for a while, and then I’ll tell you exactly which parts turned me on the most.”

“I’d like that. Maybe you can tell me on our next walk.”

“Yeah, maybe.”

They drank their coffee in a comfortable silence for a few moments, and then the conversation turned to Nicole’s impending career break.

Ed put his cup down. “Well, if you need something to fill your time, my accounts are a mess.”

Nicole had a dreamy déjà vu of being bent over a receipt-covered desk. “I can show Liz how to do them, then she can start earning her salary.”

He chuckled and nodded. “Now *that* would be a nice change.”

“Cheeky sod,” Liz muttered.

Five minutes later, Nicole stepped back into her shoes and said she should be getting back home. All three stood up together, and after a moment of awkwardness, she hugged Ed. “I hope we get a chance to repeat that.”

“Me too.”

Liz walked her to the door, but before opening it she smiled at Nicole. “You’re so incredibly sexy.”

“But not sexy enough for you to join in?”

Liz gave a self-conscious frown. “It’s not through lack of wanting to, I’m just a little...” She shrugged.

“It’s okay. I’m happy to wait.” Nicole stroked her arm. Lowering her voice, she said, “I’ve never been with a woman before.”

Liz looked down at her feet, then up into Nicole’s eyes. “Me neither. When I do, I’d prefer it to be just the two of us. At least for the first time.”

Nicole hugged her. “That’d be fine with me.” She kissed Liz’s cheek, then waited for her to open the door. “Text me when you fancy a walk.”

As soon as she got home, Nicole headed up to shower and change. She considered texting Julian but thought it might be best not to distract him on the first day of his new job. She’d tell him tonight.

* * * *

Ciaran texted her later that day. Wishing her a Happy New Year, he said he was still trying to arrange their trip but needed to wait for permission from the Irish authorities. Now confident that she wouldn’t get herself into an upsetting situation if she did humour him with her presence at the bank, she replied with a simple ‘Okay’ then put him out of her mind.

When Julian arrived home, he looked a little frazzled. She poured them both a glass of wine while he changed, then they sat in the lounge while he described his day. Apparently he was working from a temporary office while his new one was having the cables upgraded.

“Ooh,” she said, smiling. “Do you get shiny new leads for your printer if you’re management?”

He laughed. “All the printers are wireless now, as I’m sure you know. What I’m getting is a better ethernet connection. It’ll be back-to-back videoconferences until the travel restrictions are relaxed.”

Nicole tutted dramatically. “Video cameras in offices, whoever thought of that.”

Julian frowned, but then seemed to realise she was just teasing—rather than having a dig—about his impulsive hiding of cameras in Ciaran’s office. He relaxed, smiling, then told her about the rest of his day.

“Ideally,” he said after a ten-minute diatribe on the company’s concerns about the post-Brexit ‘settling in’ period, “our IT system needs to be updated. Or at least standardised. I discovered today that some branches in Europe are still using an older version of our in-house software. And that could mean the algorithm—”

“Blah blah blah.” She smiled sweetly. “I stopped listening halfway through the free-trade agreement strategy.”

“Sorry.” Julian’s sheepish grin gave way to a more sombre expression. “So, how was your day? Was this morning’s meeting what you feared?”

She nodded. “There’s going to be job losses.”

“Well like I’ve said, there’s really no need for you to continue.”

“I know, and because you’d said that, I’ve offered to let them suspend my contract for a few months. They suggested everyone in our team go part-time, but some of them really need their full salaries.”

“Will they go for that?”

“I hope so. I also said that when things finally get back to normal, I’d like to continue working from home.”

He nodded his approval.

“I also bumped into Sam.”

“Oh?”

She smiled. “I only spoke to him briefly.”

“Did you tell him about what we’re doing? The loaning—”

“Of course not!” She shook her head in exasperation. “We chatted long enough for him to tell me that not only is he now happily married, they have a baby due in three months.”

“Ah. That’s nice.”

“Yeah, but now he’s worried about keeping his job, which is understandable.”

“Yes, I would expect it—”

“And then I let the man next door go down on me while his wife watched.”

Julian almost dropped his wine glass. “You... He... *Really?*”

She nodded.

“How did that happen?”

“Liz saw me drive back from the meeting and texted to ask if I fancied a coffee. Ed was there, and one thing led to another.”

“Just like that?”

She nodded, then shrugged. “I think it might have been planned on their part.”

“Why do you say that?”

“It just seemed odd. Liz opened the door before I could ring the doorbell, and then we went into the lounge when every other time we’ve stayed in the kitchen. She said she’d been thinking about what I told her we got up to, and then Ed walked in. I’d assumed he wasn’t in the house, and he said he hadn’t known I was there. Plus, he had a condom in his pocket.”

Julian’s eyes went wide. “I thought you said he went down on you?”

“He did. And after that, he fucked me.”

“Right...”

Just then, the oven timer started to beep. Nicole walked quickly to the kitchen and took the moussaka out of the oven and left it resting on the hob. She returned to the lounge and sat back next to her husband, who still looked in a state of shock.

“Do you want to eat?” she asked.

“I can wait.”

“Do you want to fuck?”

“I can wait for that, too.” He leaned close. “What were you wearing?”

Nicole laughed, picked up her own drink and leaned back on the couch. “I’d been to work, so I had a blouse and trousers on.”

“Shoes?”

“Black heels.”

“Hair?”

“Pinned up.”

“Makeup?”

“Minimal. Mascara, no foundation, a bit of lippy.”

“Underwear?”

“White lace bra, and a thong to avoid a panty line through my trousers.”

“Did they match?” He was grinning.

“No, but it didn’t seem to matter. At least they were both white.”

His brow creased as he thought. “Was this the first time a bull’s gone down on you?”

That gave her pause. “I hadn’t thought of Ed as a bull. Would that make Liz a cow?” She grinned, then thought about his actual question. “I...” Images of being with Ciaran flashed through her mind. She’d sucked his cock several times. She’d also sucked Will’s, and even briefly sucked the plumber’s, too. “I can’t actually remember.”

“I’m not sure you’re expected to remember everything that’s occurred. So, did you go to the bedroom?”

Nicole shook her head, then told him as much as she could remember. How she let Liz undo her blouse, how she’d slid down the couch and let Ed pull off her shoes and trousers, and how her friend had held her hand and kissed her while her husband licked her sex.

“Did you come like that?” He shook his head before she could answer. “Sorry, silly question.”

“Liz asked me to keep my eyes open, but I failed.”

“And then he fucked you?”

“Hmm.”

“And?”

“And I came again.”

He smiled broadly. “Of course you did. What about Liz?”

“She’s shy. She only watched, though I did force her to kiss my breast.”

“I thought she saw another man?”

“She does, but only him. I’m not sure what her problem is, but...”
She smiled. “I intend helping her overcome it.”

“Ah.”

“Would you mind if I took another woman to bed?”

“That’s another silly question.”

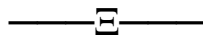
Nicole drained her glass. “Anything else you need to know?”

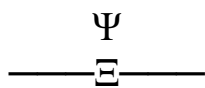
He shook his head.

“Okay,” she said. “What do you want to do first, eat or have sex?”

“We’d better eat first, otherwise I may not have the strength to meet your demands.”

“Hmm, and we can’t have that.” She stood, took his hand and led him through to the kitchen.





Chapter Six

Julian's new role at work kept him busy for the rest of the week. After full days in the office, he spent between two and three hours locked away upstairs every evening. He explained it wouldn't always be like this, but that it was a steep learning curve. Nicole assured him it wasn't a problem.

When Nicole got up on Monday morning, she saw it had snowed heavily overnight. After Julian had cleaned off his car and left for work, she texted Liz like an excited child and suggested they go for a walk and build a snowman. Twenty minutes later, wrapped up in warm clothes, a woolly hat and Wellington boots, she knocked on her neighbours' door. Liz came out similarly dressed, and the two women headed off down the snow-covered path. They discussed what each had done over the weekend, how the new lockdown was impacting their lives, and the weather, though Nicole sensed Liz was eager to discuss what had happened the last time they'd met.

They walked further into the wood, the hitherto undisturbed snow on the path indicating that they were the first to do so since last night's whiteout.

Surrounded by nothing but bare-limbed trees, Nicole turned to her friend. "So, have you had time to let all the images percolate?"

Liz chuckled. "I've barely thought about anything else. Every time I close my eyes, you're there."

"And what am I doing?"

"Fucking my husband."

Nicole stopped walking, trepidation seeping through her.

Liz saw her expression and laughed, taking Nicole's gloved hand in her own and urging her to keep walking. "I'm kidding. He barely registered in them. All I see is you."

"Ed didn't feature?"

“Not really. He was mainly offscreen, or at least out of focus.” She leaned close to whisper, even though there was probably nobody within a mile of them. “I knew he was there, but he was just a prop causing the reactions I was focusing on.”

Nicole couldn't help smiling. “A prop?”

“Well, two props. His tongue, then his dick.”

“And it didn't bother you, what his tongue and dick were doing?”

Liz looked puzzled. “You mean was I jealous of you?”

Nicole swallowed. “I was worried that after the initial excitement passed, the memory of what took place might have been spoiled by twinges of—”

“No, not at all. In fact...” Now Liz was the one who stopped walking. “If I was jealous at all, it was of Ed. He got to touch you, to make you squirm and—”

“He made me do a lot more than squirm.”

“Yes he did.” Liz stared into her eyes for a moment, then pulled on Nicole's hand. They resumed walking. “What did you do when you got home afterwards?”

“I showered and had some lunch.”

“Can you guess what we did?”

“Well,” Nicole said, “I'd guess that after watching two people getting their jollies, you'd probably want some of your own.”

“Too right. I dragged him upstairs and we went at it like teenagers.”

“I hope you allowed him a rest.”

“Nope. What's more, we've been going at it like teenagers ever since.” She squeezed Nicole's arm. “You've given our libido a massive boost.”

“Good.”

“What about you and Julian? Did he want some, too?”

“Oh yeah.” She smiled but was determined to get to the bottom of Liz's strange shyness so she could help her friend get over some of her inhibitions. “So, which parts did you enjoy the most?”

Liz looked up at the sky, which had turned quite dark. “I think we’re in for more snow.”

“Stop evading the question.”

“Okay. Skipping past the fact that your body is fantastic and makes me jealous, the thing—”

“Your body’s just as good. You’ve got a lovely figure.”

Liz gave a sad smile and shook her head. “I wasn’t as firm and toned as you are, even when I was in my twenties, and I’m certainly not now I’m in my forties. Your boobs are pert with nipples like cherries. Your legs are fantastic, your arse is like a peach and your skin’s perfect.”

Nicole stared, flattered but shocked by the impact she’d made on her friend. Other than Julian, she couldn’t remember anyone being so... into her. “I don’t think—”

“The thing that stands out the most is your face. You’re beautiful, and even if your boobs were saggy and your thighs were mottled with cellulite, men would still covet you so they could watch that face while they fuck you.”

Nicole stopped dead in her tracks, speechless. Snow had begun to fall in big, thick flakes.

Liz stepped close until they were nose-to-nose. “When Ed was pleasuring you, I watched your brow crease, your eyes flutter and your nostrils flare. I saw your mouth go from pouting to panting to screaming. I heard your little oohs and ahs turn to cries of ecstasy. Your body writhed, and I wanted to be the one who made you react like that.”

“And I wanted you to. I still do, but for some reason you seem...” Nicole searched for the right word but struggled. “Reluctant, somehow.”

“I’m not reluctant. I’m just...”

“Just what?”

Liz released a long sigh. “When I was a kid, I had an accident. I jumped on a hot water bottle my dad had just filled, and it split. It’s left unsightly red scars over my tummy and groin, and the top of one leg.” She gave a sad shrug. “It’s hard to watch people see it for the first time, and—”

“Do you think a bit of red skin would stop me wanting to touch you? To devour you?”

Liz sighed. “It’s just that you’re just so perf—”

Nicole cut off Liz’s words with a kiss, reaching up to hold her head in place. She backed Liz off the path until she was pressed against the wide trunk of an oak tree, and only then broke the kiss to remove her own right glove with her teeth. She then slipped her hand inside Liz’s coat and started to unbuckle her belt.”

Liz giggled. “What are you doing?”

Nicole kissed her again, her hand now popping each button of the jeans’ fly. She slipped her hand through the gap and pushed it inside her panties.

Liz jumped. “Your hand’s freezing,” she said, laughing.

“Good.”

“Nicole, we’re out in the open and anyone—”

Nicole cupped Liz’s sex for a brief second, then slid in a finger.

“Oh...” Liz’s eyes fluttered, and her mouth dropped open.

Nicole rocked her hand, curling the finger. The act of touching another woman like this was a terrific turn-on. Liz was soft, hot and wet.

“Nic... Oh god...”

The snow fell thick and heavy all around them, covering their hats and shoulders. A large flake landed on Liz’s eyelash and Nicole kissed it away before it had a chance to melt.

Liz groaned and dropped her head back against the bark. “Somebody might come.”

“Hmm. It’ll be you.” Nicole kissed her jawline and pumped her hand, remembering how she’d felt a few months earlier when Ciaran had done this to her in his office. It had been their first contact, and they’d gone on to share many intimate moments. She had every intention of sharing more intimate moments with Liz.

“Oh god, if you don’t stop doing that...”

Nicole moved her thumb over Liz’s clit.

“Oh god, Nicole...”

Running her thumb gently over the raised, swollen bud, Nicole experienced a huge thrill as she brought another woman to climax for the first time ever. Liz squeezed her eyes shut and clenched her teeth, and Nicole could feel the spasms gripping her finger.

Liz whimpered quietly as her body jerked and trembled. Nicole continued to rock her hand, the finger as deep in Liz's channel as she could manage, and her thumb still stroking gently, but now around rather than across her clit.

Once the orgasm had passed, Liz opened her eyes and stared at Nicole, breathing heavily. "God, that was..."

Nicole kissed her gently. "Next time," she whispered, "I'll rub my body against yours so we can both come."

"I'd... I'd like that."

"And maybe the time after that, you can watch your husband fuck me doggy-style while I make you come with my mouth."

Liz gave a wide smile. "I see you've been giving this some thought."

Nicole pulled her hand out of Liz's panties and slipped her finger into her mouth, sucking it clean of juices.

They held eye contact for a moment, then Liz removed her gloves to refasten her jeans. "I've just been finger-fucked in a snow-globe."

Nicole laughed. "From now on, every time I see a snow-globe I'll think about today."

"So will I."

The women walked back to the path and, without discussing it, headed back the way they'd come.

After walking in silence for a couple of minutes, Nicole had a thought. "Have you told John about what happened between you, Ed and me?"

Liz seemed surprised by the question. "No, I..." She frowned, then shrugged. "I hadn't thought about that. I don't know what he'd say."

Nicole shrugged. "It might give his libido a kick, too."

She nodded, then smiled. "I'll have to think about it."

The snow fell thick and fast, their own earlier footprints now completely covered.

Nicole hooked her hand into her friend's arm as they made their way up the slippery pavement toward their houses. "Are we still going to build a snowman?"

"No," Liz said with a smile. "My panties are soaked and getting cold."

"I'm not sorry."

"Neither am I." She looked up at her house. "Do you want to come in for a coffee? Ed's there, but that—"

"No, I need to get some work done. It's been agreed that I'll work until the end of this week and then stop. It'll be reviewed again at the end of April."

"Okay. Ed actually does have work that needs doing, so once I understand what that is, maybe you could show me what to do?"

"I'd love to." She glanced at Liz's house. "Are you going to tell him what just happened?"

"Of course. He'll drag me straight upstairs and I'll get another going over."

"Good. That'll give me something nice to think about while I'm filling in spreadsheets."

The women hugged before going their separate ways. Nicole walked up her drive, thinking about what her neighbours were about to do, unable to decide who she envied the most, Liz or Ed.

* * * *

Ciaran phoned later in the week. "Hi Nicole," he said, his tone cordial and professional. "Have you got time to talk for a few minutes?"

"Yes." She was actually having a break and sitting on the couch in her office space, drinking tea. Tomorrow would be her last day at work for a few months.

"I've just been chatting to the people in Ireland about our trip."

“Right...”

“Case numbers were low there last year, but they’ve started to rise through December. We can still go, but I’ve been advised that it looks likely tougher restrictions will be coming into force in February, including a fourteen-day quarantine period.”

“Ciaran, there’s no way—”

“I know, I know. I’m the last person in the world you’d want to be stuck with. But this trip’s important, now more than ever, which I’ll tell you about when I see you. If we go next week, we’ll be there and back before the new restrictions are implemented.”

“Next week?”

“Yeah. Would that be a problem with your work?”

“I doubt it, but I can find out.” She saw no harm in letting him think that he still had to compete for her time.

“Great. We can catch the ferry from Liverpool early on Thursday morning, I’ll book an appointment at the Dublin bank for the afternoon, then we can drive over to Galway on Friday.”

She noticed that he made no mention of what would happen in Dublin on Thursday night.

“Friday’s dinner will be in a private room in the restaurant,” he continued, “so no issues regarding lockdown. Next morning we’ll drive back to Dublin and catch the ferry to Liverpool. You’ll be home early Saturday evening.”

“Well that sounds okay, but I honestly don’t see the point in me accompanying you.”

“You’ll make a big difference with the bank,” he insisted. “I need the manager to be putty in your hands.”

Nicole sighed and closed her eyes. If this had happened last year she’d have been thrilled.

“One other thing,” he said. “If you could arrange to have a Covid test less than seventy-two hours before we leave, that’d be good. The ferry people will probably ask to see evidence of a negative result.”

“That’s fine,” she said, giving into the fact that this trip really seemed to be happening. It would probably take more effort to keep telling Ciaran to go away. Plus, a bit of extra cash never hurt, and she wouldn’t mind seeing Will again. “I’ll book one now.”

“Great. If you can let me have a scan of your passport, I’ll book the tickets for the ferry and a hotel in Dublin.”

“Two rooms, remember,” Nicole said firmly.

He laughed. “How could I forget? Bye, Nicole.” The line went dead.

Nicole scanned her passport, emailed it, then booked her test appointment.

She was working on her employer’s spreadsheets when she received another call on her mobile. When she saw it was Liz, her heartbeat sped up. “Hi, Liz. How are you?”

“I’m good thanks. Getting over hypothermia after someone exposed me in a blizzard.”

She could tell Liz was smiling. “Who’d do something like that? I was more concerned about any soreness you might have from subsequent encounters with your husband.”

“You’re right to be concerned. He hasn’t left me alone, but what I’m actually calling about is his accounts.”

“Oh, that’s a shame. What is it you need?”

“What I need is nothing to do with his accounts.”

Nicole grinned, a warm shiver running through her. “Well let’s get the accounts question out of the way first then.”

“I have several lists of figures on loads of different sheets, and I’m always having to cross-check them before even starting my calculations because Ed sometimes makes mistakes filling them in. I have...” There was a pause as Liz clicked through the pages on her screen. “Eight different sheets. My eyes have gone square. There’s got to be an easier way of keeping track of all these numbers.”

“Send me what you’ve got, and I’ll have a look, then get back to you if I have any questions for Ed later.” Nicole gave her email address.

“That’s super, thanks Nicole.”

“Anytime.”

Liz giggled. “I’ll hold you to that.”

Another warm shiver ran through her, and they hung up. Nicole struggled to concentrate on her work.

Liz’s email arrived an hour or so later, with numerous attachments. Nicole skimmed through them, confident she could simplify everything pretty easily. She spent the rest of the afternoon finishing off her real work, then prepared dinner for Julian’s return.

They had a pleasant evening, the first in a while where he didn’t have extra work, and she mentioned that Liz had sent her the spreadsheets.

“I’m still not sure what Ed’s business is,” she said. “Most of his customers are universities or small pharmaceutical companies, and Liz mentioned it’s something to do with compliance.”

“I assume it’s successful.”

“Definitely. His figures are much better than Ciaran’s. But I’d like your opinion on something.”

“Oh?”

She smiled. “Can I mention the word ‘algorithm’ without you going into raptures?”

“I’ll try to contain myself and will take a cold shower if necessary.”

“Hmm. Well, I was wondering if there was a way to make doing the accounts much easier. He seems to fill in everything in different spreadsheets, quite often duplicating the same information. I was thinking that if there were numerous sheets *within* the same file, then it could self-populate most of the duplicates from the master page.”

He nodded. “Do you want me to have a look at them now?”

“It’s not urgent, but if you could take a peek in the next couple of days, that’d be good.”

“Sure.”

“There’s something else...”

“Oh?”

His hopeful grin made her laugh. “No, Liz didn’t bring the files round in person. Ciaran phoned. He wants to do the Ireland trip next week.

Apparently another lockdown is going to happen there soon, or so he claims.”

“You don’t believe him?”

She shrugged. “He dropped some cryptic clue, saying it was important I was there *now more than ever*, but I suspect it’s all bullshit.”

Julian narrowed his eyes. “I kind of envy his involvement.”

“What, asking me to flash my legs at the bank manager?”

“Is that what he did?”

“Pretty much. He seems to think that if I wear a power suit and heels, the bank will give him whatever he wants.”

He smiled. “You have to admire his tenacity. No, what I meant was, it must be nice to have an interest in a totally separate business venture.”

This was a surprise. “You’ve never mentioned an interest in anything like that before.”

“No, but I’ve never had surplus money to invest before. I remember Ciaran telling me that he’d first gotten involved as a way of avoiding paying too much tax.” He shrugged. “But that’s by the by. So, when are you going to Ireland?”

“We leave next Thursday morning and will be returning Saturday evening.”

“Okay.” He gave her a smile and raised his eyebrows.

“What?”

“I was just wondering if Ciaran will manage to convince you that you’ve made a mistake by cutting him out of your life.”

“I’m sure he’ll try to convince me, but my stance hasn’t changed. What he did was unforgivable, and there’ll be no way back for him.”

“What about Will?”

She laughed. “It sounds like you’re hoping I get up to something during my trip.”

“I just thought it’d be nice for you to mix a little business with pleasure.”

“We’ll see what happens. Knowing that I have your approval means that if an opportunity arises, I may well have something to tell you about

when I get home.”

“Good.”

* * * *

After Nicole had sent off her final piece of work for her employer on Friday afternoon, she put an out-of-office notice on her company email account saying she'd be unavailable for the next three months and gave two alternative contacts within her team.

Deciding the mini career break celebration demanded more than another cup of tea, she poured herself a glass of chilled white wine and returned to her desk to play around with copies of the files that Liz had sent, all gathered in a single workbook. She was pleased to see the banking expenses on the master sheet appearing in the correct section in the corporation tax schedule, but she couldn't seem to set up conditions to move a figure between sheets if they were above or below a certain threshold. Convinced that Julian would be more adept at this, she decided to wait until he got home. She took her wine through to the lounge and sat on the couch, waiting for his return.

Her thoughts wandered to her upcoming trip to Ireland. She was determined to have a nice time and make the most of it, but it could've been a lovely trip if Ciaran hadn't ruined things. A couple of nights of filthy sex in hotel bedrooms would have been perfect, and she could even have given him a blowjob while he drove them cross country. She couldn't deny being disappointed with the way things had ended between them.

Julian arrived home before six for the first time that week. She poured him a glass of wine while he was upstairs changing out of his suit, then they sat together in the lounge and chatted about their respective days. It was obvious that he was enjoying his new role, but she could see how demanding it must be. He looked mentally exhausted.

She told him about uploading her final set of figures onto the company's database and then activating her out-of-office notification, which made him smile.

“I’ve also started to look at the stuff Liz sent for Ed’s business,” she said. “I may need your help, though.”

“We can do it now if you like.”

“You’ve only just got home. This is your down time.”

“It’ll only take a few minutes to look.” He stood and held out his hand. “Why don’t you bring your laptop up to my office so we can use my monitor?”

By the time Nicole got up to his office with her Lenovo, Julian had fired up his PC and his large 24-inch monitor. He made room on his desk for her laptop, then handed her a cable. “Here, plug this in then we can go through the dongle.”

“Ooh, I like it when you talk dirty.”

He sniggered, hit a few keys on his own laptop then a few more on Nicole’s. “Right, do you want to open up what you’ve got?”

“There you go again with your nonstop smut.” She leaned over his desk and wiggled her hips. “It’s a surprise that you ever manage to get any work done at all.”

Julian blinked, took a deep breath then looked into her eyes. “Let’s get this out of the way, then you can carry on talking like that all night.”

Nicole laughed, opened the spreadsheet she’d started to work on, and showed him what she was hoping to do. He nodded, listening as he tiled the various sheets across his screen, getting an overview of what was needed.

“Yes, this should be fairly straightforward.” He pulled his chair closer and spent a couple of minutes typing long and many-bracketed formulae.

Nicole glanced around his office, admiring the photo of the three pairs of legs she’d given him for Christmas. “Have you wanked off to your photo yet?”

“No,” he said, in a deadpan voice. “Though obviously, the temptation has been unbearable.”

Nicole laughed. “Well, don’t forget to let me know when you do. I want to kneel on the floor so you can come all over me.”

He gazed at her for a few seconds, then turned his attention firmly to her laptop. “If I show you what I’ve just done…”

She stepped next to his chair and bent down.

He quickly showed her the look-up techniques he’d used to fill the same information across the array of sheets and calculations. “In fact, there’s probably an easier way for Ed to upload the data, which would save a lot of work. I’ll have a think about that, too.”

“You’re a genius.” She kissed his cheek. “Dinner should be ready now, if you’re hungry.”

“Okay. Leave your laptop here, I’ll mess around with it tomorrow.”

After dinner, they cuddled on the couch and watched TV. Although there had been no more teasing or dirty talk, they got into bed naked. Nicole lay back and enjoyed him kissing her neck and breasts. When he started to trail kisses down her belly, she stopped him.

“Sorry,” she whispered. “I’m impatient. I want cock.”

“That’s fine by—.”

She gripped his shaft, which was already rigid, straddled him and guided it inside. Both let out a sigh.

Nicole stared down at him, rocking her hips, relishing the feel of him inside her. He brought his hands up to caress her breasts.

“So,” he said breathlessly. “Why are you so impatient?”

“I don’t know.” She rocked her hips.

“Is it something to do with—”

She put a finger to his lips and closed her eyes, concentrating on the sensations rippling through her body. For a moment it felt like a game, as if she were chasing a puppy through narrow passages. She saw herself laughing and bending and trying to grab something just out of reach, always evading her until finally—

“Oh…”

The orgasm surged through her, sending every muscle into a spasm. She arched her back and bounced up and down, his cock prodding her deep inside. With arms and legs trembling, she gasped through her clenched teeth as she drove herself down over and over, screaming with delighted pain

when he pinched her nipples. Julian arched up, lifting her off the mattress, and his cock twitched and pulsed inside her. She clenched and relaxed while rocking her hips, milking him dry.

Reaching down between his legs, she squeezed his balls gently. He opened his eyes and looked at her, and she lay down on his chest.

After a couple of minutes, he kissed her eyes. “What brought that on?”

“I thought we both deserved to celebrate my last day at work for a while.”

“And that was the perfect way to do it.”

They lay in silence for a short time, then she kissed his cheek. “Do you want me to move?”

His arms were still around her waist, and he gripped her tighter. “No.”

“If I stay here I’ll dribble your stuff all over your groin.”

He kissed her lips gently. “That’s fine. Dribble away.”

* * * *

Nicole had showered and almost dressed before Julian woke up on Saturday morning. He smiled at her from the bed as she pulled on her sweatshirt.

“Morning,” he said.

“Hi.” She approached the bed, bent and kissed him. “Want a coffee here?”

“No, I’ll get up. Give me five minutes to shower.”

Nicole walked downstairs to the kitchen, where she put the kettle on for her tea and fired up the coffee maker. Julian arrived ten minutes later, wearing jeans and a polo shirt. They drank in relative silence, then Julian asked if she’d decided what clothes to take to Ireland.

“I’ll wear jeans and a jumper for the journey, but I’d better take a suit and blouse for the meeting with the bank manager to stop Ciaran whining.”

“What about for the dinner?”

“I haven’t thought about that yet.”

“Well think about it now.”

She saw the playful twinkle in his eyes over the rim of his coffee mug. “Any suggestions?”

“Wear something outlandishly sexy. Your tightest dress and highest heels. Maybe even those strappy sandals we bought at the Trafford Centre, with fishnet stockings and your nails painted red.”

“And why would I dress like that?”

“To make Ciaran regret what he did. I want him to yearn for you.”

“But what would the other men think if I dressed like that?”

“I’m happy for them to yearn for you as well.”

She laughed. “Three of them are retired. I’d be more likely to give them heart attacks than hard-ons.”

Once he’d finished his coffee, Julian stood up. “I need fuel for my car. How about I call for a couple of bacon rolls from the bakers for breakfast?”

Nicole nodded enthusiastically. “Great. I’ll have a play with Ed’s spreadsheets and see if I can do what you showed me last night. Can I use your big monitor and dongle?”

“Of course.” He grinned and leaned close. “My dongle is yours whenever you want it.”

After he’d left, Nicole made herself another cup of tea and headed up to his office. She followed Julian’s instructions and by the time he returned Nicole had finished nearly all the relative reference calculations. She stood up to let him sit and go over what she’d done.

“I’ve had a few thoughts about this,” he said, taking a bite out of his bacon roll. “It depends how Ed gets the figures, but if he receives them in some sort of spreadsheet—or even a csv file—”

“A what?”

“Comma-separated-variable file, sorry, there’s a chance we could set up a macro for automatic import. He’d literally just have to click a button to

select which datafile he wants to upload. If so, then all he—or Liz—would need to do is fill a handful of figures, just once.”

He leaned over the keyboard and saved the spreadsheet to her hard-drive, then replaced all the figures on the first sheet with a zero and saved that one, too. “This could be the master sheet, and they could add new figures monthly, quarterly or annually, however he wants it.”

“Brilliant.” She smiled at him. “I could get Liz and Ed to come over and you could talk them through it?”

Julian nodded. “Certainly, although it might be best if they climbed over his garden fence so none of the neighbours see we’re breaking lockdown rules by having house visitors.”

Nicole finished her bacon roll then sent a text to Liz. Ten minutes later she got a reply:

Hi Nicole

Sorry, but I’m visiting my parents and getting a month’s worth of groceries for them. I’ll be out most of the day, but Ed’s at home. I’m sure he’d be thrilled to see you again :-)

Liz xx

She’d added Ed’s mobile number at the end of her message. Nicole decided to phone rather than text.

He picked up on the third ring. “Hello?”

“Hi Ed, it’s Nicole from next door.”

“Nicole, hi. How are you?” His voice was warm and friendly.

“Good, thanks. Listen, you know how Liz sent me the accounting fig—?”

“She’s not in, I’m afraid. She’s gone—”

“I know. I texted her earlier, and she gave me your number. I’ve had a look, or more accurately, *Julian’s* had a look, and we’ve found a way of streamlining your data entry quite a lot.”

“Really? That’d be great if you—”

“Do you want to come over now so we can chat about them? Julian reckons that, depending on how you get your figures, he may be able to make it even easier.”

“Great. Should I come over now?”

“Yep. Julian suggested you climb over the fence in case our nosier neighbours report the breach of lockdown rules.”

He gave an apprehensive laugh. “I was more concerned about actually meeting your husband after, you know...”

“There’s no need to be concerned about that, I promise.”

“Okay. I’ll be there in ten minutes, but I’m a bit too old for climbing six-foot fences. I’ll walk up the path to your back garden, if that’s okay.”

“That’s fine. I’ll go and unlock the gate. See you soon.”

He arrived just a couple of minutes later, smiling as she let him into the kitchen. Nicole kissed his cheek.

“Good to see you again,” she said.

“You too.” He bent down and undid his laces. “I’ll take these off—the snow’s turned to slush on the path.”

Nicole looked down at his broad back and shoulders, fond memories of their encounter of last week filling her mind.

“It’ll be easier to show you on the big screen in Julian’s office. Come on up.” She led them out of the kitchen and up the stairs.

“Wow,” he said looking around. “This is so different from ours.”

She nodded. “I like that every house is individual. So much nicer than when all the houses are identical.” She reached the office door. “He’s in here.”

Julian stood up and greeted Ed with a handshake. “Ed, nice to meet you.”

“You too.”

Both men smiled, and Nicole wondered what it was like for Julian meeting a guy who’d already fucked his wife.

“Thanks for taking the time to look at my accounting nightmare,” Ed said. “I’m afraid I relegate that to the bottom of the pile every time I have things to do.”

Julian laughed. “Yes, I can imagine.” He dropped down in his chair and turned the monitor slightly so the other two could see it easily.

By the time he’d shown Ed what they’d achieved so far, the man’s eyes were lit up with awed gratitude.

“Wow, that’s... That’s fantastic.” He smiled at Nicole, then turned to Julian. “I didn’t know you could do half this stuff in Excel.”

“It’s a great program for things like this,” Julian said. “There are loads of bespoke accounting software packages that are probably more powerful, but for what you’re doing, this is perfect. I was wondering, though, how do you get the figures in the first place?”

“I’m not sure what—”

“Do you receive a spreadsheet of some kind from your clients? If so, we might be able to link the data so you’d hardly need to type anything in yourself.”

Ed shook his head regretfully. “No, I have to invoice each customer, and then they pay their bill. There are no spreadsheets as such.”

“Ah, shame.”

Ed snorted. “What you’ve already set up is a big improvement on the way I’ve done the last two years’ accounts, I can assure you.” He turned to Nicole. “Is this something Liz could do?”

She nodded. “Yeah, of course. I’ll talk her through it. The program’s already set up. She can just put new figures in as the invoices are paid and the expenses are logged.”

“Fabulous...” His eyes seemed to catch the photo on the wall for the first time. “Wow. I love the photograph.”

Julian smiled. “Yes, me too.” He glanced at Nicole. “Nicole took it. They’re her legs.”

Ed turned to her, shocked. She briefly considered admitting the photo had been taken a couple of hours after she and Ed had been introduced for the first time.

“However,” Julian continued, “neither pair of men’s legs are mine.”

Nicole stared at her husband, totally taken aback by this calm show of open daring. Since neither man seemed fazed by Julian’s announcement,

she turned to Ed and shrugged. "What can I say? I'm a slut."

Ed laughed and shook his head. "It's really a great photograph."

Julian turned back to the keyboard and tapped away, and for a moment Nicole was afraid he was going to bring up the picture she'd taken of cum dripping from her sex. Or worse still, the one Ciaran had taken with cum dripping from both her holes. But then he said, "I've saved this to Nicole's hard-drive. She can send it to Liz when she shows her how to do it."

"That's great," Ed said, looking very grateful. "I really appreciate it. I have to confess that things like this are not my forte."

As Julian asked about Ed's business, Nicole slipped out onto the landing. The comments about the photograph had inspired her, and she knew what she wanted to happen next. Once in their bedroom she stripped and put on a black suspender belt and a pair of black stockings. Then she stepped into the peep-toe shoes she'd worn in the photograph, applied lip gloss, brushed her hair and sprayed a little perfume on her neck.

After putting a pack of condoms and the tube of lube in the top drawer of her bedside cabinet, she walked along to her husband's office. The men were still chatting about Ed's work, but the conversation stopped mid-flow when she stepped through the door. Both men's eyes wandered down her body. Her nipples tightened under their gaze.

She looked at Ed. "I thought I could pay you back for last week. How about I perform oral sex on you while my spouse watches?"

Ed opened his mouth to speak, but then turned to Julian as if waiting permission. Before either of them could reply, Nicole turned and left the room. Both men followed, and she swung her hips as she strutted along the galleried landing to their bedroom.

She walked over to the far side of the room and turned to face them. "Come here," she said to Ed.

He did so while Julian stopped at the wall opposite the bed.

"Take your clothes off," she ordered.

Ed glanced at Julian, then began to unbutton his shirt. Nicole went to work on the buckle of his belt, then slowly dropped to her knees and pulled his jeans down his legs and off as he raised each leg in turn. She also

removed each sock, so he stood before her in only a pair of black jockey shorts. She ran her hand over the bulge while watching his face, then slipped her fingers into the waistband and eased them down. His cock sprung out and Nicole pushed the shorts all the way down so Ed could step out of them.

She ran her hands up the outside of his legs, then brought her right hand in and wrapped her fingers around the base of his shaft. Looking up into his eyes, she stuck her tongue out and leaned forward to lick the salty clear pearl from his slit. She ran her tongue around the glans several times, as much for Julian's benefit as Ed's, then pushed her head forward and took his full length into her mouth and throat.

Ed let out a gasp of pleasure, and she was pleased to see the shock on his face when she pushed the tip of her tongue against his scrotum.

She swirled her tongue against the underside of his shaft and then pushed forward to swallow the entire length again, her nose buried in his thick pubic hair. She sucked and teased but didn't get into any sort of rhythm. Although the idea of making him come like this was sexy, it wasn't what she wanted today.

She pulled back, reached over to her bedside cabinet and took out a condom. After ripping the foil with her teeth, she placed the rubber on the tip of his cock and slowly rolled it down the length. She stood up, turned her back on him and placed one heeled foot on the bed.

Nicole twisted to look at him over her shoulder. "Fuck me."

Ed glanced at Julian again, then stepped close and ran his hand over her backside. The height of her heeled shoe on the floor made her tall enough for him to reach without difficulty. He bent his knees and put his cock between her slick folds. As he straightened his legs, he entered her.

Nicole groaned and let her head fall back onto his shoulder. "Play with my tits," she whispered, eager to put on a show for her watching husband. Ed raised his hands and cupped her breasts as he fucked her slowly. She let out little moans when he began to tease her nipples, pinching and twisting them.

She opened her eyes and stared at her husband. His eyes glowed with lust, and she could see his chest rise and fall with his shallow breaths.

Nicole reached round and pushed on Ed's stomach, easing him back and out of her. She took her foot off the bed, turned to face him again and kissed him gently on the lips. "Time for a change of position." Nicole crawled onto the bed on all fours, her hands in the middle of the mattress and her knees on the side nearest to Ed, her feet hanging over the edge.

She looked over at her husband. "Julian, get naked and get involved."

As Julian started to remove his polo shirt and jeans, Nicole turned to look back at Ed. "Don't wait for him."

Ed slid his cock back inside her. Nicole pushed back to meet his thrusts.

Now naked, Julian stood at the foot of the bed looking a little uncomfortable. This was the first time he'd been involved in front of anyone else, but she remembered him saying he wanted her to be spit-roasted by Ciaran and Will.

Nicole looked up at him. "Kneel on the bed and fuck my face."

Julian quickly clambered on and held his dick out, and Nicole parted her lips. She closed her eyes and focused on the sensations. Ed reached around her and brought his fingers into play. As soon as they brushed over her clit, she felt the first tingles of an orgasm. The next contact his fingers made sent her over the edge. She grunted, gagged and mumbled around Julian's cock, and finally had to release it from her mouth as she cried out. Her head dropped, she gasped in deep breaths, and Ed slowed his thrusts. She hoped he hadn't come when she had, because there was something else she wanted.

She crawled forwards and Ed's cock slipped out. Holding her husband's gaze, she dragged away the hair that clung to her face. Then she turned to let her eyes wander down Ed's body. He was still hard, the condom's teat still empty.

Nicole moved to the foot of the bed and patted the middle of the mattress. "Ed, lie here." As he did so, she straddled his legs. Reaching over to the top drawer again, she took out the KY and another condom. Though she had no problem with Julian going in bare, she wasn't sure how Ed

would feel about his neighbour's cum dribbling onto his balls at the end of the session.

She opened the condom for Julian and told him to put it on, and then handed him the lube. Ed's stunned expression suggested he'd finally cottoned on to what was about to happen.

While Julian prepared himself, Nicole crawled up Ed's legs until she was directly over his groin. She looked down into his eyes. "Are you okay with this?"

He nodded eagerly, so she gripped his cock and impaled herself on it. She rocked her hips a couple of times, then leaned forward onto his chest as her husband climbed on top. The coldness of his lubed cock pushed against her backside, opening her up.

She stared into Ed's eyes and gritted her teeth as her husband's cock pushed in a little harder. Ed stared in awe as she tried to relax, then suddenly Julian was all the way inside, nestling snugly against the cock already filling her other hole.

Nicole closed her eyes and started to rock herself between their bodies. Ed pushed up as Julian pushed down.

Unlike the only other time she'd experienced this, Nicole was completely relaxed. This was her own doing, and this was exactly where she wanted to be.

"Fuck me," she whispered. "Fuck me and use me."

Both men increased their movements—pushing, prodding, thrusting, grinding. Hands stroked her arms, hips and thighs. Julian bit the side of her neck. Another orgasm built inside her, sending tremors through every muscle. Her eyes squeezed shut and she raked her fingernails down both torsos sandwiching her own. As her legs moved on the bed, a shoe came off. She rubbed her stockinged foot against Ed's hairy leg and ground her clit against his pubic bone.

Julian cried out, pushed in deep and held still as he came first. Nicole wished he'd gone in bare so she could feel the heat of his cum. Ed pushed up and held still. Nicole came with him. All three let out cries and groans as their bodies became a single mass of pumping hips and shaking limbs.

Another spasm shook Nicole to her core, making her scream. It was either the most intense aftershock she'd ever experienced, or she'd come twice in quick succession.

Her pulse raged in her ears. As they all finally slowed down their thrashing, she let out a long, satisfied moan.

Julian raised himself off her and flopped down on his side of the bed, and Nicole stayed where she was with Ed's cock still inside her. She knew Ciaran could stay hard and come a second time, but Ed's cock was already soft and when she clenched her muscles it forced him out.

She rolled off and lay between them, a contented feeling seeping through her still-tingling body. "Hmm. Thank you, gentlemen."

Ed laughed. "I'd be understating things if I said it was a pleasure." He sat up and looked at Julian, then at Nicole. "That's a first for me, and it was something else."

Nicole smiled, secretly elated that this had been Ed's first threesome. Julian removed his condom and then got off the bed and started to dress. Ed followed his lead, and Nicole looked down at her legs. Both shoes had come off and one of her stockings was laddered. She unclipped both stockings and rolled them off, then put on her robe before unclipping the suspender belt.

There was no awkwardness as the three of them headed back downstairs and into the kitchen.

Ed put on his shoes, then looked from Nicole to Julian. "Well, thanks for everything. The accounting thing is a great help, but that fades into insignificance after what just happened."

Nicole leaned in and kissed his cheek. "Tell Liz to phone me when she wants to go through the spreadsheets, but it might have to wait—I'm off for that Ireland trip for a couple of days next week. Providing I test negative, of course."

Ed nodded. "Okay." He opened the door and smiled one last time before heading out into the cold.

Nicole turned to her husband. "Was I too forward?"

He shook his head.

"I wanted you to watch, and I wanted you to share in a threesome."

“I’m glad I did. Watching you with your foot on the bed as he took you was very erotic. I wish I’d been able to film it.”

“That would have been nice.” She stepped close and looked up into his eyes. “You know what would have been even nicer?”

“What?”

“No condoms. If I’d taken you both bare, and felt you both coming inside me.”

“Well, if Ed’s going to become a regular, maybe you should broach the subject. Ask how careful he is with other women, and see if he’d be prepared to dispense with condoms for you.”

Nicole stared into his eyes. “You’d like that?”

“You know I would. I understand that for strangers condoms are a necessity, but maybe not for people you trust.” He shrugged. “See what Liz thinks.”

“Okay.” A thought occurred. “It’d also be nice if he didn’t wear a condom when I go to bed with Liz *and* Ed.”

“Is that what you’d like to do?”

“Yes.” She kissed his cheek. “Fancy another coffee before you take me back to bed?”

“No.” After taking her hand, he led her upstairs.

$$\Psi$$

Chapter Seven

On Wednesday evening, Nicole laid her suit for the bank appointment and little black dress for the dinner on top of her case. She added her red-soled stilettos, strappy black sandals, and found room for her sexy underwear around the edges.

Packing finished, she found Julian working in his office. “Ciaran’s picking me up at six,” she said. “I think I might have an early night.”

“Okay. I’ve finished here, too.” As he stood, he nodded towards the photograph of the three sets of legs. “Are you excited about seeing Ciaran and Will again?”

“No. I’m worried it’ll be awkward.”

“Why? What you did was nothing to be ashamed of.”

She laughed. “I sucked and fucked them both, and left their hotel room with cum in every orifice. I’m pretty sure most people would view that as something to be deeply ashamed of.”

“Ah, but we’re not most people.”

“Hmm.” Nicole walked along the landing and into their bedroom. After brushing her teeth, she stripped down to her panties, pulled on a white vest top and slid into bed. Julian joined her after he’d finished in the bathroom.

“So... Will you do something dirty and then describe it for me when you return?”

“I don’t know.”

He pushed his leg against hers. “What if I want you to?”

“Julian, I don’t need a pimp.”

“That’s not what I...” His face blanched. “I’m sorry, I wasn’t trying to put pressure on you to—”

“I know. I’m sorry, I didn’t mean—”

“No, you’re right. I shouldn’t have said anything. I still feel guilty for talking you into having the threesome in the first place.”

“You didn’t. I’m just tense about how Ciaran’s going to behave.” She ran her hand down Julian’s arm. “Let’s not keep going over what’s already happened. If I have regrets, they’re down to the choices I made. Okay?”

“Thank you. And I’m sorry. It’s not my place to tell you what to do.”

She could see his sincerity and kissed his cheek. “Let’s just see what happens, eh?”

They turned the lights off and snuggled in silence for a few seconds, then Nicole whispered, “I’ve packed six condoms, but can always buy more.”

He chuckled and kissed the top of her head.

* * * *

Nicole woke before her 5.30 alarm and went to shower in the main bathroom to avoid disturbing her sleeping husband. She dressed in jeans, jumper and trainers, didn’t bother with makeup, and pulled her hair back into a ponytail. As she drank a cup of tea in the kitchen, a text from Ciaran arrived saying he was five minutes away.

She went up to the bedroom and woke Julian by kissing his cheek. “I’ll be leaving in a few minutes.”

He blinked and sat up. “Okay. Have a good trip.”

“Thanks. I’ll text you later from Dublin.”

She’d put her bags and leather jacket in the hall already, so as soon as she saw the headlights on the drive, she opened the front door and stepped outside. Ciaran gave her a reassuringly friendly smile as he opened the boot for her to put in her holdall and suit cover.

He nodded toward the house. “Nice place.”

“Thanks.” She climbed into his Audi TT and put her jacket on the backseat.

Ciaran drove slowly along the icy roads of the estate, but the main roads had been gritted and he was able to go faster. “Have you remembered your passport and proof of negative Covid test?”

“Yes, Dad.”

He laughed and shook his head. “Sorry. So, how are things with you?”

“They’re good, thanks.”

“Is Julian enjoying his new role?”

“Yes, he seems to be.”

They made small talk for a while, then Ciaran put on the radio and they drove in a comfortable silence. Still tired, Nicole enjoyed the peace. The sun rose behind them as they drove west towards Liverpool.

At the docks, they went through passport control, then nipped to the hospitality shack for coffee. Nicole bought a pastry as well, but, as ever, Ciaran resisted.

Back at the car, Ciaran followed the instructions of the men controlling traffic and drove slowly along the ramp onto the ferry. He was directed to a parking space near one side.

“I hope you’ve brought something to read,” he said. “We’re not allowed out of the car during the trip.”

“Really?” She hadn’t realised this. “How long’s the journey?”

“We’re on the Seacat, which is fastest. It’ll be under four hours.”

“Four hours?”

“The normal ferry takes seven and a half.”

“Jeez. I just assumed we’d be allowed to wander around the ferry, sit in the restaurant and go on deck. I’ve dressed for standing in a sea breeze.”

“And I thought you’d dressed like that to piss me off.”

She saw from the twinkle in his eyes that he was teasing, and she couldn’t help thinking what fun they could have had if things had been different. “You shouldn’t have let me choose a large latte.”

“There’ll be toilets we can use, I’m sure.”

“Hmm.” She looked around at the other people in their cars. “Will I even be able to get a signal on my phone?”

“Who cares?” He reached into the pocket of his door, took out a paperback and grinned.

She ate her pastry in silence as she watched him, wondering if he was actually concentrating on his murder mystery. “If I’d known I’d be sitting in a car for four hours, I’d have worn a skirt and brought my wand.”

Ciaran looked up from his book. “Well if you want to slip your jeans off, I could get you the wheel brace from the boot.”

Nicole laughed out loud. “Cheeky bastard.”

Just then, the boat started moving. Nicole finished her pastry but only drank about a third of her coffee. Then she closed her eyes and dozed.

After ten minutes of silence, she remembered what he’d said about the timing of the meeting with the bank. “Why is seeing the bank manager so important now?”

He put his book down and looked at her. “I’m thinking of selling my stake.”

“What? Why?”

“I think it might be a good time to invest in other things. Stocks have crashed, and if I get a decent price for my half of the business, I could make a killing when the share prices pick up again.”

“But would you get a decent price now, during the pandemic?”

“I think so. The business is doing well, and we’ve had quite a bit of interest from other customers wanting to lease.”

“What does Will think?”

“I haven’t told him yet.” He shrugged. “I need to make sure the financial back-up is there first, because that’ll make the business look stronger.”

“Is that to safeguard everyone’s jobs, or to get you a better price?”

“That’s a bit cynical, don’t you think?”

She thought about the accounts she’d done and remembered the salaries the men were being paid. Men who probably needed those salaries—especially now, when so many other people would be looking for jobs.

“Have you actually got a buyer?”

“No, but I’ve drawn up a list of companies that’ll be worth approaching. They’d be happy to get their hands on the contracts we’ve got.”

“But would they keep the staff, or just let their own people do the work to fulfil the contracts?”

“What’s with the inquisition? It’s just a business decision.”

“It just seems a little mercenary, that’s all.” She was struck by the horrible thought that he might blurt his plans out during the celebratory dinner. “When are you planning on telling them they might be out of a job?”

“They won’t be out of a job. Some of the guys are retired, anyway. They were just helping Will out when he first got started. They’ll probably be glad of the rest.” He sighed. “But obviously I’ll have to tell Will as soon as possible.”

Nicole shook her head and remembered Julian’s comment about envying Ciaran’s involvement in the business. She wondered how much Ciaran’s share was worth.

They fell silent again. Nicole’s phone did indeed get a signal, and she spent the rest of the journey reading the news and surfing the web. By the time they reached Ireland, the sky was clear. At the hotel, Ciaran told Nicole to take one of the seats in the foyer while he checked in.

He returned after five minutes. “There’s some kind of plumbing problem, so only one of the rooms is ready at the moment.”

Nicole stared at him. “A plumbing problem?”

“A leak or something in the room above. They’re working on it now, so hopefully it’ll be sorted by the time we’re back from the bank. We can both get ready in the one room, though.”

She stood up. “What time’s the appointment?”

“Three.”

It was a little after one. “Let’s drop our stuff off in the room, have something to eat, then we can get ready.”

He nodded. “Good plan.”

The room was huge, with a couple of easy chairs either side of a large window, and a queen-sized bed. Nicole put her holdall on the floor and suit cover on the bed, then waited by the door while Ciaran wandered over to the window.

“What do you think of the room?” he asked, a broad smile on his face.

“It’s lovely. I hope yours is as nice.”

In the nearly deserted restaurant, they were shown to a table under the window. Nicole chose the soup with a ham sandwich, and Ciaran ordered himself a chicken salad.

They discussed what they were going to ask for at the bank. Nicole felt more strongly than ever that her presence was totally unnecessary. This, coupled with the apparent ‘problem’ with the second room in the hotel, confirmed her suspicions about Ciaran’s motives for inviting her on this trip. And he’d been behaving so nicely, too.

“Do you need to shower before we go to the bank?” she asked.

His eyes sparkled with mischief. “I wasn’t going to, but I will if you want company.”

She held out her hand. “Give me the cardkey.”

He passed it over.

“I’ll get ready first, because you’ll probably spend more time in front of the mirror than I will.” She stood up. “I’ll text you when I’m dressed.”

Once back in the room, Nicole stripped down to her underwear, applied her makeup, slipped on her stockings, cream silk blouse and grey suit, then pinned her hair up. After stepping into her black stilettos, she texted Ciaran.

When she opened the door to him, his eyes wandered over her body. He sighed.

“I’ll wait in the foyer,” she said, secretly pleased to see the longing in his eyes.

Five minutes later, Ciaran joined her, looking wonderful in a charcoal suit and crisp white shirt with a maroon silk tie. Despite her best intentions, seeing him dressed like this rekindled some very sexy memories.

“Ready to go?” he asked.

Nicole dropped her phone into her bag and stood up. “How far away is the bank?”

“It’s only a couple of hundred yards. That’s why I chose this hotel.”

As they walked, she noticed Ciaran kept flashing looks at her legs and stilettos.

“I really love those shoes,” he said.

“Thank you.”

“And I can’t stop thinking about the last time you wore them.”

“You should concentrate on what you’re going to say to the bank manager.”

“I doubt he’ll be even listening to what I say. Try and sit where he can see your legs.” He grinned. “They’re stockings, right?”

She ignored him, pulling her facemask from her handbag as they approached the bank. A young man in an ill-fitting suit asked them to wait in the far corner until the manager came to collect them. A minute or so later, the door opened and a lady in her mid-fifties wearing a blue trouser suit walked over and introduced herself as the manager. Nicole couldn’t help smiling at Ciaran’s shocked expression as the lady escorted them to a small meeting room.

“You can take your masks off for now,” she said with a lovely Irish brogue. “Please replace them before you walk back through the bank, though.” She sat by a laptop at the far end of the table. “Now, what can I do for you both?”

Ciaran cleared his throat and turned on his most winning smile. He’d obviously realised he needed to change his planned strategy of having Nicole repeatedly cross her legs. “We’d like to discuss the possibility of extending our overdraft facility.”

The bank manager tapped a few keys, then frowned. “You already have quite a big overdraft facility...” While dragging her finger over the touchpad, she checked the screen then looked over at Ciaran. “You’ve never used more than thirty percent of the overdraft available to you, so I’m not entirely sure why you feel it’s necessary to increase it. Are you expecting an immediate fall in revenue as a result of the current situation?”

“Yes, possibly. Nicole is our financial expert, and she predicted a potential downturn...” He glanced at the astonished Nicole. “I’ll let her explain.”

You twat.

“I think Ciaran’s overstating my importance—I’m certainly not a financial expert. All I’ve done is prepare this year’s books for submission to the tax office.”

Ciaran turned to look at her. “But you’d highlighted the potential shortfall—”

“Ciaran announced his plan to change the emphasis of the business from sales-only to a leasing and servicing strategy, so I simply made him aware of the potential short-term fall in revenue due to the income from leasing arrangements being spread throughout the year.”

The bank manager nodded and studied the screen again. “Well, that’s certainly true in a lot of cases, but your accounts haven’t shown any downturn. When is the new strategy going to start?”

“It’s already started,” he said. “And as a result, we’ve been approached by a couple of other potential clients, so I just wanted to know that we’d have the capacity to buy more stock before we committed to any new business.”

“I see. Well, there’s certainly plenty of capacity there, so I’d suggest leaving the overdraft limit as it is for now. If you find you *do* need to increase the amount to cope with the initial purchase of stock for any new contracts you may secure, then we can certainly do that. You can apply online or, if you’d prefer, phone us.” The woman gave Nicole a knowing look. “I hope you haven’t come all this way just to ask about the overdraft?”

“No,” Ciaran said with a laugh. “We have a meeting with the staff tomorrow in Galway, so this was en route.” He smiled at Nicole. “I thought it’d be nice for Nicole to see a bit of Dublin, too.”

“Well, if there’s nothing else?” The bank manager stood and walked to the door. Ciaran went to shake her hand, then thought better of it and simply nodded instead. He walked out past the bank’s main service counter to the entrance.

The manager looked at Nicole. "I'm sorry if it's been a wasted trip."

"I knew it was unnecessary, but he insisted."

"And did he also insist you dressed accordingly?"

Nicole's jaw dropped.

The manager offered a reassuring smile. "There will be better times to see the city than now, but I hope you enjoy your stay."

"Thank you." Just before Nicole fitted her facemask, she whispered, "I'm not completely naïve. Ciaran isn't getting anything more than bookkeeping advice." After leaving the meeting room, she marched past Ciaran and out of the bank.

He caught up with her on the pavement. "So, my plan to have you —"

"It was stupid, and I can't believe I listened to you."

"We got the extra—"

"As she pointed out, you could have got it using online banking. That was so embarrassing."

"I thought you showed why you were—"

"She thinks you've brought me here to fuck me," she said, a little louder than she'd intended.

Ciaran checked over his shoulder to see if anybody had overheard her outburst. "Why would she think that?"

She closed her eyes and took a deep breath, trying to gather her patience.

"Come on," he said, putting his hand on her elbow. "Let's see if we can find a bar that's open and we can talk about things."

She glared at him but the day was actually quite cold, so the thought of finding somewhere warm had its own appeal. They entered the first pub they saw. Once inside, a pretty waitress who seemed unable to stop smiling at Ciaran, led them to a table. Nicole ordered white wine, Ciaran a pint of Guinness.

When their drinks arrived, Ciaran raised his glass. "I always drink this when I'm here. Cheers."

Nicole took a sip of her pinot.

He put down his glass. “Nicole, I honestly thought that your presence in the bank would be needed. I had no idea they’d be so accommodating, with the pandemic and all the uncertainty it’s raised. But she was right about something...” He gave her a smile. “I’d really like us to go back to what we used to have.”

“I’ve already explained that’s not—”

“Come on. I know you enjoyed all those times in my office.”

“Yes I did, but then you—”

“And you enjoyed the night with Will. Don’t try and tell me you didn’t, because I was there.”

“You weren’t there when I got home and cried about being passed around like a piece of meat.”

“That’s not... You weren’t *passed around*. You were shared. You had two men worshipping your body. You’d even discussed it with Julian beforehand. The way you’re acting, it’s like I’d smuggled in another man and we’d taken turns abusing you. Have you forgotten that you walked up to the room knowing exactly what was going to happen? Or that for most of the time, you were directing the action?”

Nicole remained silent, unable to contradict anything he’d said.

Ciaran rubbed his chin. “I know I upset you, and I’m really sorry. I honestly never meant to hurt you.”

Nicole stared into his cobalt-blue eyes. Was she being unreasonable? Was this a case of her cutting off her nose to spite her face? Memories of their other times together flashed before her eyes. They’d had great sex. Looking at him now, she could imagine slipping off his jacket and undoing his perfectly knotted tie. Even Julian seemed to be hoping she’d relent and take Ciaran back as her bull. It would be so easy to go back to the fabulous hotel room, and—

Room, singular. She raised an eyebrow at him. “Tell me again about the leak.”

He frowned. “About the what?”

“The problem with the second hotel room.”

“Oh, yeah. Er...” He shook his head. “Something happened in the room above.”

“What’s the hotel phone number?”

He shrugged. “I booked online.”

She took out her phone. “I’ll look it up.”

“Why...?” He watched her scrolling through the hotel website.

“Okay, stop. Can we just talk about—?”

“Talk about what? she asked. “The fact that you never learn?”

He took a breath. “Nicole—”

“So, what was your plan? Get me to dress like I did for our dates, have a few drinks and reminisce about the hot sex we had in your office, then go back to the hotel and find the other room was still unavailable?”

He looked into her eyes. “Would that really be so awful?”

“Ciaran, I know you’re used to getting your own way, but this is you manipulating me again.”

He stared into her eyes. “I think about you all the time. I spend every day thinking about what we did together. About the night we shared the bed, and all those times in my off—”

“Yes, we had fun, but that’s all it was. I’m happily married, and you were someone I had sex with. I’ve moved on, and you should too.”

He frowned. “What d’you mean, you’ve moved on?”

“Exactly that.”

“You’ve already had sex with somebody else?”

She laughed. “Haven’t you?”

“No.” He looked hurt and angry. “I can’t believe you’ve—”

“Ciaran, what I do is none of your business.”

“Well since you’re such a slut, I can’t see why one more night here would make much difference.”

Nicole’s jaw dropped and tears blurred her vision. She picked up her bag and stood up.

He sighed. “I’m sorry. Please, just sit down and we can—”

“I need some fresh air.” Nicole walked out, avoiding eye contact with any of the other customers or the pretty waitress.

She walked through the streets and alongside the river. Maybe Ciaran was right, but it had still hurt. It was getting dark, and she felt a little vulnerable. She’d find a bar and calm down, then find a restaurant and have something to eat. By then, Julian would be home, and she’d phone him. She’d explain she intended getting a taxi back to the hotel and see if there was another room available.

The temperature had dropped, and her heels were too high for walking long distances on uneven pavements. When she saw the lights of a bar up a side street, she headed for it. Inside it was warm and cosy, and five minutes later she was at a table near the back with a glass of white wine.

Taking out her phone, she saw she had four missed calls from Ciaran; she’d set it to silent before they’d gone into the bank. He’d also sent a couple of texts, which she quickly read. He was sorry. Please phone him.

Had she overreacted by storming out? She’d just confessed to having sex with somebody else, so could she really take offence at his slut jibe?

Her phone lit up on the table as another text arrived. Expecting it to be another from Ciaran, she was pleased to see it was from Julian:

Hope the trip is going well. xx

Nicole tapped out a reply to ask if he was free to talk, and he called her. She picked up immediately. “Hiya.”

“Hi. How’s Dublin?”

“It’s lovely, and we should come here together sometime in the future.”

“I’d like that.” After a brief silence he asked, “Is everything alright?”

She loved that he could read her mood so easily. She told him about the appointment at the bank, and how the manager had made her feel. Then she revealed Ciaran had only booked one hotel room.

“Ah.”

“*Ah?* A guy brings your wife to another country under false pretences and expects her to sleep with him, and that’s your response?”

“Sorry. Obviously I understand your anger.”

“Thank you.”

“Even if his ulterior motive was to try and convince you to share his bed, he should have booked two rooms anyway.”

“I’d already told him we’d need two rooms, and he assured me there would be.”

“In that case, he was being devious.”

“Exactly. I think he was hoping to keep me dressed up in the way he likes me, ply me with drink and then take me back and seduce me.”

There was a brief silence. “Why, what are you wearing?”

“Pardon?”

“You said you’re dressed how he likes you, so what are you wearing?”

“My grey suit with silk blouse and heels.”

“And stockings?”

She frowned. “Hold-ups.” She wondered if Julian thought that by dressing like this, she was encouraging Ciaran to make a pass. “Why?”

“Nothing, I just like to visualise you. So where are you now, back at the hotel?”

“No, I’m in a bar somewhere. I left Ciaran in a pub after...” She closed her eyes and sighed.

“After what?”

“He said he wanted us to go back to what we had before. I told him I’ve moved on and suggested he should too.”

“You told him about Ed and Liz?”

“No, but I admitted I’d slept with someone else.”

“How did he take that?”

“He wasn’t happy. He said that since I’m such a slut, it shouldn’t be that big a deal for me to sleep with him again tonight.”

“That’s... I can see how that would hurt.”

“Yeah it did, though to be honest, I’m now wondering if it should have done.”

“What do you mean?”

“He’s right, I’m a slut. It’s who I am now we’re doing this loaning thing.” She checked that nobody was sitting close enough to overhear. “Should I really be offended if someone points out the obvious?”

“What you do is always on your terms. You choose who and you choose when. It’s not for anyone else to decide, and you should remind him of that.”

Nicole smiled. Talking it through with Julian always helped. She doubted there were many husbands who were this understanding.

“So,” he said, “what are you planning on doing?”

“Keep ignoring his calls for now. This bar seems to be serving food, so I’ll eat here and then get a taxi back to the hotel.”

“You’re not planning to find somewhere else to stay?”

She sighed, regretting having left all her stuff in Ciaran’s room. “All my clothes are in the first one, and I’m sure there’ll be other rooms available. The restaurant was practically empty at lunchtime.”

“Okay, well do whatever you think best.”

“I will. I think this little accounting job has reached its natural end, anyway. Ciaran said that he’s looking to sell his share in the business.”

“Really? Why?”

“He seems to think he can make more money by investing in the stock market after the crash.”

“Hmm, he might be right. Haven’t some companies suspended dealing in their shares for the time being?”

“I have no idea, but I was wondering if you’d be interested in buying his share.”

“I could be. Why? Any idea how much that would cost?”

“I really have no idea. I only mentioned it because I remembered you saying that you envied him having a business venture of his own.”

“Well, we can certainly think about it if that’s what you’d like to do.”

They said their goodbyes and hung up. Nicole asked the waitress for another glass of wine and a menu, then ordered herself lasagne and chips—her favourite comfort food.

After she'd finished eating, a couple of young guys came into the bar and took a nearby table, chatting away in strong Irish accents. They gave her friendly smiles, then studied the menu. Nicole checked her phone to see if Ciaran had sent another text; he hadn't.

By the time the waitress delivered the food for the two men, Nicole was ready for another drink and ordered a third glass of wine. She decided this would be her last, because getting drunk in a strange city while dressed to the nines wasn't the smartest thing to do.

When the two men had finished their meal, one of them looked over at her. "Excuse me, are you waiting for someone?"

She shook her head. "No."

"Well you're welcome to join us, if you like."

Nicole intended leaving when she'd finished her drink but didn't want to appear rude. "I'm not going to be staying long."

"That's fine. We're dull company, but probably a little more interesting than none at all."

She picked up her bag and glass, then joined them at their table. "Is this allowed? In England all the pubs are closed, and we can't mix with anyone indoors."

"That'll be happening here soon enough, so let's make the most of it while we can. I'm Declan, and this is Colin."

She smiled from one to the other. "Nicole."

They made small talk for a few minutes, Nicole explaining she was here on business and would be going to Galway tomorrow before returning home on Saturday. Colin insisted they all have a drink to celebrate and ordered a round from the waitress. Three small glasses of clear liquor were duly delivered.

Nicole frowned. "What's that?"

"Poitín, an Irish tradition. It's a liqueur made from potatoes."

She took a sip and coughed as the liquid burned its way down her throat. “Jeez, I can’t drink that.”

Declan laughed. “As this is your first trip to Ireland, you should really drink it with another Irish tradition.” He called the waitress back and ordered more drinks. Several minutes later, three pints of Guinness were delivered, a shamrock etched in the head of each.

Nicole started to giggle again. “There’s no way I’ll be able to drink that.”

“I’ll show you,” Colin said. He picked up his glass of Poitín and took a sip, grimaced, then washed it down with a large gulp of Guinness. “See?”

Nicole took a slug of the fiery liqueur, then a gulp of stout but before she had a chance to swallow the second drink, she coughed, spraying Guinness over the two men and dribbling it down her own blouse.

Colin laughed and handed her a napkin. “Okay, I think we still need to work on that.”

Just then, Nicole’s phone rang. She took it out of her bag, saw it was Ciaran, and declined the call.

Declan glanced down at her phone, then raised his eyebrows. “Husband?”

“No, he’s back in England. That was Ciaran, the business colleague I’m here with.”

“Right. Didn’t he want to eat with you?”

“I didn’t give him the chance. We had a disagreement.”

Her phone rang again, and this time she decided to answer it. “Hi Ciaran.”

“Nicole, where are you?”

“I’ve no idea.” She looked at Declan. “Where are we?”

“Temple Bar.”

“Apparently, I’m in a temple bar.” She peered around the building. “It doesn’t look like a temple, though.”

“Who’s that you were talking to?” He sounded concerned.

“Declan. Colin’s here too, but it was Declan who answered my question. So if this isn’t really a temple, blame him.”

“Temple Bar is the area,” Ciaran explained. “If you tell me the name of the actual place you’re in, I’ll come and find you.”

“No, I’m fine.”

“Nicole, just tell—”

She ended the call and looked up at the two men. “He gets a little possessive sometimes.”

“Your colleague gets possessive?” Colin asked.

She nodded.

The two men glanced at each other, then Declan asked, “And how does your husband feel about your colleague getting possessive?”

“He just tells me to do what I think’s best.” Their puzzled expressions made her giggle. The alcohol was starting to kick in. “My husband isn’t the possessive type, and he’s happy for me to have a little fun. My colleague *is* the possessive type, and he’s only happy when I’m having fun with him.” She shrugged. “There’s a bit of history there, you see.”

The men shared another look.

“What’s more,” she went on, “Ciaran has brought me to Ireland in the hope of winning me back.”

“Winning you back from your husband?”

“No, from Ed.”

“Who’s Ed?”

“My next door neighbour. Though to be honest, I’m actually more interested in his wife.”

Both men laughed and shook their heads.

Nicole leaned forward over the table. “When he asked me to accompany him on this trip, I told him we’d need two rooms. And d’you know what he did?”

“He only booked one?” Colin asked.

“Or,” Declan said, leaning forward, “he claimed he’d booked two, but said there’d been a mix-up with one of them.”

“Exactly,” she said, slapping her hand on the table. “Some plumbing problem.”

“Men, eh?”

“Hmm.” She smiled, took another sip of her potato fire-water and washed it down with Guinness.

“So, what are you going to do?” Colin asked.

Nicole shrugged. “All my clothes are in the hotel, and we’re driving over to Galway tomorrow, so I’ll have to go back there. Julian suggested I get another room.”

“Julian?”

“My husband.”

“He knows your colleague only booked one room?”

She nodded. “He said Ciaran had been devious.”

“And he wasn’t angry?”

She shook her head. “I think he was hoping I’d maybe hook up with Ciaran again. Or Will.”

“Who’s Will?”

“He’s the guy we’re meeting up with in Galway. Another colleague.”

“Sheesh. They should make a soap opera about your life.”

Nicole’s phone lit up as a text arrived from Ciaran. She read it and looked up at the two men. “He says he’s worried about me.”

“Sounds like he’s worried you might get a better offer than sharing his hotel room.”

“Hmm.”

Another text arrived. “He says I don’t know anything about you, and you’re not to be trusted.”

Declan nodded. “That’s right enough. Tell you what, give me your phone.”

Nicole passed it over, and Declan signalled the waitress over. After passing her the phone, he and Colin got up and came to crouch on either side of Nicole. Each slipped an arm around her shoulder while the photograph was taken.

Declan took the phone back from the waitress and passed it to Nicole. “Send him the photo to assure him if anything bad happens, he has evidence for the police.”

Nicole giggled and forwarded the picture to Ciaran.

“You’re welcome to come back to our place and sleep there,” Declan said.

She gave him a warm smile. “That’s very kind of you.”

“But I should warn you that you might be disappointed.”

“No I won’t. I think you two will be the perfect hosts, and I’ll be very grateful to use your sofa.”

“You’ve guessed?” Colin asked.

“I suspected.” She smiled. “It’s nice to talk to men who look you in the eye rather than glancing down at your chest.”

“Well, there’ll be no need for the sofa—we have a spare bed. Now, let’s finish these and try another bar.”

Nicole pointed to her Poitín and Guinness. “I really can’t drink these.”

“That’s fine. You’ve drunk some, which is good enough for your first Irish trip. Come on, there’s a bar with live music just around the corner.”

As they got outside, the cool air hit Nicole and she stumbled in her heels. The men walked either side of her, helping her. Once inside the next bar they found a table and sat Nicole down. She ordered a sparkling water and a coffee, which made both men smile. Traditional Irish music was performed by a three-piece band consisting of one man on a bodhrán, another on an accordion and a woman on a violin. Some of the customers sang from their tables, others danced in the small space at the back of the room. Nicole wondered if social-distancing rules were being broken but decided she really didn’t care. For the next hour she laughed and had a great time. She hadn’t realised how much she’d missed just going into pubs.

Declan and Colin convinced her to dance, but she couldn’t do it with her shoes on. Declan got another customer to take a few photos of the three of them crushed together on the dancefloor.

“I’ll send you these, and you can share them with your colleague,” he said with a smile.

By the time they’d reached the men’s house, Nicole had sent Ciaran two pictures of her dancing with Colin and Declan and had also sobered up considerably. Once inside, she accepted a decaf coffee while the men each had a shot of Jameson whisky.

“What hotel are you booked into?” Declan asked.

Nicole couldn’t remember the name until she scrolled back through her search history. She showed him the photo on their website.

“Ah, that’s a nice place. I’ll drive you over there in the morning. To be honest, their breakfasts will be a lot better than what we can offer.”

After she’d finished her coffee, they showed her to the spare room. After they’d wished her goodnight, Nicole draped her suit and Guinness-stained blouse over the seat of a rowing machine in the corner. The feet of her stockings were laddered and ruined from dancing on the wooden floor, so she balled them up and put them in her bag. Then she slipped between the sheets in her bra and panties and fell asleep almost immediately.



$$\Psi$$

Chapter Eight

Nicole woke, dressed and wandered downstairs to find Colin on the couch in a t-shirt and shorts.

Declan came out of the kitchen carrying two mugs. “Morning,” he said in a cheery voice. “Coffee?”

“Ooh, yes please.”

Colin moved along to make room for her. “How’s the hangover?”

“Not too bad, considering how little I usually drink.”

“I think you made a wise choice by going onto non-alcoholic drinks.”

Declan returned and passed her a steaming mug. “Here you go, pet.”

“Thank you,” she said, then looked from one to the other. “And thank you for last night. I had a great time.”

“I’m glad.”

“And thank you for...” She shrugged. “In the cold light of day, I can understand why Ciaran was concerned. I could’ve gotten myself into a really nasty situation.”

Declan shook his head. “I think you knew we were safe from pretty early on. I’m sure if you were picking up any negative vibes, you’d have walked away. You weren’t drunk until we made you sample the Irish drinks.”

“True. I can blame it all on you two.”

When she’d finished the coffee, Declan went to get his car keys. She gave Colin a hug before she left. Declan had a Mini like her own, though his was five years old and not the Cooper S.

It took them less than ten minutes to get to the hotel. When he pulled into the small drop-off area at the front, Nicole leaned over and kissed his cheek. “Thank you.”

“Any time. And if you come back to Dublin, drop me a text. You have my number from the photos I sent you.”

“I will. I’ve told Julian we should come here after Covid’s disappeared.”

“Is that your husband, your neighbour or your colleague in Galway?”

She slapped his arm. “Stop making me sound like such a floozy.”

“You should bring your next-door neighbour’s wife with you, then we can all go to the best gay bar in Dublin.”

Nicole laughed but a tingle ran down her spine. “I actually really like that idea.”

“It’s a solid offer. We’ll even let you two have the double bed.”

She shook her head. “We’ll stay in this hotel, but meet you for dinner and dancing.”

“Right, it’s a date.”

She smiled, got out of the car and headed into the hotel. Through the glass panels she saw Ciaran having breakfast in the restaurant. She walked up to his table. “Morning.”

Ciaran looked her up and down, taking in the stain on her blouse and the lack of stockings. “Have a nice night?” he asked.

“Fabulous.” She smiled sweetly. “How about you?”

“What do you think?”

“Can I have the cardkey, please?”

“Why?”

“You know...” She wiggled her hips. “After two guys going at me all night long, I really need a shower.”

Ciaran snatched the card from his pocket and held it up. She saw his hand shaking slightly.

“Thank you. I’ll only be ten minutes. Can you order me a pot of tea and a full breakfast? I seem to have worked up quite an appetite.” She smiled again and left the restaurant.

In the hotel room she quickly showered, tied her hair back and put on her jeans and trainers with a fresh top. Ciaran was still eating when she

got back to the table.

“So, tell me about your share of the business,” she said.

He looked puzzled, then shook his head. “Tell me about your hot night of passion, and why you didn’t insist they use protection.”

“What makes you think they didn’t use protection?”

“There was cum on your blouse, and if you needed a shower so bad, they must have come inside you as well.”

She poured her tea, wondering how long she should tease him. “Maybe they started off using protection but ran out of condoms before they ran out of stamina.”

His expression was as cold as she’d ever seen it. “You know what you are, Nicole?”

“Yes, you reminded me yesterday.”

He looked away, then took a sip of his coffee.

She didn’t like seeing this side of him and decided to put him out of his misery. “Ciaran, nothing happened.”

He scoffed. “You can’t expect me to—”

“They’re a gay couple. They took me to a bar with traditional music and I had a great time. Then we went back to their house and I slept in the spare room.”

“But the stain—”

“It was Guinness! I’ve never met a man whose cum leaves a brown stain.”

He stared at her, obviously trying to decide if she was being honest. “What about your stockings?”

“Laddered while dancing without my shoes on.”

Just then, her breakfast was delivered to the table. Nicole poked a slice of toast into her fried egg, then smiled at him. “So, how much is your share of the business worth?”

“Why?”

“I’m just curious.”

“Over the last three years I’ve put in thirty-five grand, but I’ve also reinvested all the profit I was due, so I’d like to think it’s worth somewhere

between eighty and ninety grand now. I'll need to sit down with Will and work it out." He smirked. "Maybe you should join the discussion. You seemed to enjoy the last time the three of us got together."

Nicole ignored his comment. "Did Will invest the same amount?"

"Yeah. He actually started it all. Other than a small salary, his whole share of the profits has gone back into the business. Why?"

"I just wondered what sort of figures were involved, that's all."

Ciaran finished his breakfast. "Right, if you give me the door card I'll go and bring the bags down and check out. Come through to reception when you've finished your breakfast."

Once Ciaran had left, Nicole phoned Julian. "Hi, are you free to talk?" she asked.

"Yes, I'm alone in my office, but have a meeting in fifteen. How was your night? Did you get another room?"

"As things turned out, I didn't need one."

"Oh?"

"No. I met two men in the bar I phoned you from, and they took me back to their place."

He was silent, but she could hear his ragged breathing.

"Are you still there?"

"Yes. The two men, they just asked you back to their place?"

"Not immediately. They took me dancing first."

"Dancing?"

"Yep. If there's supposed to be social distancing here, they're not very strict with it."

"What about Ciaran?"

"He stayed in the hotel room. I sent him photos of me with the two men."

"You sent him photos?"

Julian sounded so bewildered she had to suppress a giggle as she dropped her voice to a sultry whisper. "I'll show them to *you* when I get home."

“Right... right. Good. So, how was it?”

“Wonderful.”

“Good—you know I’ll want the details. And how did Ciaran take it?”

“Not as well as you.” She laughed. “I hate to disappoint you babe, but nothing happened.”

“What do you mean?”

“They were a lovely couple who offered me their spare room when I told them about Ciaran’s deviousness with the hotel booking.”

“They were gay?”

“Yep, though I didn’t tell Ciaran that until after his tantrum.”

Julian guffawed. “Oh dear, poor Ciaran. Where are you now?”

“I’ve just finished breakfast at the hotel. Ciaran’s checking out, and we’ll be starting the drive to Galway in the next few minutes.”

“Right. Well, you might want to make up for your teasing by giving him a blowjob while he drives.”

“I don’t think he deserves one.”

He gave a soft chuckle. “No, probably not. Anyway, I’ve been thinking about what might be involved in raising funds to buy Ciaran’s business. For each of my two promotions, I got share options. Although I can’t sell them yet, I can use them as security to borrow money from the bank. You’ve seen the figures—does the business look like a good investment?”

“On paper it certainly looks successful enough, but I can’t help wondering... If it’s doing well, why is Ciaran looking to sell out?”

“Well, like he says, he could probably make a lot more if he’s shrewd with his stock investments.”

“Then shouldn’t we be looking at doing that, rather than buying into a business he seems to think isn’t good enough for him?”

“I don’t enjoy tracking share prices,” he said. “Besides, this would be about being part of a venture—I’m not really aiming to make the biggest, fastest profit available. I thought this could be something for you to be more involved with.”

His considerate nature made her smile. “Thanks, but this whole discussion might be for nothing anyway. Ciaran seems to think his share of the business is worth between eighty and ninety thousand pounds.”

“Really? That’s a lot more than I’d imagined. We could only raise about forty thousand, maybe fifty at a push.”

Just then, Ciaran appeared at the restaurant entrance. Nicole got up from her seat. “It looks like he’s checked out, so we’ll talk about this later, okay?”

“Right, yes. Enjoy the drive over, and try not to cause an accident with your oral skills.”

* * * *

The day was dull and overcast, with occasional drops of rain hitting the windscreen as Ciaran drove out of the city.

“I’m sorry for only booking one room,” he said. “Thinking about it now, it wasn’t the smartest strategy.”

“No, it wasn’t.” She turned to look at his profile. “If you hadn’t done that, we could have had a nice evening. Maybe even gone dancing.”

“Did you tell Julian?”

“Yes. I also told him about pretending to have spent the night with two men.”

“Heh. What did he say to that?”

“He told me I could make it up to you with a blowjob while you drive.”

Ciaran snapped his head around to look at her, his expression one of shock.

“Don’t get excited. It’s not going to happen.”

He shook his head. “Nobody at work has any idea what Julian’s like. People see him as a quiet, straitlaced—”

“Basil Fawlty?”

He smiled. “He’s changed that look, but nobody would ever guess what goes on in his life.”

“Good, because what we do is nobody else’s business.”

It was early afternoon by the time they reached Galway. Ciaran asked if she wanted to stop for lunch, but Nicole was still full from breakfast.

“We have a few hours to kill,” he said. “If the weather had been better, we could have taken a walk around the city. I need to talk to Will before tonight, and I’ll also go and see my folks. You’re welcome to join me —”

“No, I think you need to talk to Will on your own. And I certainly don’t think it’d be appropriate for me to meet your parents.”

“Okay, well I can drop you at the hotel if you want to rest up in the room before dinn—”

“*The* room?”

Ciaran chuckled. “I only booked one because I’ll be staying at my mum and dad’s house.”

“Oh, right.” She shook her head. “Sorry, I just—”

“I know.” He grinned sheepishly. “So, how about we go to the factory so you can meet the rest of the guys before tonight’s get together?”

“That’d be nice.”

“Great. While we’re there I’ll talk to Will, then I’ll drop you at the hotel and go see my folks. I’ll call at the hotel later and walk you to the restaurant.”

“Okay.”

The factory was a modern unit in a small industrial park. Ciaran parked next to a large black pickup truck with chrome bumpers. “That’s Will’s,” he said.

Nicole wasn’t sure how she felt about seeing Will again. He’d seemed like a nice guy and had appeared as shocked as she was when Ciaran had suggested the threesome, but it would still be awkward chatting to him as if that had never happened.

They got out of the car and hurried through the rain to a door which led into a small office. Will was sitting behind the desk, talking to an extra-

petite blonde who was leaning against a filing cabinet. They both stood upright to greet the new arrivals.

Ciaran did the introductions. “Nicole, Will you’ve met, of course...”

She smiled warmly. “Yes, hello Will.”

The blonde hugged Ciaran and kissed his cheek.

“And this lovely creature,” Ciaran continued, his smile smug as he held his arm around the blonde’s waist, “is Will’s wife, Meg.”

Nicole’s expression froze. She’d had no idea that Will was married when she slept with him. She doubted if it would have made any difference, because that night she’d acted like a complete—

“Hi Nicole,” Meg said with a broad smile, holding out a tiny hand.

Recovering quickly, Nicole forced herself to return the smile and shook the proffered hand. “Hi.”

Meg was stunning, with short-cropped spiky blonde hair, big green eyes and a pointed chin that gave her an elfin appearance. She wore tight faded jeans, a black jumper and flat ankle boots. She couldn’t have been any more than five feet tall. Nicole avoided looking at Will, who was probably feeling as uncomfortable as she was.

“Meg,” Ciaran said. “Is there any chance you could introduce Nicole to the guys while I have a quick word with Will?”

Meg looked surprised. “You want me to take this beauty into that den of depravity?”

“I thought it might be nice for her to meet them before we all go out tonight.”

She looked at Nicole. “You’ll have to ignore the pornographic calendars, and slap any of them that try to pinch your backside.”

Nicole laughed.

Meg turned to Ciaran. “What’ve you got planned for the rest of the day?”

“Nothing. I was going to drop Nicole off at The Galmont and go see my folks.”

“Ooh, swanky.” Meg gave Nicole a broad smile. “Nice to see he’s not put you up in some cheap backstreet dive, but you could have stayed

with us.”

Nicole risked a glance at Will, who looked suitably embarrassed. She was now angry at him for what they’d done together. “Thanks, but I’m sure the hotel will be fine.”

“It’s a lovely hotel with a spa. I hope you packed your cozzie.”

“Unfortunately not.”

“Shame.” Meg took her hand. “Come on, let’s go and meet the perverts.” She led Nicole through another door and onto the factory floor. It was a single room, about forty-foot square with numerous work benches. A radio was playing, though one of the machines was making so much noise the music was barely audible. There were four men at the benches, all wearing dark grey overalls.

“Gents, come and meet the latest recruit,” Meg called.

The noisy machine was turned off, and the men converged on the two women.

“This is Nicole,” Meg told them. “She’s the lady from England who’s been doing the accounting. She’s joining you for dinner tonight, so you’d all better behave.”

Nicole was greeted with friendly smiles, and each man wiped his hands on a rag before being introduced. None of them were wearing facemasks.

“This is Brian,” Meg said as one of the older men shook Nicole’s hand. He had a full head of grey hair and a goatee.

“Nice to meet you, Nicole,” he said.

“John, put your tongue away,” Meg warned as another man with thinning salt and pepper hair stepped forward. “He’s the one responsible for all the filthy pictures on the wall.”

“I also have a few of Meg but like to keep those to myself,” he said with a wink.

“Dream on,” she said with a laugh, slapping his arm when he held onto Nicole’s hand for too long. “Put her down, you dirty old bugger.”

Another man shook Nicole’s hand. He was younger than the first two, maybe forty, with a wide chest and big shoulders.

“Donal’s a former rugby player who keeps the others in check,” Meg said. “But don’t let him get you into a scrum because they’ve corrupted him, too.”

“Rugby?” Nicole asked.

He nodded. “In my younger days.”

“He used to play professionally,” Meg announced, proudly.

Donal gave a sheepish smile. “It was a long time ago and was short and sweet. Busted my knee when I was twenty-two.”

“Yeah,” John said with a laugh. “He used to be a hooker, same as Meg.”

Meg glared at him, then turned to the last man. “And this is Paul, the baby of our outfit.”

A guy who looked about Nicole’s age smiled and shook her hand. He had black hair pulled into a short ponytail and eyes as blue as Ciaran’s. “Hi.”

“There’s also Ted, but you’ll meet him tonight,” Meg added. “Right guys, you’ll all see Nicole again later. Please be nice to her, because I won’t be there to slap your wrists.”

John laughed. “You can count on us to keep a close eye on her.”

“Not too close.” Meg led Nicole back toward the office. “They’re all lovely guys really. We’re lucky to have them.”

“Do you work here?” Nicole hadn’t seen any payments to Meg in the accounts.

“No, I’m a nurse. I just like to call here to see everyone whenever I can.”

“And you’re not coming to the dinner?”

“No, employees only.” Meg pushed open the door and saw Will and Ciaran in deep conversation at the desk. Their faces were serious, which made Meg frown.

When they looked over, Nicole could tell that Will wasn’t happy.

“Is everything alright?” Meg asked.

“Not really,” Will said. “We’ll talk about it later.”

“Okay...” She glanced at Ciaran, then back at Nicole. “Well I’m off now, so if you want, I can drop Nicole off at The Galmont and you two can carry on here.”

“That’d be great if you could.” Ciaran looked at Nicole. “Is that okay with you?”

“Yes, fine.” She turned to Meg. “If you’re sure you don’t mind.”

“No problem. We can call for a coffee on the way.”

“The car’s unlocked if you want to get your bags,” Ciaran said.

Outside, Nicole left her suit in Ciaran’s car but took her holdall and leather jacket.

“Will doesn’t look too pleased about something,” Meg said as she manoeuvred out of the space and through the gates onto the main thoroughfare of the industrial park. She turned to Nicole. “Do you know what it’s all about?”

“I suspect Ciaran’s just revealed his plan to sell his share of the business.”

“What?” Meg shook her head. “Is that what...? *Fuck!*” She turned to Nicole with wide eyes. “Sorry about the language, but this...” She shook her head again. “This is a bit of a shock.” She stopped at the junction with the main road. “Why does he want to do that now? We’ve had so many enquiries about new work. Will was thinking we might even need to hire another engineer, but now...” She dragged her fingers through her hair.

“I’m sorry,” Nicole said. “I was surprised too.”

“How long’s he been planning this?”

“I’ve no idea. He only told me yesterday, which was the first time I’ve seen him in quite a while.”

“How come?”

“Well, we’re not exactly close.”

“Aren’t you two an item?”

“No.” Nicole wasn’t sure what Meg knew about her, or about the relationship she’d had with Ciaran.

“Sorry. I thought you two were seeing each other.”

Nicole sighed. “I’m actually married. What I had with Ciaran was just a brief fling, which my husband knew about.”

“God, I had no idea.” Meg looked stunned. “I’m sorry for being so... I didn’t know any of that. I just knew that Ciaran was keen. He talked about you constantly at Christmas, and he’s never done that about any of the other women he’s seen.”

“That’s a surprise, because it was over by then.”

“Oh. Well, it’s none of my business, and I’m sorry for bringing it up.” Meg concentrated on her driving for a few moments. “Do you mind if we have a coffee at our house instead?”

“No, but if it’s too much trouble—”

“It’s no bother, I just don’t feel like going to a café now.”

Their house was in a row of old stone cottages. The ceilings were low with exposed beams, and the floors were polished quarry tiles. The entire ground floor had been converted into a large open-plan area, with the kitchen at the back.

“What a fabulous house,” Nicole said, following Meg to the kitchen from where a set of French doors led to a paved area. “You’ve even got a sea view.”

“They used to be fisherman’s cottages. We’ve spent the last two years doing this up.” She picked up the kettle. “Tea or coffee?”

“Could I have tea, please?”

“I’ll have the same. I could do with something a little stronger, but I’ll need to drive you to your hotel.”

“If you want something stronger, I can get a taxi back to my hotel.”

Meg thought about it, then nodded. “Tea first, then see how we’re feeling.”

They sat at the circular pine table and chatted about the business that Will and Ciaran owned.

“Will got made redundant a few years back, and he used his redundancy money to start the business. It was just Will at first, with Brian and Ted helping him out a couple of days a week. They’d all been laid off at the same time, but the others took early retirement.

“Then Ciaran offered to put some money in, and the business grew from there. We got the new premises, took on John and Donal, and started to see a profit. We hired Paul last year, and—”

A mobile phone rang somewhere, and Meg stood up and walked to retrieve it from the kitchen countertop. She clicked it and put it to her ear. “Hiya.” She listened for a few seconds, then said, “Yes, Nicole’s already told me.”

She was obviously talking to her husband. A fresh wave of guilt washed over Nicole.

“We’re actually at home because I didn’t feel like... Oh, okay. See you in a bit.” Meg put her phone down and sat back opposite Nicole. “Ciaran’s dropped his bombshell then gone to see his family. Will’s coming back here now, so he can run you to the hotel and we can have a real drink. Gin and tonic okay?”

“That’ll be fine, thanks.”

Meg fixed the drinks and brought over two tall tumblers, placing one in front of Nicole. “Cheers.”

By the time Will arrived, the women were halfway down their second glass. He walked through to the back of the house and gave Nicole an embarrassed smile.

“Are you alright?” Meg asked him.

There were only two chairs at the kitchen table, so Will leaned against the kitchen counter. He shook his head. “I’m still in shock.”

Nicole studied his face. Even though she was still angry with him, she could see the worry etched on his face. “How much is Ciaran’s share worth?”

He scoffed. “He seems to think it’s worth ninety grand.”

“*What?*” Meg shook her head. “How the fuck is it...?” She turned to Nicole. “Sorry, again. I can’t believe Ciaran believes it’s worth that much.” She looked up at Will. “If his share is worth that, then maybe we should sell up as well.”

“We might not have a choice. He seems to think one of the big boys will buy him out to get the contracts. He says they’ll keep us all on, but I

doubt it. Why would they, when they have their own factory and their own engineers?”

“How much do *you* think it’s worth?” Nicole asked again.

“I really hadn’t thought about it. He’s obviously spent some time working things out...” He studied Nicole’s face. “Did you know about it?”

“Not until yesterday.”

“Nicole and Ciaran aren’t seeing each other anymore,” Meg informed him.

“Oh?” Will looked embarrassed again. “I’m sorry, I didn’t know that. He never said anything about—”

“It was over by Christmas,” Meg informed him.

Will blinked but didn’t say anything.

Nicole put down her glass. “I was talking to my husband, and it’s possible we may be in a position to help.”

“How?” Will asked.

“We’d like to invest in the business, though there’s no way we could raise ninety grand.”

“I think Ciaran’s over-estimating how much it’s worth.” Will walked through to the middle of the room and picked up a pine stool. After carrying it back to the table, he sat down and looked at Nicole. “How much could you and your husband invest?”

They spent twenty minutes discussing the possibility of raising the money to buy Ciaran out of the business. Meg suggested asking the other men if they wanted to buy in, and also said her parents might be able to help financially.

It had gone dark outside by the time Meg asked Will to drive Nicole to her hotel. “Take her in my car, because her bag’s in the boot.”

Nicole gave Meg a warm hug goodbye, but once inside the car, she glared at Will. “What the fuck were you thinking when you came over to England?”

“I didn’t have time to th—”

“Bollocks, you had plenty of time. How could you cheat on her? She’s gorgeous, and she deserves better.”

“I know.”

“So why?”

He shrugged. “I don’t know. It was all a bit of a blur. You waltzed into Ciaran’s office and flashed your stocking-tops, and—”

“I thought we were alone.”

“Yeah, but he’d told me about this new woman he was seeing, how you were the sexiest thing he’d ever met, and how your husband actually liked the idea of you—”

“He had no right to tell you any of that.” Anger flared inside.

“I didn’t ask him anything,” Will assured her. “He was brimming over with all the tales. He told me you’d seduced him in his office during a thunderstorm.”

“I didn’t seduce him, I just sucked him off.”

Will’s jaw dropped.

She shook her head. “Have you any idea how awful I felt, drinking and chatting to Meg, knowing what we’d done in that hotel room?”

“I’m sorry. If Ciaran had suggested anything before I saw you, I’d have said no. But when you came into his office looking all gorgeous and acting like—”

“A whore?”

“No! No, you were just...” He shook his head again, clearly flustered. “I know it was wrong, and there were a hundred reasons why I should have stayed in the bar while you two went to the room, but...” He shook his head. “That was before Ciaran mentioned you coming over to Ireland. I didn’t think I was likely to see you again anytime soon. I’m sorry, I know that’s not any kind of excuse.”

Nicole stared at him and shook her head. Could she really blame him? Wouldn’t most men have taken advantage if a woman had behaved the way she had? “You’d better start driving, or Meg will wonder what we’re talking about.”

He nodded, put the car in gear and pulled away from the kerb. “I didn’t know it was all over between you and Ciaran.”

“It stopped after that night with you.”

“Really? I thought you’d had a good time.”

“I did, but afterwards I was angry about being manipulated.”

Will was silent for a few moments. “I was torn about whether to confess to Meg about—”

“Don’t, for God’s sake. Nothing good will come of it. It could end up ruining your relationship.”

“Yet you share everything with your husband.”

“Yes, but that’s because we have an arrangement that we *both* like. How would you feel about another man fucking Meg?”

“It’d drive me mad.”

“Well, the chances are she’d feel the same way.”

He nodded. “You’re right. It’s just that...” He shook his head.

Nicole looked at him. Saw his grim profile illuminated by each streetlight they passed. “You have a lovely wife and a lovely home, Will. It was stupid to risk losing them for a couple of hours of illicit fun.”

“I know.” He gave a shy grin. “Though I’m too ashamed to admit how many times I’ve thought about that night.”

She sighed. “Yeah, you’re not the only one. While I hate myself for going along with it, another part of me...” She shook her head. “What’s done is done. I haven’t let it ruin my life, and you shouldn’t let it ruin yours.”

“No, but he’s started...” He sighed, then slowed the car down. “Right, there’s The Galmont.”

Nicole looked at the hotel. It was much bigger than she’d expected. Will steered the car to the area in front of the steps and got out. He lifted Nicole’s bag from the boot and passed it to her. “I’ll see you later.”

She nodded. “I’ll call Julian and tell him what you said about raising the rest of the cash. You must also get an independent valuation as soon as you can.”

He nodded. “Okay. Well, I’ll see you in a couple of hours.”

Nicole walked into the hotel and checked in. Fifteen minutes later she was in the bath, drinking another gin and tonic from the minibar. When

her glass was empty she got out, wrapped herself in the white fluffy robe and called her husband.

“Hi,” he said, sounding a little breathless.

“Are you alright?” She heard the sound of a car door being closed.

“Yes, I’m just...” There was a muffled noise, then the sound of their front door being slammed. “Sorry, I’m just home. I’ve called for some groceries on the way.” There was another muffled sound, presumably as he put down the shopping bags, then his voice came through clearly. “So, how was the drive across country?”

“Well I didn’t give him a blowjob, but it was okay. Horrible weather. I couldn’t see much of the countryside.”

“So you’re now in Galway?”

“Yes, in a very nice hotel.”

“Two rooms?”

“No, Ciaran’s staying with his parents. We went to the factory today so that I could meet the rest of the workforce before tonight’s dinner.”

“And did you meet Will again?”

“Yes. And I also met his wife.”

“Ah...”

Nicole could imagine Julian’s face as he considered this information. “And how was that?”

“Awkward. I had no idea he was married, and I felt guilty because she’s so lovely. She took me back to their house for a drink.”

“Is she aware of what happened?”

“No, thank God. Anyway, what I wanted to tell you was that Will reckons some of the other guys might be interested in raising the money to help buy Ciaran’s share. Are you sure it’s what you want to do?”

“Yes. I’ve thought about it, and you seem to like the business, so definitely.”

“Okay, good. Well, I suppose I’d better start getting ready.”

“What dress did you take with you?”

“I took your advice and brought a tight little black number.”

“And underwear?”

“The silk basque you chose.”

“Nice. What about shoes?”

“The strappy black sandals you bought for me, along with a pair of fine-meshed fishnet stockings.”

“Wonderful. You’ll be giving heart-attacks dressed like that.”

She giggled. “The men are actually younger than I’d imagined. The part-timers all took early retirement when they were made redundant. They’re in their fifties, but there are a couple of younger guys—an ex-rugby player in his forties and a guy about my age.”

“Well, maybe you’ll get lucky then.”

“If we’re going to be investing, me behaving like a slut probably wouldn’t be a good idea.”

“I’m not so sure—they might consider it quite a perk to have someone like you on the Board.” He gave a dirty laugh. “Though they’d probably prefer to have you on the boardroom table.”

“Right, I’m going before your fantasies get too crude. Do you want me to call you when I get back to my hotel?”

“Yes, that’d be nice.”

“Even if I’m not alone?”

“If that’s the case, FaceTime me.”

“Pervert.” Giggling, she ended the call.

$$\Psi$$

Chapter Nine

Ciaran walked into the hotel bar wearing yet another designer suit, this one dark blue with a subtle pinstripe. His eyes raked over her. “Wow, you look fantastic.”

“Thank you.”

“Is that gin?”

She nodded.

“Do you want a top up?”

“No thanks.”

He ordered himself the same from the bar, and they took their drinks to a table.

Ciaran’s eyes glanced down when Nicole crossed her legs. When he saw that she’d caught him looking, he shrugged. “Sorry. You’re a hard habit to break.”

“Isn’t that a song title?”

“Probably.” He gave a wry smile. “Am I not allowed to miss you?”

“You can miss what we had, but not me. All we were doing was allowing our bodies to enjoy each other’s.”

“It was more than—”

“No, Ciaran. It wasn’t.”

He bit his lip, then sighed. “It was for me.”

“Then I’m sorry.”

Ciaran looked away, and they drank in silence for a couple of minutes. Once the drinks were finished, he stood up. “I guess we should be getting to the restaurant.”

Nicole followed him through reception and out of the hotel. It was a cold night, and she pulled her shawl tighter around her shoulders.

He nodded toward a side road. “The restaurant’s just down there. It’ll only take us a couple of minutes to get there.”

The combination of cobbled pavements, four-inch heels and tight dress meant it actually took them closer to five minutes.

The restaurant door, which displayed a sign saying Private Party, opened into a small hall. Will and the other engineers—all dressed in suits and ties—stood at the bar at the back of the dining area. When they noticed Nicole, all conversation stopped, and they stared at her.

She gave them a shy smile. “Hello again,” she said.

All of them started talking at once. They gathered round her, offering drinks and compliments. She asked for a gin and tonic and thanked them all for the nice things they said about her dress.

The only man she didn’t recognise introduced himself as Ted, who explained that he only worked Monday to Wednesday. He was probably the oldest of them all and also the shortest. In her heels, Nicole was slightly taller.

As John delivered her drink, one of the facemask-clad restaurant staff approached and offered to take her shawl. Nicole slid it from her bare shoulders and passed it to the waiter. Another brief silence ensued as all the men took in her form. The dress had a fitted waist and hugged the contours of her hips and thighs. The cold night had also raised her nipples so that they were hard behind the silk of the basque, but she hoped that this wasn’t obvious.

While Nicole was receiving all the attention from the other men, she saw Will talking to Ciaran near the bar. After a few more minutes, a waiter requested everyone move through to the dining area and sit at the table. Nicole felt a hand on the small of her back and looked up to see John herding her to the far side of the table.

“You come and sit over here with the workers,” he said. “Let the management sort out what’s going on between them.”

Nicole was more than happy with this arrangement. The large, circular table was lit with candles. Ciaran and Will were almost directly opposite Nicole, who sat between John and Donal, with Brian and Ted to her left and Paul to her right between Donal and Will.

As the waiter took their orders, Nicole was aware of all eyes continually glancing her way. Paul, the youngest engineer, couldn't seem to keep his eyes off her.

John and Donal kept Nicole entertained all through the first course, each telling bawdy stories. They kept her wine glass topped up and by the time the main course was delivered, she'd laughed so much she feared her eye-liner would run.

Brian and Ted were obviously old friends and were more old-fashioned than John and Donal. They told her about growing up in Galway, and how each had acted as best man for the other's wedding. Ted had been married over thirty-five years, but Brian's wife had died of cancer fifteen years ago, at only forty years old.

Every time Ciaran tried to interrupt her conversation with the engineers, John would talk over him, which she found amusing. Before dessert was served, Ciaran excused himself and headed to the loo. As soon as he'd left the room, Brian asked Will if he'd told Ciaran about the plan.

Will looked at Nicole. "After I'd dropped you at the hotel, I called these guys and told them to get here early so we could all talk. Everyone's agreed to put up some money to buy Ciaran's share, so we—" he waved his hand at everyone at the table "—will be in charge from now on."

Nicole smiled. "That's great news."

"And how's he taken it?" John asked, nodding toward the door through which Ciaran had left. "The queer 'un?"

The other men giggled.

"That's their name for Ciaran," Will explained to Nicole. He looked around at the men. "He's happy. He keeps saying he'd only have sold to another company if they'd guarantee all our jobs—"

"Yeah, sure he would." Brian shook his head. "Tosser."

"Well," said Will, "as soon as it's sorted, we'll be the new Board."

All the men whooped.

Ciaran finally returned, and dessert was served. More wine was ordered, and John and Donal both pressed their legs against Nicole's under the table as they regaled her with more smutty stories from their pasts. Paul

continued to watch her. Even when he was talking to other people, his gaze rarely veered away for long.

When coffee and petit fours were served, Donal insisted Nicole also have a brandy. “This will be the last company dinner we’re not paying for, so let’s enjoy it,” he said. “Next year I’ll be overseeing the bar bill, and you’ll all be limited to one glass of wine each.”

Jeers rang around the table, and Brian threw a rolled-up napkin at him.

Once the coffee had been finished, they all moved back to the bar area while the waiters cleared the table. The men ordered more drinks from the bar. Nicole still had a full glass of white wine and half of her brandy, so declined a top-up. Spirits were high as everyone chatted and laughed.

It was getting late, and the restaurant staff were obviously eager to close. Brian invited everyone back to his house because he lived closest. His suggestion was greeted with nods of approval.

“How far is it?” Nicole asked.

“About a mile,” John said.

“A mile? These shoes are not—”

“Those shoes are perfect,” John assured her. “Besides, we’ll be getting a taxi. The guy can do a couple of trips, no problem.”

A taxi was ordered and as they all stood around finishing their drinks, Ciaran wandered over to stand by Nicole.

“Are you sure you want to go back to a house with all these guys?” Ciaran asked.

“Of course. They’re my colleagues now.”

“It’s just that they seem a bit...” He shrugged. “I don’t think they’re used to women who dress like... that.”

She stared at him. “Like what?”

“You know. I think that style’s a little racier than they’re used to.” His eyes bored into hers, and she could tell he didn’t approve of the way she’d been laughing and flirting.

“Do you think I look too cheap, Ciaran?”

“No, I’m not saying that. I just—”

“Well lads,” Ted announced. “I’m going to love you and leave you.” He walked over to Nicole, took her hand and raised it to his lips. “It was a pleasure to meet you, Nicole. I look forward to seeing you again.”

“Thank you, Ted.” She stepped closer and kissed his cheek. “It was lovely to meet you, too.”

* * * *

Brian’s house was a small cottage overlooking Galway Bay. Inside it was snug and warm, so she left her shawl on a chair. Drinks were passed around, Nicole choosing a beer rather than a shot of tequila or an Irish whisky.

Like in the restaurant, Paul couldn’t seem to keep his eyes off her. Deciding he was obviously shy, she went over and started a conversation. He seemed nervous at first, but soon became more relaxed and talkative. He’d grown up in Cork and had moved to Galway ten years ago after securing an apprenticeship on leaving school.

Out of the corner of her eye, Nicole noticed that Will and Ciaran were getting more animated as their conversation became heated. The other men in the room had noticed, too.

As Will strode into the kitchen, Nicole approached Ciaran.

“What was that all about?” she asked him quietly.

“Nothing.”

“It didn’t look like nothing.”

“What I should have said was, nothing to do with you.”

Nicole blinked, shocked at the venom in his tone. If her reflexes hadn’t been dulled by alcohol and the warmth of the camaraderie she’d felt part of all evening, she would have responded with a barbed comment of her own. As it was, she turned her back and followed Will through to the kitchen.

She found him rummaging through a drawer. “Hey, are you okay?” she asked.

He looked at her bottle of beer. “How did you open that?” Glancing down into the drawer again, he shook his head. “I can’t find—”

She passed the opener from the counter behind him.

“Oh, cheers.”

Nicole could see from Will’s expression that he was still seething. “Was Ciaran being awkward about selling the business?” she asked.

“No, I think he’s happy that he won’t have to tout it round to prospective buyers.”

“So,” she said, tipping her head towards the room they’d just left. “What was all that about?”

He chewed his lip, as if unsure of whether to divulge the real reason behind the argument with his cousin.

“Will?” Nicole stepped closer and looked up into his eyes. He was clearly upset about something.

“Ciaran’s been... suggesting things for a while. He keeps reminding me about how much fun we’d all had together that night in my hotel room. He seems to think I owe him something.”

Nicole frowned. She wouldn’t put it past Ciaran to ask for a high price for his share of the business in exchange for his discretion regarding Will’s night with them in England.

Will glanced at the door to make sure nobody else would overhear. “When I found out you and Ciaran had stopped seeing each other, I asked him why he’d kept talking about you all Christmas. Or, to be more specific, I asked him why he kept talking about you in front of Meg.”

A chill settled in Nicole’s stomach. “Was he threatening to tell Meg unless you paid top dollar?”

“What?” Will shook his head, obviously confused. “No, nothing like that. It’s not money he wants.”

“Then what is it?”

“Meg.” Will clenched his jaw and shook his head. “He said that since he’d agreed to share his woman with me, it was only right that I did the same.”

“*What?*”

“He says if I don’t convince Meg to take us both on—like you did—then he might let it slip about what the three of us got up to in England.”

Nicole saw red and stormed out of the kitchen before she had any idea of what she was about to do. Ciaran was standing alone in the place where he’d been arguing with Will. She stopped in front of him and slapped him as hard as she could across the face.

The room went quiet.

“You fucking weasel,” she said through clenched teeth. “I was never yours to barter with. You were nothing more than a piece of meat.” She saw a glass of red wine on a nearby windowsill and, before she could think about the consequences, she’d picked it up and thrown the contents in Ciaran’s face, covering his shirt, tie and suit.

Ciaran stared at her in mute shock.

Nicole leaned close and looked into his wide eyes. “You fucking *wanker!*” With that, she turned on her heels and stomped back into the kitchen, passing a stunned looking Will in the doorway.

She heard quiet conversation from the living room, then the firm thud of the front door closing. A few seconds later, peals of laughter rang through the house. All the engineers trooped into the kitchen, grinning. John kissed the palm she’d used to slap Ciaran.

She turned to Brian. “I’m so sorry, I hope I haven’t ruined your carpet.”

“A small price to pay for what you’ve just done.”

The others added their approval, nodding and laughing. “He’s had something like that coming for a long time...”

“Always talking down to us, thinks he’s the dog’s bollocks...”

“Thinks his English education makes him the sharpest tool in the box...”

John was still holding Nicole’s hand. “Anyone who spends that much time preening himself deserves a slap. He gets his eyebrows sculpted, for fuck’s sake.”

“Yeah, and probably wears man-scara as well,” Paul added with a laugh.

“This,” Brian announced, “deserves to be toasted.” He opened a cupboard and took out a bottle of whisky. “If that isn’t worth a 15-year malt, I don’t know what is.”

He lined up six non-matching glasses on the countertop, then poured a generous measure into each. Once he’d handed everyone a glass, he raised his own. “To Nicole, our feisty new member—”

“And gorgeous,” Donal pointed out, which received numerous murmurs of agreement.

“Our feisty *and* gorgeous new member of the Board.”

Everyone took a drink. The strong liquor made Nicole cough and John patted her back.

“Sorry,” she said. “I don’t usually have trouble swallowing.”

The men stared in stunned silence until Donal whooped and passed his empty glass to Brian. “Now *that’s* worth another toast.”

Brian refilled Donal’s glass, then went round the circle topping up everyone else’s. “To Nicole, our feisty, gorgeous and dirtiest new member of the Board.”

“Who swallows,” John added, before knocking back his drink in a single gulp.

Everyone made their way back into the living room and settled on the easy chairs. The conversation moved to buying out Ciaran’s share, and the men’s excitement about being more involved.

“To be honest,” Will said. “The way things are looking, I reckon it’ll only take us a couple of years to make enough for you all to get your investment back. We’ll pay cash bonuses at the end of each year.”

“And because it’s repaying the director’s loan,” Nicole pointed out, “there’ll be no tax to pay on it.”

“Good point. After that, whatever you guys make will be profit and will be taxable. But if you want to sell up and get out, then hopefully we’ll be in a position to give you a fair price.”

Brian was grinning. “I like the idea of keeping my share and retiring, knowing that all your hard work is paying for me to go fishing on my boat every day of the week.”

For the next thirty minutes or so, the mood remained high. Nicole noticed that the engineers were far more relaxed now that Ciaran had left. She'd never imagined that they'd resented his involvement in the business, and she doubted it'd ever occurred to Ciaran, either. She had a nice warm feeling about the atmosphere and felt a real kinship with the men in the room.

She returned to the kitchen to get another bottle of beer, and found Will topping up his whisky.

"I'm sorry for making a scene," she said.

He smiled. "Don't apologise. Most of this is my own fault. It was my actions in England that brought it on, and—"

"No it wasn't. What you do has nothing to do with Ciaran. I still can't believe he was trying to get you to let him..." She shook her head. "That is such an awful thing to do."

Will shrugged. "Ciaran's been getting his own way with women for as long as I can remember. He's always fancied Meg, even when we were teenagers."

"You've known her that long?"

He nodded. "Childhood sweethearts. Met at high school and been together for more than half our lives."

"Then why the hell did you—?"

"I don't know. Like I told you in the car, it all happened so fast. You were this sexy thing that Ciaran kept going on about. I'd only ever slept with Meg, and when you..." He shook his head.

"Never admit to what happened. I promise if Meg asks, I'll deny it. I'll say it's just Ciaran trying to get his own way."

Will nodded toward the door. "You've got that lot in the palm of your hand, too."

She giggled. "I think I'd need both hands."

He turned serious. "I mean it, they can't keep their eyes off you. Every time you cross your legs, I worry that Paul will nip upstairs for a wank."

“Ha ha!” She stepped closer to him, looking up into his dark eyes. “As you know only too well, I could give him something much better than a wank.”

“Nicole, don’t—”

“Shh.” She put her finger to his lips. “Please don’t turn into Ciaran. I’m having fun. If they want to ogle me, that’s fine by me. I’m having a really nice time, and if I want it to progress into something else, then it’s not for you to tell me otherwise.”

“Sorry, I just wouldn’t want you to get yourself into a situation you’re uncomfortable with. I was worried you might not be aware that—”

“I’m very aware of their eyes, and their thoughts.” She smiled. “And I have to confess, the idea of being the centre of their attention is making my heart race.”

Will stared at her. “Nic—”

“Are any of them married?”

“What? No. John’s divorced. Donal lived with someone for ages, but she’s moved away. Brian’s a widower and Paul’s probably too shy to talk to girls.”

“Perfect.”

“You can’t possibly... I mean, not with all of them.”

“Not all.” She smiled at him. “Nothing will happen until you leave.”

“What?”

“You’re going to take a taxi home, and you’re going to make love to your beautiful wife. Whatever I do here won’t be anything like as sensual, but it’ll be something that my husband and I will both enjoy.” She nodded toward the living room. “And so will those four.”

“Nicole, you... You can’t take on four guys.”

She grinned. “Want to bet?”

He frowned. “How many drinks have you had?”

“A lot, but I won’t wake up tomorrow with no memory of what took place, if that’s what you’re worried about.”

“I think you should phone your husband, like you did before you came up to the room with me and Ciaran. Would you do that for me?”

Just..." He shrugged. "Just to put my mind at rest."

Nicole smiled. "You're a nice guy." She wandered into the living room and found her bag.

"Please don't tell me you're leaving already," John said from the couch.

She smiled at him, aware that his eyes were on her backside as she'd bent to take out her phone. "Oh no, the night's still young." It was actually past one in the morning. "I'm just going to phone Will a taxi, because he needs his beauty sleep."

He'd already called one by the time she'd returned to the kitchen. "Ten minutes," he said.

"Good. Thank you." Nicole phoned Julian, who answered on the second ring. "Hi," she said, her eyes locked on Will's. "Were you asleep?"

"No, though I am in bed. How was your evening?"

"It's been... entertaining."

"Ah, that sounds promising."

"Don't get excited. Nothing like that's happened."

"Oh."

"Yet."

"Oh?" She heard a muffled rustling as Julian sat up in bed. "You mean something might happen?" he asked.

"Maybe. At the moment I'm standing in the kitchen with Will."

"Will?"

"Yes, you remember me telling you about him?"

"Of course I do."

"Yes, he did. And in my mouth." Will's eyes widened, and she smiled at her own wickedness.

Julian caught on quickly. "Ah. So he's listening to this conversation?"

Nicole smiled. "Only my half of it."

"I see. So is Will—?"

“Oh no, he’s just called a taxi to take him home to his gorgeous wife.”

“Right. What about Ciaran?”

“Gone home to change his clothes. I’ll explain when I get home, though I might have to book a plane ticket now.”

Julian was quiet for a few moments. “Is everything alright?”

“Yes, everything’s fine. That’s why I phoned you. Actually, it was Will who insisted I call you because he’s a little worried about me.”

“Why is he worried?”

“Well, once he’s gone, I’ll be alone in the house with four men.”

“Four men?”

“Hmm.”

“The engineers from the company?”

“That’s right, though they’re actually soon going to be members of the Board. And Will seems to think I’ve had too much to drink to make any rash decisions.”

“Decisions about what?”

“Apparently all four of them have been ogling me all night. Will was suggesting that they were actually lusting after me. He reckons they’ve been looking at my legs.”

“I see...”

“Do you think four at once would be too many?”

Julian was quiet for several seconds. Nicole wished she could see his expression.

“Erm...” His voice was a rasp. “Do *you* think it’d be too many?”

“I’m sure I could cope.”

“Yes, I’ve no doubt that you could.” From his voice, it sounded like he was smiling.

“There’s a problem, though.”

“Oh?”

“I’d imagined that if something sexy was going to happen tonight, it would have been in my room. So that’s where I’ve left the condoms.”

“The condoms are in your hotel?”

“Hmm.” She gazed into Will’s eyes. “So I’ll have to take all four guys bareback.” Julian went completely silent, but Nicole had no intention of letting Will know that. “Yes,” she went on, lowering her voice to a husky whisper. “That’ll be a lot of cum.”

Will’s expression was one of complete awe.

“So, you’re happy for me to do it?”

Julian’s ragged breathing was loud in her ear. “Yes, more than happy. Is it going to happen now?”

“No. Once Will’s left, I’ll go and join the others and have a drink. Maybe do a bit of flirting, flash a little stocking-top.”

“Call me beforehand.”

She was surprised by his request, but smiled. “Okay. Speak later.” She blew him a kiss and ended the call.

Will looked like he’d just got off a rollercoaster. “Jeez, I didn’t know couples like you existed outside of dirty films.”

She laughed, and just then someone shouted that a taxi had pulled up outside.

Will frowned at Nicole. “Give me your phone.”

She did so.

He keyed in a number, and then his own mobile rang. “There, we’ve now got each other’s number.” He handed her phone back, then sighed. “I wish I was staying.”

She hugged him close. “No you don’t. Go home and enjoy the best woman in your life.”

He nodded, then they walked out into the hall together. Nicole went into the living room and Will poked his head in through the doorway.

“Guys, thanks for a great night. I’ll see you all on Monday.”

There were numerous farewell calls from the others.

“Can somebody make sure Nicole gets back to the Galmont for me?” he said.

John held up a hand. “You can count on us, boss.”

Will laughed. “Yeah, that’s what I’m worried about.” He turned to Nicole. “We’ll have a catch-up about the business. I’m sure Ciaran will phone you about the ferry but call me if there are any problems.”

Nicole flashed him a warm smile. After he’d left, she looked around at the men sitting on the 3-piece suite. “Is there room for a small one?”

John and Donal made space between them on the couch. Brian got up from his armchair to refill everyone’s glass with whisky, and Paul, in the other armchair, now stared blatantly at Nicole’s legs as she sat down. She gave him a smile. Brian handed her another glass of whisky, which she managed to sip without coughing at all.

She turned to John. “See, I can swallow.”

He gave a dirty laugh.

“Do you think I was too harsh on Ciaran?” she asked.

John stroked his chin. “I don’t know what it was about, but to be honest, I don’t really care. Anyone who slaps that twat is alright in my book, though it *was* my Malbec you threw at him.”

“Sorry, I’ll buy you a new bottle.” She looked over at Brian. “And I’ll buy you some carpet shampoo.”

They chatted for a few more minutes with Nicole enjoying the heat of the men on either side of her. She waited until Paul looked back at her legs, then slowly crossed them. The hem of her dress rode up, and she could feel the cool leather of the seat on the back of her bare thigh.

“I like your shoes,” Donal said.

“Thank you.” Nicole pointed her upper leg out in front of her, turning her ankle this way and that. “My husband calls them my fuck-me shoes.”

The men cast furtive glances at each other. “And does he know you’re wearing them tonight?” John asked.

“Oh yes.” She turned and looked up into his eyes. “It was his idea that I wear them tonight.”

This left him speechless, which made her giggle.

“Does he know you’re here now?” Donal asked.

“Yes, I phoned him earlier. At Will’s request.”

“Will suggested you phone your husband back in England in the early hours of the morning?”

She nodded. “Hmm.”

Donal looked bemused. “And what did he say?”

“Will?”

“No, your husband. What did he say about you being here in your fuck-me shoes?”

“He asked if I was wearing them with stockings.”

“And are you?”

Nicole turned to look at Paul, whose gaze hadn’t moved since she’d crossed her legs. “Ask Paul.”

Paul looked up at Donal, glanced at John, then looked back at her hem line. “She is. And suspenders.”

John closed his eyes. “Oh my fuck...”

“Don’t you like stockings, John?”

“I *love* stockings.”

“Good. Would you like to see them?”

The four men all glanced at each other again.

“Well I don’t know about these three,” Brian said, leaning forward in his chair, “but I would.”

Nicole smiled at him, then slowly stood up. She was drunk, but not *that* drunk. Her hands trembled as she put her drink down on the coffee table, but that was more to do with her excitement than the alcohol. Her dress fastened under one arm, and after pulling the zipper down she swayed her hips and let the dress slide down and off her body. Stepping out of it, she stood in front of the four men in her basque, thong, suspender belt and stockings.

“Oh my fuck,” John said again.

“You like?” Nicole turned slowly through a full three-sixty.

John reached up and ran his hand slowly down Nicole’s leg. “God, I’ve not seen anything like this in...” He shook his head “Ever.”

She looked at Brian. “Is there anywhere that might be more comfortable?”

“The bedroom?”

Nicole looked around at them. “The bedroom sounds perfect...”

The men stood up as one.

“But first,” she went on, “I have to phone my husband.”

All four men stopped in their tracks, and she giggled. “Don’t worry, he just asked me to let him know when the fun was going to start.”

They exchanged shocked looks, and Nicole strode through to the kitchen to get her phone. She came back into the living room and looked at Brian. “I assume the bedroom’s upstairs?”

He nodded, and Nicole moved through the hall and started up the stairs. All four men quickly followed her.

“To the left,” Brian said, and Nicole pushed open the door. The huge room featured a king-sized bed under a single wall light. The curtains were already closed.

She stepped over to the far wall and turned round to look at the men, then called Julian. With the phone pressed to her ear, she gave them a confident smile.

“Hi,” she said when Julian picked up.

“Hello.” He sounded breathless already.

“You told me to call you back when things started to heat up.”

“And are they heating up now?”

Nicole looked around the room at the four men staring at her. “I’m hoping things are about to get pretty hot.” She saw John slip off his jacket and drop it on the floor near the wall. Donal did the same.

“Are you still in the kitchen?” Julian asked.

“No, I’m in a bedroom.”

“Has Will gone home?”

“Mm-hmm.”

“But the other four are still there?”

“Yeah, they’re all here.”

“And what’s happened so far?”

“Nothing’s happened yet.” She looked down at herself. “Except that I decided to leave my dress downstairs.”

“So you’re in the bedroom with four men wearing just your underwear?”

“And my shoes.” She grinned at Donal. “Yes, the fuck-me ones.”

“I want to see you.”

“What?” Nicole was puzzled.

“I want to watch it. I’ll FaceTime you. Put your phone where it shows the action, or better still, let the men hold the phone.”

“Are you serious?”

“Very. I’ll call you using my iPad. End this call and I’ll call you. Then answer the phone, pass it to one of the men and get whoever isn’t involved at that time to film the action so I can watch it.”

Before Nicole could reply, he’d ended the call. She looked up at the men. “He wants to watch it on FaceTime.”

They all glanced at each other, then shrugged. When Nicole’s phone rang she jumped, then accepted the call.

The screen was blank, but Julian’s voice came over the loudspeaker. “Tap the screen, then choose the ‘Flip’ icon.”

Nicole did as instructed, and the screen filled with the view from the camera lens on the back of the phone, as if shooting a normal video.

“Right,” said Julian, “now pass the phone to somebody else so I can see what you’re wearing.”

Nicole felt a little awkward, but Paul stepped forward and held out his hand. After she’d handed him the phone, he pointed it at her, slowly sweeping from her head down to her feet and then back up again.

“Wonderful,” Julian said. “Right, forget I’m here. Just enjoy yourselves and capture what you can.”

$$\Psi$$

Chapter Ten

Nicole looked around at the men, momentarily knocked off her stride by Julian's inclusion. She studied their expressions, looking from one face to the next. Brian looked as nervous as she felt. John and Donal both stared hungrily at her. Paul's focus was fixed on the screen of the phone, his eyes wide.

Nicole slowly walked over to the bed. After turning to face the men, she sat on the edge, tucked her thumbs inside the waistband of her thong and peeled it down her legs. This time she'd put it on over the suspenders so it could be removed without unclipping her stockings. Once the thong was off, she sat upright, stared into the lens of the phone in Paul's hand, and slowly parted her legs. John let out a low sigh and Paul angled the phone lower, moving two fingers on the screen to no doubt zoom in on her exposed sex.

Nicole's head buzzed. She wasn't sure if it was due to the alcohol, her arousal, or nerves. During her first threesome, she'd had some sort of routine planned. By following her husband's prior instructions, she'd gotten over the awkward first hurdle by dropping to her knees and sucking Ciaran and Will in turn.

Nicole gave them a smile, then scooted around until she was lying on her back in the centre of the bed. The men gathered round, two on either side. Hands reached down towards her, and she closed her eyes.

Fingertips, probably Brian's, traced over the fine mesh of her left leg. Another hand, warm and calloused, slid over her bare right shoulder and down her arm. That'd be Donal. A heavy hand was placed on her bare tummy and slid up over the basque, cupping her breast through the material and circling the nipple. Undoubtedly John.

Brian's hand had started at her thigh and he'd moved it downwards over her knee, slipping around from the shin to feel the contours of her calf before cradling her foot and tracing the intricate straps of her shoe. Another

hand replicated the action on her other foot, which she surmised was Paul finally joining the action.

The hands on her feet moved upwards, caressing her ankles and calves. Nicole bent her legs and let her knees fall apart. The hand on her arm moved back over her shoulder and followed her collarbone down to the centre of her chest. It pushed further, forcing the soft material of the basque down. John stopped stroking her boob and helped Donal ease the basque lower.

She felt cool air on her taut nipples as her boobs were uncovered. One of the men uttered a low growl. Both breasts were caressed at the same time, one being squeezed and lifted, the other having the nipple pinched. The hands on her legs had moved up above her stocking-tops and were now on the soft flesh of her upper thighs. She could feel her juices seeping out, and as one man traced a finger through her sopping labia, Nicole let out a groan.

The finger slid inside her and she arched up, raising her crotch to meet it, to take it deeper. Warm wetness enveloped her left nipple, instantly followed by the same on her other. John and Donal were sucking her tits, and either Brian or Paul was fingering her. She let out another groan as teeth nipped at her nipples and another hand joined the first at her sex. As the first finger eased out of her sodden channel, another replaced it. This was Paul, she felt sure. He'd been on her right, and he fingered her like a piston—in and out, short and fast. After a few seconds, he removed his hand to let Brian back in. The older and younger men played finger-tag for a couple of minutes, and she was sure they both had a finger inside at the same time at least once.

The scent of her sex was strong in the air, and a hand—probably John's—moved slowly down her belly and over her mons. Brian and Paul both retreated, now moving their sticky fingers up to her hips and waist, and John cupped her sex for a moment before sending two thick fingers deep inside her. Nicole groaned again.

It felt good, and it felt dirty, but it never threatened to provoke an orgasm.

Finally, she opened her eyes and looked up at the faces surrounding her. “Okay, I think you all know what I want now.”

John's hand remained over her sex, a fingertip flicking through the slick folds. Paul still held her phone, and it was the lens of this that Nicole stared into when she spoke.

"I want your cocks." She remembered the night Julian had narrated his fantasy about him being one of several men waiting in line. "I want you to take turns fucking me, but you're not allowed to come yet." She looked from one man to the next, then back at the phone. "Just stay inside for a while, then let someone else have a go. Let your balls get wound up tight, but don't let them unload."

They all nodded. The men were now all stripped down to shirt and trousers. Brian and Paul still wore ties, though Paul's was undone and hanging down on either side.

Nicole looked around the men. "Okay, who's going first?"

Unsurprisingly, John unbuckled his belt. He moved to the foot of the bed and took out his cock. Paul swung the phone around to capture the thick pillar of flesh jutting from John's suit trousers. John crawled up the bed and Nicole stretched her legs out, straight and wide. She smiled up at him as he leaned over her. With a lunge of his hips, his cock slid into her sopping hole.

She let out a grateful moan and undulated her body beneath him, riding him from below.

John let out little grunts as he fucked her, but after less than a minute he pulled out and got off the bed. Brian took his place, a frown of concentration on his face as he looked down at her body.

Nicole stroked her hand down his arm, trying to dispel the fleeting thought that she was behaving like a whore on the bed he'd probably shared with his late wife. She rocked her hips and held onto his backside as he fucked her. "Mmm, that feels so... Yeah, give it to me."

Brian fucked her slowly, as if relishing every single thrust. But, like John, he pulled out after only a minute or so. Donal held his hand out for the phone, which Paul eagerly passed over before he dropped his trousers to mid-thigh. He clambered between Nicole's spread thighs and ran his hand over her sex again, slipping two fingers inside then holding them up to her

mouth. Nicole parted her lips and raised her head, sucking his fingers seductively.

Paul grinned and rammed his cock home. His shyness completely gone, he fucked her hard and fast. Donal stepped back and swept the phone over their entire length, then moved close and held it overhead, filming Nicole's face over Paul's shoulder as he fucked her with a ferocity that seemed to verge on anger.

Nicole stared into the lens, her mouth hanging open and tiny yelps escaping her lips with each thrust. She slid her hands around Paul's back and raked her fingernails over his shirt, which spurred him on to fuck her harder.

John tapped Paul's shoulder gently. "Okay mate, take it easy. You'll drive her through the mattress."

Paul took a breath, then pulled out and nodded. "Sorry," he whispered to Nicole as he knelt up.

She shook her head. "Don't be. Fuck me like that when you get in again."

Donal handed the phone back to Paul. His shoulders bulged under his shirt. His chest was broad, his stomach probably not as flat as it had been during his younger days, but he was undoubtedly the most athletic man in the room. Probably the most powerfully built man Nicole had ever been with. He knelt on the bed and gave her a confident grin. Without bothering to unbuckle his belt, he unzipped and pulled out his cock. It was big. Thick and long, and an unusually dark shade of purple. The fat crown of his tip glistened with precum, and he wanked it slowly while looking into Nicole's eyes.

She took a breath, then licked her lips. "What are you waiting for?"

"Just savouring the moment." Then he leaned over her, supporting himself on one thick arm, and guided his cock to her slippery entrance.

Easing it in slowly, he showed a lot more consideration than Paul had a couple of minutes earlier. Nicole appreciated his concern. This was the biggest cock she'd ever taken. He was both longer and thicker than Ciaran. She felt herself stretching, was aware of her walls clinging tightly to the thick shaft. Maybe it was just her imagination, but she was sure she

could feel the ridges of his veins. He pulled back a little, then pushed in again. On the next thrust he gave her even more. She felt crammed to the brim, then on his next stroke he filled her.

“Oh god!” she whispered as he moved slowly in and out. The tip bashed against the roof of her cunt with every in-stroke, and she feared she’d be pulled inside out with each retreat.

John reached down and gently turned Nicole’s head towards him, offering his cock in front of her face. Nicole parted her lips and watched his face as she took him into her mouth. She swirled her tongue around the head and licked the sensitive underside of his glans, then pushed her head further toward his side of the bed and took his entire length into her throat.

Gasps of surprise escaped from Brian and Paul. John didn’t appear to be able to say anything, and Donal pushed his cock as deep as it’d go. Nicole was now fully stretched, and all she felt was pleasure.

She bobbed her head, then John held up his hand. “Whoa! You’re going to have to stop there before I...”

She released his cock from her mouth and gave him a self-satisfied smile. Paul replaced John at that side of the bed and, holding the phone close to her face, fed his own cock into her mouth. Nicole stared into the lens and fellated Paul in what she hoped was a visually thrilling way. She slobbered down the side of his shaft, used a hand to wank the base, and wiped the wet tip over her lips before swallowing it again. She wanted her husband to be jerking off while watching at home. She hoped her actions made him come so hard he left a stain on their bedroom ceiling.

Paul pulled back and looked up at Brian. “You want some of that?”

“Too fucking right, I do.”

Nicole leaned over to the opposite side of the bed and took Brian’s cock into her mouth. The cocks were different sizes and shapes but all tasted of her juices.

“Donal,” John complained. “Stop hogging the main attraction.”

With a reluctant sigh, Donal withdrew and backed off the bed. Before anyone could take his place, Nicole released Brian and sat up.

“Time for a change around.” She turned so she was lying sideways across the bed, then rolled over onto her tummy and raised herself up onto

all fours. “Let’s try two at a time, shall we? Brian, come here and put your dick back in my mouth.” She looked at the other guys. “And one of you fuck me from behind.”

As Brian held his cock in front of her face, Nicole felt a cock being lodged just inside her slit, then two hands gripped her hips and pulled her back to meet his thrust. Without turning round, she couldn’t be sure if it was Paul or John. She closed her eyes and enjoyed being spit-roasted yet again, clenching on the cock invading her from behind while working her tongue on the one in her mouth.

After a couple of minutes, Brian pulled out of her mouth, shaking his head and laughing. “If we’re not allowed to come, you’re not allowed to use your tongue like that.”

“Move over.” Donal took his place, his monster cock pointing directly at Nicole.

She stuck out her tongue and licked all around the tip, then took the fat head into her mouth. Since it was impossible to take him any deeper, she used her tongue and the insides of her cheeks to stimulate his glans.

The man behind her withdrew. “Give me the phone.” It had been John fucking her, and as he made his way around to the bottom of the bed, Paul took his place and entered Nicole again. She was starting to get sore.

John swept the phone over the scene. Paul was pounding her from behind with a woodpecker rhythm, and Donal was breathing heavily as Nicole sucked and licked the top half of his cock.

She released Donal and eased herself forward until Paul withdrew. “I think it’s time for your release.” Nicole lay back in the middle of the bed, the position she’d been in at the start. “Okay, now I want you to repeat what you did earlier.” Julian had made several references to something over the past couple of months; she didn’t know if it was actually a fantasy of his, but it had become one for her. “Take yourself all the way, but I want you to pull out and shoot it over me. I don’t care where you come. Just make sure it lands somewhere on my body.”

John pushed his way to the front of the queue and got on the bed. Without any preamble he entered with force, sending his cock balls-deep in a single stab. Holding himself up on straight arms, he jackhammered his

hips. His eyes were closed, and his brow covered in a sheen of sweat. Eventually his breathing became short gasps. Then he opened his eyes, gave one final thrust and withdrew. A rope of creamy white arced from him and landed on Nicole's left breast. She writhed on the bed as he pumped his cock, sending another dollop onto her chest and two more onto the rolled-down basque.

After Paul had handed the phone to Brian, he impatiently pulled John out of the way and took his place. He lifted Nicole's legs and rested them against his shoulders before pushing his cock inside and fucking her with the same brutal intensity he'd shown earlier. Paul lasted only a couple of minutes before pulling out and ejaculating on her chest and stomach, as John had.

Brian was next, and once again the older man seemed to savour each sensation, sliding his cock slowly in and out. On any other occasion this would have made Nicole come, but tonight she was too ramped up. This wasn't about reaching orgasm—this was about putting on a show of being used by four men, all while her husband watched.

Brian pulled out and held his cock flat against her mons. Nicole raised her head in time to see him come onto her bare belly below the basque. He let out a stifled grunt and kept his gaze on his cock. She brought her hands up and clamped his dick to her belly, wriggling beneath him as another gush covered her tummy. She continued to massage his cock with one hand as she rubbed his cum into her skin with the other. Paul brought the phone closer to capture the action.

Nicole and Brian shared a smile, and then Donal knelt on the bed, grinning down at her. She took a breath, glanced down at his cock, then swallowed. This was probably going to hurt, but that would be a fitting finale to the evening.

Donal entered her with ease. There was no pain, just the wonderful sensation of being filled. Nicole clenched, wriggled and rocked her hips. She looked up at the phone in Paul's hand, remembering the time Julian had described waiting in line while a guy with a big cock fucked her. In her head, this was it. This was the biggest cock she'd ever taken, and she was enjoying taking it all. Wanting her husband to see her pleasure, she gritted

her teeth and rocked her body, trying her hardest to entice the spunk out of Donal's balls.

It seemed to work—he lasted no longer than any of the other guys. With a groan, he pulled out and aimed his cock at the opening of her sex. She felt the hot shower of cum hit the gap between her slit and her right leg. The second eruption covered her outer lips and pubic hair. So did the third and fourth.

Donal rubbed his fat cockhead through the sticky mess and then pushed back inside her. Nicole cried out and, as he resumed fucking her, she finally tumbled into an orgasm. She wrapped her legs around his and moved on his cock. He held still as Nicole rode out the final tremors. He didn't manage to come again, and as the contractions of her orgasm abated, she felt his cock wither and slip out of her.

Once Donal had stood up, Nicole sunk into the mattress, limp and weary. She saw Paul walking slowly to the bottom of the bed and moving the phone closer to her cum-splattered sex. After a few seconds, he passed her the phone.

She smiled into the camera then blew her husband a kiss. "See you tomorrow." After ending the call, she looked up at the four men. They'd all tucked away their cocks and had fastened their trousers.

"I'll give these guys a final drink," Brian said. "The bathroom's the next door on the left, if you need it."

"Thank you."

After they'd trooped back downstairs, Nicole walked unsteadily to the bathroom and managed a basic clean-up. Even so, she'd need a bath when she got to the hotel. Back in the bedroom, she'd just pulled on her thong and rolled her basque back up when a knock on the door made her jump.

Brian was holding out her dress. "You left this downstairs."

"Thanks." Nicole put it back on, took one last look around the room and picked up her phone.

Downstairs, the other three men were standing in the hallway. "We've got a taxi coming in five, so we can drop you at The Galmont on the way."

“Thank you.” Nicole gathered her bag and shawl, then waited in the hall with the others. When the taxi arrived, she gave each man a hug before leaving the house.

Donal held open the front door of the taxi for Nicole while John and Paul got into the back. “I’m just down the road, so I’ll walk from here,” he explained.

Nicole thanked the driver as he stopped outside the steps of her hotel. The men in the back refused her offer of money, so she got out and walked up the steps and into the hotel. Avoiding looking over at the reception desk, she headed straight to the lift and managed to get all the way to her room without meeting any of the other guests or staff.

Once inside, she slipped off her shoes and started to fill the bath, adding the whole complimentary bottle of relaxing bubbles. Then she returned to the bedroom and quickly stripped. She picked up her phone and tapped out a quick text to Julian.

*Am now back in my hotel room if you want to
chat. xNx*

She’d been soaking for a couple of minutes when her phone rang. She reached out to the side and grabbed it. “Hiya.”

“Nicole?”

She sat up so suddenly that water sloshed over the side of the bath. “Ciaran?”

“Yes, I’m sorry to call so late. Did I wake you?”

“No, I’ve only recently got back to the hotel.”

He was silent for a beat, then asked, “Are you alone?”

She snorted. “Yes, I’m alone. Though I’ve a good mind to tell you I’m enjoying a filthy threesome with Will and Meg.”

Ciaran chuckled. “Well, I don’t suppose I could blame you. Listen, about Will and Meg—”

“I’m sorry for my reaction earlier, but I was so angry at—”

“Yes, and you had every right to be. I was—”

“Yes, you were. I still think the slap was justified, but not throwing the wine. I’ve probably ruined Brian’s carpet as well as your suit.”

“They’ll both clean, I’m sure. But the reason I called was to apologise, and to try and explain some things.”

“I’m not sure even your smooth-talking could ever justify your actions.” She heard another soft chuckle, and could imagine his handsome face looking half-sincere, and half-admonished.

“Well, I haven’t been thinking very clearly for quite some time, but I do know I want to clear the air. Before the journey home.”

She believed him, but his long pause suggested he didn’t know where to start. She decided to lay her own cards on the table and explain what had disturbed her so much. “Meg told me that you’d kept talking about me over Christmas, and she seemed to think we were still ‘seeing’ each other.”

“I’d hoped that, after you’d calmed down, we could maybe go back to what we had.”

“Ciaran, I got the impression that your continual mention of me was to force Will into convincing Meg to do a threesome.”

“No, that’s not—”

“Then why mention me at all? Was Meg your ulterior motive all along? Let Will have a bit of fun with me and then pressure him into getting Meg to do the same with you?”

“What? No, of course not. That was never... Look, I didn’t introduce Will to you as part of some complicated plan—I thought you’d say no.”

“What?” Nicole was confused.

“It never crossed my mind that you’d agree to a threesome with him. I expected you to refuse. I was *sure* you’d refuse, and that your refusal would prove that I meant something to you.”

Nicole closed her eyes and tried to think clearly. The residual fug of alcohol was still slowing her thought processes. “You thought I’d—?”

“I wanted you to see that I was more than just someone you had sex with. There was a real connection there. I felt it, and I was sure you felt it, too. The full night we spent in that hotel room together, that was more than

just fucking. When you told me about the other guy you'd seen, I was upset and angry." He let out a long sigh. "I didn't stop talking about you because I couldn't stop thinking about you."

"Oh, Ciaran."

He was silent for a moment, and when he spoke again, his voice was barely more than a whisper. "I wish I'd never invited Will along that night. I wish we were still meeting in my office or in a hotel, and I wish we were still—"

"I'm sorry. I have some lovely memories of our time together, but that time is over. What we had was a physical thing, nothing more. I was always honest about that, and I thought you accepted it for what it was."

A beeping told her and Ciaran that someone else was trying to phone her.

"Is that Julian?" he asked.

"Probably."

"Well, I'd better let you go. Can you be ready for 10.30 in the morning?"

"Yes, I'll be ready."

"Okay. Will says you and Julian are going to invest in the company, too."

"Yes, if you're still intending to sell."

"My decision to sell now has nothing to do with anything that's been said between me and Will."

"Good. I'd hate to think that an indiscretion on my part had put the livelihood of all the employees at risk."

"No, it's simply about me trying to get into the stock market at a good time. Tell Julian you'll be home before six tomorrow evening. I'll see you in the morning. Goodnight, Nicole."

"Bye." Nicole ended the call and rang Julian, who picked up immediately.

"Hello?" He sounded worried.

"Hiya."

"Were you on another call?"

“Yes, Ciaran phoned to confirm what time he was picking me up. So...” She lowered her voice. “Did you enjoy what you saw tonight?”

“Enjoy is far too mild a word. It was phenomenal.”

Nicole smiled. “Did it come out clearly? The lighting was quite low, and I didn’t know if—”

“It was all much clearer than I imagined it would be. Whoever held the phone had a steadier hand than I did. You can watch it tomorrow.”

“You recorded it?”

“Of course. Didn’t you want me to?”

“I hadn’t thought about... Yes, I’m glad. It’ll be nice to see it, I just didn’t realise you could record FaceTime chats.”

“I didn’t either until after you called me from the kitchen and told me your intention. But once I’d had the idea, I quickly researched how to do it.”

“What was your favourite part?”

“There were so many favourite parts, I couldn’t possibly choose just one.”

“Did it turn you on, seeing your wife being used by four men?”

“Immensely.”

“Good.”

“Did you enjoy being used like that?”

“Mm-hmm.”

“Did you come?”

“Yes, but not until the very end.”

“That’s what I thought.” He chuckled. “I actually came more times than you did.”

“You made yourself come watching it?”

“Twice. And once more after I watched it a second time.”

Nicole smiled. “I like that you came, and I’m glad you told me about it.”

“As you’ve told me on many occasions, what we’re doing now means that there’s no reason to be anything other than completely open and

honest with each other.”

“That’s right.”

“One of the men was very big.”

“Mmm.”

He let out another sigh. “Well, I suppose I should let you get some well-deserved rest.”

“Okay. Ciaran’s picking me up from the hotel in...” She checked the time on her phone. “Seven hours. He said to tell you I’ll be home around six tomorrow evening.”

“I look forward to it.”

She smiled. “And what will you do to me when I get home?”

“I promise to exercise some patience and restraint.”

Memories of returning home after one particular date with Ciaran flickered through her mind—when she’d been caught in a rainstorm and arrived drenched and horny. Julian had taken her roughly in the hallway of their old house the moment she’d set foot inside.

“What if I don’t want patience or restraint?” she asked.

“Then I may well drag you straight to bed.”

“That might be showing too much patience.”

“In that case I’ll fuck you on the stairs.”

“I love that idea.”

“Me too. And what’s on the agenda after that?” he asked, his voice an intimate whisper.

She frowned, a little confused. “On what agenda?”

“I mean who will be the next person to enjoy the charms of my loaned wife?”

“Liz.”

“Liz alone?”

“Yes. After that, maybe Liz and Ed at the same time. And then, who knows?”

“I’ve had some thoughts about that.”

Nicole smiled. “Oh have you?”

“Hmm. When lockdown’s lifted, I’ll have to travel more with my new job. I was thinking that it’d be nice for you to join me on some of those trips.”

“I’d love that.”

“And while I’m busy working, you could go sightseeing. Budapest, Strasbourg and Paris are all on my list of places to go as soon as restrictions allow.”

“That sounds lovely.”

“And you could seduce a stranger in each city.”

Nicole felt a shiver run down her spine. She held her breath.

“Are you still there?” he asked after a few moment’s silence.

“Yes, I just... Are you serious?”

“Very. There’d be no pressure to do anything, but the option would be there if a man you found attractive made a pass at you.”

Nicole thought about wandering through Paris on a hot day, or sitting at a sidewalk café and catching the eye of a man at a nearby table, allowing him to join her for a drink, and then... “It’s a very sexy idea.”

“Hmm. And if your date with Liz is a success, you won’t need to limit your options to only men.”

“We’ll see.”

He let out a chuckle. “Well, it’s something to think about. I’ll see you tomorrow.”

“Night night.” She ended the call, got out of the bath and dried herself.

Nicole climbed into bed naked and lay in the dark, sated and content. She had a beautiful home, an incredible sex-life, and a wonderful husband who encouraged her to explore all her fantasies. Life as a loaned wife certainly suited her.

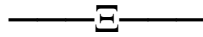
THE END



[Delores Swallows](#)

United Kingdom (2021)

About the Author



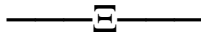
Delores Swallows has many dirty thoughts, and during his free time he writes them down in the form of stories. Born and bred in the northwest of England, he has a commoner's accent and a bit of a crush on his future queen (Kate, not Camilla!).

His stories often feature petite brunettes, high-heeled shoes and voyeurism. He claims he didn't realise these were obsessions until someone pointed out how often they appear in his work.

Find out more about Delores on his [web site](#), chat on [Twitter](#), or follow his new stories on [Amazon](#). And don't forget to sign up to his [mailing list](#) for a **free story**.

*Don't forget your dirty story exclusively available to members of [Delores'](#)
[mailing list](#).*

Also by Delores Swallows



A Hotwife's Journey

Her key in the door made his heart race. He listened as she came up the stairs, then held his breath when she walked into the bedroom. He couldn't help staring. Her clothes were twisted, her makeup was smudged, and her hair was dishevelled.

She's fucked someone.

Karen walked to the foot of the bed and looked into his face. "I did it."

He swallowed.

She pulled her top over her head and dropped it on the floor, then pushed her skirt down over her hips and kicked it away. Slowly, she unclipped her bra at the front. As the cups came away, he saw a love bite on one of her breasts. Karen held his gaze as she pushed her thong down her legs and then bent to pick it up, holding it open so he could see the gooey mess soaked into the crotch.

It was another man's cum, and it'd dribbled out of her during the drive home. The guy had deposited it deep in her cunt, and she'd returned home to her pervert husband to show him the evidence.

Nigel ached for her.





After her husband's open invitation to become a hotwife, Karen enjoys a variety of surprises and adventures that are hotter than any wife could wish for.

This collection covers her entire journey.

Karen's Open Invitation

Nigel is a lucky man. He has everything a man could want: a successful and beautiful wife, a happy marriage, two wonderful daughters, a nice home and his own business.

So why risk it all just to satisfy his dirty fantasy?

When Karen's throwaway comment about a hot colleague in the Sweden office unlocks the door to his secret desires, he offers her the chance to have a little fun; to mix business with pleasure.

Nigel has fantasised about sharing his wife for a long time. And from the way Karen's been behaving lately, he suspects the idea appeals to her, too.

But there's a big difference between fantasy and reality.

Will she take up his suggestion and have a passionate tryst with a virtual stranger while attending an overseas meeting? Neither know the answer when she leaves for the airport, but she doesn't have to

make her decision straight away. She can see how the meeting pans out. After all, it's an open invitation...

Karen's Party Surprise

Nigel is amazed by how Karen's taken to her new role as a hotwife. Not only does she give herself freely to strangers, but she also thrills her husband by giving him all the juicy details he craves when she gets home.

Their sex-life is better than ever.

Nigel realises that an upcoming company get together will mean that they'll be staying in the same hotel as Sean, the first man he ever shared her with. He offers Karen the chance to enjoy another night of passion, and they hatch a plan that could work. But Sean comes up with a counteroffer that's just too good to refuse.

For a wife-sharing couple like Nigel and Karen, it's the ultimate party surprise...

Karen's Holiday Adventures

Life keeps getting better and better for Nigel. His long-held wife-sharing fantasy is now his reality, and he couldn't be happier.

Or at least that's what he thinks until his wife reveals her plans for a break.

Their daughters are going away with their cousin's family, so Karen books a holiday for the two of them—on a Caribbean island. What's more, she promises to make it a fun-filled week where nothing is off-limits.

Under the hot tropical sun of St Lucia, Nigel learns just how hot his hotwife can be.

He's shocked by the diversity of her sexual appetite, but then she did promise him an 'anything goes' holiday adventure...

[A Hotwife's Journey](#) is available from Amazon.



Extramarital Pursuits

Michelle climbed up off the lounge and turned to face Harry. Lucas's sunglasses still hid her eyes, and his cum still covered her chest and stomach.

She tilted her head to one side and smiled. "Take my picture."

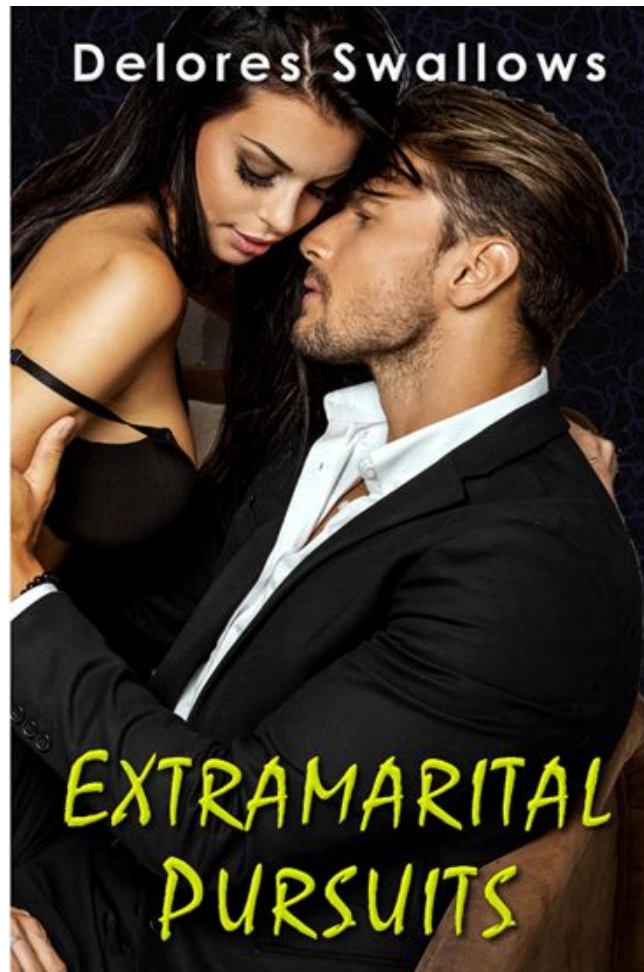
Harry did so, taking at least ten shots.

"And now shoot a video," she ordered.

Harry obeyed, selecting the correct option and pressing the red button.

Michelle smeared the cum all over her stomach and breasts while looking directly into the lens. "I have a confession—this isn't my husband's cum. My husband has just watched another man

fuck me, and I know he enjoyed it almost as much as I did.” She licked her lips. “And when we get home, my husband is going to use me for his pleasure, and then he’s going to come all over me as well.” Michelle gave her most beautiful smile. “I love my life.”



The complete sordid trilogy...

Operation Cuckold

Harry's having problems rising to the occasion and discovers Michelle's been using porn to help take care of things herself. He suggests she lives out her fantasy of a one-night stand, but is shocked by how much he gets out of it. As they repeat the experience with other men, pretty soon neither can stand the idea of going back to what they had before, even though Michelle pushes Harry right out of his comfort zone.

A cuck and bull story about a very happy hotwife.

Stag Nights

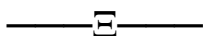
Harry and Michelle are now fully entrenched in their new wife-sharing lifestyle. Michelle is proving to be one of the hottest hotwives around, with bulls waiting in line to take turns. Literally. As Michelle gets more of what she craves, she pushes Harry further into the role of the cuckold and he's presented with situations he finds hard to accept. Things look like they might be going awry until a helpful bull called Ben explains that not all wife-sharing husbands need to be cucks...

Unleashing the Bull

When Josh's ex-girlfriend asks to meet for coffee, his hopes that they might get back together are crushed by news of her whirlwind romance and marriage. He offers his congratulations through gritted teeth, still besotted enough to agree to meet her again just days later. This time, Olivia's more provocative, more flirtatious, and she tells him exactly what part of him she misses the most. Caught up in a rush of emotions which steamroll over his morals, he goes back to her upmarket townhouse and indulges in what he's been missing. Her behaviour—coarser, sluttier—puzzles him, but that doesn't stop him going back for more. And then she tells him that her husband wants to meet him. Josh is stunned to find that her husband is a cuckold who actively encourages their liaisons. Hotwife Olivia, with her husband's help, convinces Josh that he has the physical attributes and stamina to service not just her, but several of her friends. Rising to the challenge, he becomes Ben the Bull, and loves every minute of it. As he explains to a friend, his life is full of dates with gorgeous women interested in having hot, dirty sex and nothing more.

Surely, no red-blooded man could want for anything more than that...?

[Extramarital Pursuits](#) is available from Amazon.



Take My Wife

After about fifteen minutes, Sophie leaned up on her elbow and started to kiss Joel, ready to continue with her night of passion. As she pushed the quilt down the bed with her foot, Jim saw that her hand was gripping Joel's dick, slowly masturbating him. Joel was already hard. Evidently, he was ready for more, too. Jim wondered how long Sophie had been playing with him. Sophie climbed on top of him, feeding his thick dick inside her.

Jim knelt on the bed next to their legs and watched as his wife slowly made love to the other man. Her head was buried against Joel's shoulder, her long tousled hair a dark fan over the pillow, hiding both their faces. Their bodies moved together in a slow, sensual dance. From his position on the bed, Jim had a perfect view of their union. With each slow, upward movement of Sophie's hips he could see Joel's slippery hardness, partially exposed for a second or two before it disappeared again inside the dark pinkness. Joel was holding Sophie's hips in his hands, moving her on him. Jim

stretched his hand out and gently stroked the back of Sophie's leg, aroused to feel her thigh muscles working as she rode his friend.

There was a layer of perspiration on Sophie's back, giving her a sultry, exotic look in the dim yellow light. Their lovemaking seemed to go on for a long time before Sophie reached her climax. She was very vocal as she came – muffled moans and sighs as the current built up, urgent grunts as the waves swelled inside her, then screams and shouts as the waves broke into an explosion of pleasure. Finally, she let out grateful cries and whimpers as she rode the final waves.



The epic saga of how a really dirty fantasy becomes a fantastically dirty reality. All three books under one sweaty cover.

Bon Voyeur

Another man in their bed? Madness! Sophie and Jim had never done it before—heck, it was only supposed to be a fantasy to get them in the mood for each other. What if Sophie likes it too much? What if Jim has second thoughts when he sees his beautiful wife taken by another man? What if she enjoys the other man more because he has more to offer?

When the perfect opportunity presents, though, they both jump at the chance.

Joel is tall, handsome, and so much bigger than even Sophie expected! Best of all, he's moving to the other side of the world, so they need never see him again. If Jim plays this right, Joel won't even suspect the stranger they're sharing is his loving wife.

Watching his beautiful Sophie—so vulnerable, so unprotected, so utterly owned—Jim experiences a powerful revelation. It's sure been fun having a gorgeous wife all to himself, but it's much more fun to share.

Abuse of Power

Jim's learning things about himself that he never knew. Surprising things. Like how much he enjoys watching his wife lose herself with another man. Sophie's learning as well, like how when it comes to male attention, for her it's a case of the more the merrier.

And Sophie loves getting merry. You might say she's becoming addicted. Sometimes she needs it so bad she'll take the initiative herself, even when Jim is not around. For most men, that might be a problem, but Jim is not most men. Just knowing what his loving wife is doing without him, giving herself to those men, letting them have her in every way they can... Yes, he gets jealous, but if Sophie tells him everything, how she becomes so needy that she simply relinquishes her will, it can be almost as good as being there.

Drunk on the seemingly inexhaustible depth of his wife's libido, Jim oversteps at a swinging party and starts directing Sophie's lovers, telling them where they should finish. Finally, Sophie cracks. Sticky, degraded, angry, she strikes back and gives her cuckold husband a taste of his own medicine... or at least, her lovers' medicine.

Global Playground

Jim is a simple man with simple needs. He lives in a nice house on a nice street, he's got a good job, and he plays tennis to wind down. And on weekends he kisses his wife Sophie goodbye when she goes off to swingers' parties to service her ever-escalating needs. Billionaires, porn stars, dancers—one at a time or all at once, it doesn't matter to Sophie. She'll take it every way she can get it and relay all the juicy details to Jim when she gets home.

Life is good. Too good, you might say. For a voyeur like Jim, his open marriage is damn near perfect. Little bit of wife-watching, little bit of playing around... what more could a man want? Well there's only one answer to the eternal question, and that's the eternal truth. He wants what he can't have—romantic dates, curling up in front of a fire, sweet togetherness—and while Sophie is off jet-setting with wealthy men to service her needs, Jim falls into a comfortable friendship with Naomi, a stunning older woman and self-described cougar.

For a man who's known nothing but chocolate-chip, where's the harm in trying vanilla for once? Just a little taste... maybe a scoop...

[Take My Wife](#) is available from Amazon

